



# Govt cracks down on polluting industries: 33 units shut, 44 fined

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

The Delhi Government has taken action against 106 industrial units found violating environmental norms. Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said the decision followed inspections of 2,011 industrial units carried out between January and July 2026.

The Chief Minister said the Government had stepped up monitoring of pollution caused by industrial units as part of a broader crackdown to ensure cleaner air in the capital. During the inspection drive, 106 units were found non-compliant with prescribed environmental standards, while 78 units were found operating without a valid Consent to Operate (CTO) from the Delhi Pollution Control Committee (DPPC).

Following the inspections, environmental compensation was imposed on 44 units, while closure orders were issued against 33 non-compliant industrial units. The Chief Minister said action was also being taken in other cases under relevant environmental laws and regulations. "Our objective is not merely to take action but to ensure effective control over pollution at its source," the Chief Minister said, adding that providing clean air to Delhi remained a priority for her government.

She said the Government would extend full support to industries complying with environmental regulations but would show no leniency toward units violating norms or polluting the city's air.

The Chief Minister said the campaign extended beyond industrial pollution to cover other major sources, including road dust, vehicular emissions, construction and demolition activities, and waste burning. She said on-ground monitoring of industrial emissions had been strengthened to identify polluting activities in time and enable swift action.

The Chief Minister said the fight against pollution could not rest with the government alone, describing citizens as important partners in the campaign.

She urged people to report instances of industrial pollution, open burning of waste, dust pollution, illegal dumping or any environmentally harmful activity to the Government, saying a single credible report could help



identify polluters faster and enable timely action.

Citizens can report such violations through the Green Delhi app or the MCD 311 app, the government said. Officials said genuine and reliable information from residents could play a significant role in identifying pollution-related violations and prompting swift enforcement action.

The Government said it was working to strengthen its inspection mechanisms, technology-based monitoring, coordination among various agencies, and citizen participation to further improve its pollution monitoring and enforcement system.

The stated objective is to

ensure environmental violations are identified as soon as they occur, allowing concerned agencies to act quickly.

The Chief Minister said the government's efforts toward ensuring clean air in Delhi would continue and become more effective going forward. She reiterated that industries complying with environmental regulations would receive support and facilitation, while strict action would continue against those found polluting the city's air.

She said the Delhi government wanted to turn the fight for clean air into a broader public movement, involving coordinated efforts between the Government, industries and citizens. She expressed hope that through such collective action, Delhi would move toward becoming a cleaner, healthier and greener capital.

The inspection drive and subsequent enforcement actions form part of the Delhi government's ongoing efforts to address the city's persistent air pollution challenges, with officials indicating that monitoring of industrial units would continue on a regular basis through the remainder of the year to ensure sustained compliance with environmental standards across the Capital's industrial areas.

## LG Sandhu reviews ease of doing business reforms

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Friday reviewed the progress of the Deregulation and Compliance Reduction exercise in Delhi. The LG directed all departments to close pending reforms without further delay and prioritise the needs of ordinary citizens.

The meeting, attended by the Chief Secretary, MCD Commissioner, Vice Chairman of DDA, and secretaries of the Education, Urban Development, Tourism and Health departments, followed a previous review held on July 29, 2026.

The exercise is being led by the Cabinet Secretariat, Government of India, through a dedicated Task Force



and Deregulation Cell.

The LG said the exercise had reached a stage where delays were directly affecting Delhi residents, and pending reforms must be implemented by the end of the month. He said progress should not be measured by how many Priority Areas are marked closed on a portal but by whether a shopkeeper, small manufacturer, school or

party involvement in building approvals and inspections, stand substantially addressed through the new Master Plan. The TOD Policy notified on April 6, 2026, is already under implementation.

The Urban Development Department is set to issue a notification urbanising the remaining 48 villages, after which no rural area will remain in Delhi. DDA's proposed amendments to the Unified Building Bye-Laws, 2016, are awaiting final notification and are expected soon.

On Phase-II, as of August 20, seven priority areas have been implemented, including removal of dual trade licences by MCD, perpetual registration for shops and commercial establishments, and electricity connections up to 200 KW without inspection.

## Taxi driver abducted, murdered after being lured on pretext of Jaipur trip; minor among six held

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

A 22-year-old taxi driver was allegedly abducted and murdered after being lured into accepting an offline booking for Jaipur, with his body later dumped in a forested area in Rajasthan, police said on Friday.

The Delhi Police have apprehended six persons, including a juvenile, in connection with the murder and recovered the victim's car from Rajasthan, they said. The deceased was identified as Ashish Pal, a resident of Auraiya in Uttar Pradesh. He was driving the taxi when he accepted the booking from Sarita Vihar to

Jaipur on July 20, according to police.

The incident was initially reported as a Zero FIR at the Mokhampura police station in Jaipur Rural in Rajasthan and was subsequently transferred to the Sarita Vihar police station in Delhi, where an FIR was registered.

According to the FIR, the

accused have been booked under multiple sections of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita. "During the journey, an altercation allegedly broke out between the accused and Pal over the fare. The accused assaulted him and subsequently strangled him before concealing his body in the vehicle," a senior police officer said.

The body was later taken to Rajasthan and disposed of in a forested area near Mokhampura, he said.

A team was formed, and investigation was taken up. During the investigation, police analysed CCTV footage from the taxi booking point, highways, toll plazas and other loca-

tions. Technical surveillance was also used to reconstruct the movement of the vehicle and identify the suspected accused, he said.

The team also coordinated with Rajasthan Police to identify locations and recover evidence. The investigation led to the apprehension of a 16-year-old juvenile and the arrest of five others -- Anil Jat, Kalu Ram, Sumit, Mangal Deep alias Sanu and Arjun Rinwa, police said.

The stolen car was traced to Rajasthan and recovered from the possession of Anil Jat and Kalu Ram by police. The victim's body was also recovered from Rajasthan and identified during the investigation.

**PUBLIC NOTICE**

My clients **Harish Kumar Gupta S/o Late Shri Prahlad Rai Gupta and Geeta Gupta** (wife of Harish Kumar Gupta) both are at H.No. **B-9/2, Shish Ram Park, Uttam Nagar, West Delhi 110059** have disowned their son **Piyush Gupta** from their movable & immovable properties and several all relations with them due to their disobedience. My clients will not be responsible for their any act.  
**Rajendra Yadav (Advocate)**  
Ch. No. 272 Saket Court New Delhi-17

**PUBLIC NOTICE**

My client **Shri. Ravi Kumar S/o H. Shri. Ayodhya Prasad and Smt. Sunita W/o Shri. Ravi Kumar R/o 9/4619, old Seelampur, Gandhi Nagar, Delhi 110031** and also at A/705, Milan earth society, Rajnagar extension, Ghaziabad, up 201017 has debarred their Daughter **Ms Nitika**, aged about 25 years, from all their movable and immovable properties and also severed all family relations With her with immediate effect on account of her conduct. Any Person dealing with the said Ms. Nitika shall be doing so at his own risk.  
**Suresh Agarwal (Advocate) A-266, MIG Flats, Bri Vihar, PO Chandanagar, Ghaziabad, UP-201 011**

**NORTHERN RAILWAY**

**Notice Inviting Quotations (NIQ)**

The Sr. DCM/FS, Northern Railway, Delhi Division for and on behalf of President of India invites quotations for Provision, Installation, Operation of 04 sprinklers and 01 dust screen to control pollution by dust at Adarsh Nagar Delhi Goods shed and to maintain the same for a period of 1 year.

For more details and information kindly visit Northern Railway's website: [www.nr.indianrailways.gov.in](http://www.nr.indianrailways.gov.in) or contact 9717631962.

Last date for submission of NIQ is upto **15:00 Hrs on 28.08.2026.**

**No.- 1C-MG-GoodsShed Pollution-2026 Date: 00.08.2026 2921/2026**

**SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE**

**CONTINENTAL CHEMICALS LIMITED**

CIN: L24123UP1984PLC014111

Regd. Office: A-7, Sector - VII, NOIDA, Distt.: Gautam Buddha Nagar U.P. Pin - 201301

Website: [www.continentalchemicals.com](http://www.continentalchemicals.com); Email: [info@continentalsoft.com](mailto:info@continentalsoft.com);

Ph. No: 91-120-2423316

**INFORMATION REGARDING 41<sup>ST</sup> ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING OF CONTINENTAL CHEMICALS LIMITED**

NOTICE is hereby given that the Forty-first (41<sup>st</sup>) Annual General Meeting ('AGM') of the Members of Continental Chemicals Limited ('Company') will be held on Friday, September 18, 2026 at 04.00 p.m. IST, through Video Conferencing (VC)/Other Audio Video Means (OAVM) facility, without the physical presence of the Members at the meeting, in compliance with all applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 and the Rules made thereunder and SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 read with Circular No. No. 14/2020 dated April 8, 2020, Circular No. 17/2020 dated April 13, 2020, Circular No. 20/2020 dated May 5, 2020, Circular No. 02/2021 dated January 13, 2021, Circular No. 02/2022 dated May 05, 2022, General Circular No. 9/2023 dated September 25, 2023, Circular No. 09/2024 dated September 19, 2024 and latest being General Circular No. 03/2025 dated September 22, 2025 issued by Ministry of Corporate Affairs ('MCA Circulars') and SEBI circular No. SEBI/HO/CFD/CMD/CI/RP/2020/79 dated May 12, 2020, SEBI/HO/CFD/CMD/CI/RP/2021/11 dated January 15, 2021, SEBI/HO/CFD/CMD/CI/RP/2022/62 dated May 13, 2022, SEBI/HO/CFD/POD-2/PICR/2023/4 dated January 5, 2023, SEBI/HO/CFD/CFD-POD-2/PICR/2023/167 dated October 7, 2023 and SEBI/HO/CFD/CFD-POD-2/PICR/2024/133 dated October 03, 2024 (collectively referred to as 'SEBI Circulars') and Master Circular SEBI/HO/CFD/POD/CI/RP/2023/120 dated July 11, 2023 ('SEBI Circulars') to transact the businesses as set out in the Notice of the AGM.

In compliance with the said Circulars, the Notice of the AGM along with the Annual Report for FY 2025-26 ('Annual Report') will be sent in due course only through electronic mode to those Members whose email ids are registered with the Company's Registrar and Transfer agent ('RTA') and Depository Participants ('DP'), those Members who have not registered their e-mail address so far are requested to register their e-mail address for receiving all communication including Annual Report, Notices, Circulars, etc. from the Company electronically.

In case you have not registered your email id with depository you may register your email id in following manner:-

**Physical Holding** Send a signed request the Company, at [info@continentalsoft.com](mailto:info@continentalsoft.com), compliance@continentalsoft.com providing Folio number, Name of the shareholder, scanned copy of the share certificate (Front and Back), PAN (Self attested scanned copy of PAN Card), AADHAR (Self attested scanned copy of Aadhar Card) for registering email address.

**Demat Holding** Please contact your Depository Participant (DP) and register your email address as per the process advised by DP.

The Notice of the AGM and Annual Report will also be made available on the Company's website at [www.continentalchemicals.com](http://www.continentalchemicals.com), websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE Limited at [www.bseindia.com](http://www.bseindia.com) and on the website of CDSL (agency for providing the Remote e-Voting facility and e-voting system during the AGM) i.e. [www.evotingindia.com](http://www.evotingindia.com). The Company is providing the remote e-Voting facility before the AGM and e-Voting facility at the AGM to its members to exercise their right to vote on all the resolutions set forth in the Notice and proposed to be transacted at the AGM by electronic means. The facility of casting votes will be provided by CDSL.

The Members who had already casted their vote by remote e-Voting prior to the AGM may also attend/participate in the AGM through VC/OAVM but shall not be entitled to cast their vote again at the AGM. Detailed process and manner of remote e-Voting, e-Voting at the AGM and instructions for attending the AGM through VC/OAVM is being provided in the Notice of the AGM.

Members may follow the instructions for remote e-Voting as well as e-Voting at the AGM as provided in the Notice of the AGM. If you have any queries or issues regarding attending AGM & e-Voting from the CDSL e-Voting System, you can write an email to [helpdesk.evoting@cdslindia.com](mailto:helpdesk.evoting@cdslindia.com) or contact at 1800 21 09911.

For CONTINENTAL CHEMICALS LIMITED  
Sd/-  
Naresh Kumar Chhibba  
Managing Director  
DIN 00376963  
Place : Noida  
Date : August 21, 2026

**PUBLIC NOTICE**

NOTICE is hereby given that one Mr. Jayram hereinafter referred to as 'said Mortgagee/Borrower' has created mortgage in respect of the Flat/Property more particularly described in the Schedule hereunder in favour of the said Mortgagee/Borrower, original documents, namely: Flat No. 76, Commercial Market Sec-5, Balendra Nagar, Ghaziabad UP 201006. According to the said Mortgagee/Borrower, original documents, namely: Lease Deed dated 28-01-2004 bearing Document No. 1245/2004, Volume No. 2405, Pages 27/234, from Home have been lost/misplaced and not traceable. If the said Original Agreements/Deeds/Documents, found by any person, the same shall be handed over at the address mentioned herein below. Further, if any person, body, individual, institution having any claim and/or objection in respect of or against or relating to or touching upon said property by way of sale, lease, lien, mortgage, charge, encumbrance, gift, assignment, maintenance, inheritance, testamentary disposition or otherwise or having in their custody any title, documents pertaining to the said property, the same shall be handed over to the undersigned at my address within 7 days from the publication of this notice with documentary evidence in support of their claim. Failing which all the claims of such person shall be considered to have been waived and/or abandoned. Any objections raised after the completion of the 7 days shall not be binding upon the said flat or my Client, please contact Advocate Bhagupinder Kumar, Ph. 9810899988 or 1584 Sector 16-37 HSR WITHIN 7 DAY OF THIS PUBLICATION.

**PUBLIC NOTICE**

Property I.e., EWS House No. NK-1H/3502, Third Floor (Without roof right), Haryana Khadd-3, Indrapuram, Ghaziabad, Telangana District Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh 201014

**NORTHERN RAILWAY**

**CORRIDGUMENT**

Ref: Tender Notice No. 20/2026-2027 dated 15.06.2026 S.No. 03

Tender Number 72759051RGCC Opening date 27.08.2026

In reference to above, Tender Opening date has been extended from 27.08.2026 to 08.09.2026. Price Variation Formula has also been revised. All other terms and conditions remain unchanged. The corrigendum has been published on website [www.ireps.gov.in](http://www.ireps.gov.in). Note: This is the Fourth Corrigendum in above referred tender. Date: 21.08.2026 2920/2026

**SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE**

**New Okhla Industrial Development Authority**

Main Administrative Building, Sector-96, Noida, G.B. Nagar (U.P.) Website : [www.noidaauthorityonline.in](http://www.noidaauthorityonline.in)

**E-TENDER**

E-Tenders are invited from firms/contractors registered with UPLC Lucknow for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on Noida Authority's official website: [www.noidaauthorityonline.in](http://www.noidaauthorityonline.in) & <http://tender.up.nic.in>. Please ensure to see these website for any changes/amendments & corrigendum etc.

1. Job No. 02/Computer Cell/Conference Room/2026-27 SUPPLY, INSTALLATION, TESTING AND COMMISSIONING OF CONFERENCE ROOM EQUIPMENTS AT CAMP OFFICE SECTOR-11A NOIDA WITH 3 YEAR WARRANTY

The above tenders can be uploaded by date 27.08.2026 upto 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date 28.08.2026 at 11.00 AM.

प्रबन्धक (कम्प्यूटर सैल)

**CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA**

**NORTHERN RAILWAY**

**Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement System**

Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

| S. No. | Tender No. | Brief Description             | Qty.     | Closing Date |
|--------|------------|-------------------------------|----------|--------------|
| 01     | 08265100A  | MATERIALS OF SLIDING BOOM     | 271 SET  | 17.09.2026   |
| 02     | 19262604   | 1-1/4 INCH CUT OFF ANGLE COCK | 3126 NOS | 21.09.2026   |

**Note:-** 1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. [www.ireps.gov.in](http://www.ireps.gov.in) for details. 2. No manual offer will be entertained.

Tender Notice No.: 37/2026-2027 Dated: 21.08.2026 2917/2026

**SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE**

**PUBLIC NOTICE**

Notice is hereby given to the general public that the original ownership/shares pertaining to the following properties situated in Godrej Connaught One, 14 Lady Harding Road, Connaught Place, New Delhi-110001, have been lost/misplaced: Apartment No. 0701 Apartment No. 07CSP1 Apartment No. 0703

Ms. Tanini Mehta is the sole and exclusive owner of the above-mentioned properties. The last documents include Original Builder Buyer Agreements, Allotment Letter, all payment Receipts, and other related documents, they are not found despite our best efforts. Any person who has found the aforesaid documents, or has any claim, right, title, interest, objection or encumbrance in respect of the said properties or documents, is requested to intimate the same in writing, along with supporting documents, to the undersigned within 15 days from the date of publication of this notice. If no objection is received within the stipulated period, any such claim shall be deemed to have been waived, and no claim shall be entertained thereafter.

Date: 21.08.2026  
Place: New Delhi

**Tanini Mehta**  
Thru  
Mr Hemant Walla  
M-25, 1st Floor, GK-1, M Block Market  
New Delhi-110048, Mob.: 9899474781

**PUBLIC NOTICE**

The general public is hereby informed that my clients, Mr. Satyendra Tiwari (aged 56 years) S/o Late Mr. Radhey Shyam Tiwari, and Mrs. Anjali Tiwari (aged 51 years) W/o Mr. Satyendra Tiwari, and Mr. Adarsh Tiwari (aged 24 years) S/o Mr. Satyendra Tiwari, all residents of Flat No. 214/204, 21st Floor, Austin Dev Sai Sports Complex, Greater Noida West, VTC, Noida, District Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh, have severed all their ties and relationships from Mr. Shashank Tiwari (aged 28 years) S/o Mr. Satyendra Tiwari, resident of SAP No. 1944, Housing Colony, Dulajon, No.1 Dulia, Dibrugarh, Assam 786602, and his wife Mrs. Shalu Devi (aged 30 years) D/O Mr. Rajmal, being resident of Chakraborty (158), Khaddar, Bajinath, District Mandi, Himachal Pradesh 176726. That since 12.02.2026, which is the date of solemnization of marriage between Mr. Shashank Tiwari and Mrs. Shalu Devi, the conduct and behaviour of Mrs. Shalu Devi and Mr. Shashank Tiwari towards the family members have remained unlawful and discourteous. Therefore, my client and his family have as of 01.04.2026, disowned and disidentified both of them i.e. Mr. Shashank Tiwari and Mrs. Shalu Devi from all movable and immovable properties, and any body dealing with them may do so at their risk. From 01.04.2026 onwards, my client will not be responsible for the acts and deeds of Mr. Shashank Tiwari and Mrs. Shalu Devi.

Date: 20.08.2026  
Place: New Delhi

Anur Kumar Tiwari Advocate

**KONKAN RAILWAY CORPORATION LIMITED**

(A Government of India Undertaking)

**EMPLOYMENT NOTIFICATION**

Konkan Railway Corporation Limited has published Employment Notification for various posts in Rishikesh Project of S & T Department on fixed term Contract basis through **Walk-in-interview**. Details are as under:

**Employment Notification No.CO/P-R/15C/2026, dated 17.08.2026**

| Name of post                  | UR | EWS | OBC | SC | ST | Total No. of Posts | Date of Walk in Interview |
|-------------------------------|----|-----|-----|----|----|--------------------|---------------------------|
| Deputy General Manager/S&T    | 1  | 0   | 0   | 0  | 0  | 1                  |                           |
| Sr. Project Manager/S&T       | 1  | 0   | 0   | 0  | 0  | 1                  | 07.09.2026                |
| Project Engineer/S&T(AUTOCAD) | 2  | 0   | 0   | 0  | 0  | 2                  |                           |
| Senior Technician             | 1  | 0   | 0   | 0  | 0  | 1                  |                           |
| Technician                    | 1  | 0   | 0   | 0  | 0  | 1                  | 08.09.2026                |
| Cook                          | 1  | 0   | 0   | 0  | 0  | 1                  |                           |

Candidates may see the details of notification, eligibility criteria, etc. on the KRC's website [www.konkanrailway.com](http://www.konkanrailway.com) at the link → Recruitment → Current Notification and apply accordingly

Chief Personnel Officer

**AXIS BANK LTD.**

Retail Asset Centre: Axis House, Jaypee Green Wish Town, Tower-2, 4th Floor, Sec-123, Noida Expressway, Noida-201301

Corporate Office: 'Axis House', Block-B, Bamsay Dyeing Mills Compound, Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai-400025, Registered Office: 'Trishul', 3rd floor, opposite Samartheswar Temple, Laxmi Nagar, Ellisbridge, Ahmedabad-380006, Also at: Axis Bank Ltd., Himalaya House, Upper Ground Floor & First Floor, KG Marg, Connaught Place, New Delhi-110001

**PUBLICATION OF NOTICE REGARDING POSSESSION OF PROPERTY U/S 13(4) OF SARFAESI ACT 2002**

Notice is hereby given under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (SARFAESI Act) and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(4) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, read with demand notice was issued on the dates mentioned against each account and stated hereinafter calling upon them to repay the amount within 60 days from the date of receipt of said notice. The Borrower having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of power conferred on him/her under section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 9 of the said Act on the dates mentioned against each account.

The Borrower in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of the Axis Bank Ltd. for an amount and interest thereon.

The borrowers attention is invited to provisions of Sub-section (8) of Section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available to redeem the secured assets.

| S. No. | Name of Borrower / Co-Borrower                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | (1) Date of Demand Notice                                                                                                           | (2) Date of Possession                                                                                                              | (3) Amount in Demand Notice (Rs.) |
|--------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| 1.     | Gaurav Vasudev Flat No B-605, Media Apartment, Plot No-18 A, Sector-7, Dwarka, South West Delhi-C7095, Delhi-110075 (Borrower) 2. Manish Sharma H.no-A-58, The Ground Floor, Near Gurdwara, Pandur Nagar, New Delhi, Delhi-110092 (Co-Borrower/ Guarantor) | (1). 14-Jun-2025<br>(2). 19-Aug-2026<br>(3). Rs. 1,10,93,130/- (Rupees One Core Eleven Lakh Nine Thousand One Hundred Thirty Only)  | (1). 14-Jun-2025<br>(2). 19-Aug-2026<br>(3). Rs. 79,16,112/- (Rupees Seventy Nine Lakh Sixteen Thousand One Hundred Twenty Only)    |                                   |
| 2.     | Gaurav Vasudev Flat No B-605, Media Apartment, Plot No-18 A, Sector-7, Dwarka South West Delhi-C7095, Delhi-110075 (Borrower) 2. Manish Sharma H.no-A-58, The Ground Floor, Near Gurdwara, Pandur Nagar New Delhi, Delhi-110092 Guarantor                  | (1). 14-Jun-2025<br>(2). 19-Aug-2026<br>(3). Rs. 79,16,112/- (Rupees Seventy Nine Lakh Sixteen Thousand One Hundred Twenty Only)    | (1). 14-Jun-2025<br>(2). 19-Aug-2026<br>(3). Rs. 79,16,112/- (Rupees Seventy Nine Lakh Sixteen Thousand One Hundred Twenty Only)    |                                   |
| 3.     | Mr. Dan Singh Rawat (Borrower) S/o. Mr. Bhagwan Singh Rawat R/O. House No. 1994, Sec-7/6, Faridabad, Haryana-121006                                                                                                                                        | (1). 30-08-2025<br>(2). 20-Aug-2026<br>(3). Rs. 4,39,544/- (Rupees Four Lakh Thirty Nine Thousand Five Hundred Forty Four Only)     | (1). 30-08-2025<br>(2). 20-Aug-2026<br>(3). Rs. 4,39,544/- (Rupees Four Lakh Thirty Nine Thousand Five Hundred Forty Four Only)     |                                   |
| 4.     | Mr. Sukhbir Singh Verma, R/O Quarter 20 F Type 1, 4-2nd Floor, Aram Bagh, Behind Delhi Haat, New Delhi-110055 2. Sarvesh Verma, R/O Quarter 20 F Type-1, 2nd Floor, Aram Bagh, Behind Delhi Haat, New Delhi-110055                                         | (1). 30-08-2025<br>(2). 20-Aug-2026<br>(3). Rs. 11,66,132/- (Rupees Eleven Lakh Sixty Six Thousand One Hundred And Thirty Two Only) | (1). 30-08-2025<br>(2). 20-Aug-2026<br>(3). Rs. 11,66,132/- (Rupees Eleven Lakh Sixty Six Thousand One Hundred And Thirty Two Only) |                                   |

**Description of Property:** All Piece & Parcels Flat Unit No.(R004A30805/Flat#0805) 7th Floor, In Sector-3 Tower, At Supertech Czar Plot No. G-07, Sector-3 Tower, Greater Noida, U.P.

Dated: 22.08.2026, Place: Delhi MCR

Sd/-, Authorized Officer, Axis Bank Ltd.

**नौलामी सूचना**

नौलामी सूचना के रूप में जारी किया जाता है कि रा. वा. मा. विद्यालय, नानपुर (1155) हथौन पवेल के आठ (08) जर्जर कमरों की नौलामी दिनांक **02-09-2026** बुधवार सुबह 10.00 बजे विद्यालय परिसर में की जाएगी। घरोहर राशि पचास हजार रुपये होगी। बोली आरक्षित मूल्य तीन लाख पचासी हजार रुपये से शुरू की जाएगी। नौलामी से सम्बंधित नियम व सर्त नौलामी पर नौलामी से पहले बता दी जाएगी। नौलामी में सरकार व शिक्षा विभाग के नियमों की पालना सर्वांगीर होगी। इच्छुक व्यक्ति विचारित समय एवं स्थान पर पहुंचें।

**प्रधानाचार्य एवं विद्यालय प्रबंधन समिति**  
रा. वा. मा. विद्यालय, नानपुर, हथौन  
फोन: 9811969791

**PUBLIC NOTICE**

Notice is hereby given that PRATANU MUHURI son of PRANAB KUMAR MUHURI is applying to the Secretary to the Government of India in the Ministry of Home Affairs for naturalization and that any person who knows any reason why naturalization should not be granted should send a written signed statement of the facts to the said Secretary

**PUBLIC NOTICE**

My client **Sh. Ram Singh Rautela S/o Sh. Jeet Singh Rautela** and his wife **Janaki Rautela** both R/O **E-148 E, East Vinod Nagar, East Delhi, Delhi-110091**, have severed their all relations and disowned their son **Keshav Rautela**, from their all moveable-immovable properties, due to his disobedience. Anybody dealing with Keshav Rautela will do so at him at their own risk and my client will not be responsible for any act.  
**D.S. Mehta (Advocate)**

**NAME CHANGE**

1, Azhar Ahmed R/O T-7 Ward No.6 Islam Colony, Mehrauli, New Delhi-110030, henceforth be known as my son namely Ayaan Ahmed now I want to change: Anas Ahmed to Ayaan Ahmed vide and affidavit sworn before the Notary Public at New Delhi on 05/07/2025 that Anas Ahmed and Ayaan Ahmed are one and the same identical Child.

**TO WHOMSOEVER IT MAY CONCERN**

The general public and our clients are cautioned that Sumit Bhadra, Accounts Co-ordinator, is no longer employed with our organisation and in this connection FIR No. 264/2026 is registered at P.S. Kapasera, Delhi. Anyone dealing with him shall do so at their own risk and responsibility. For Ares Advisory Private Limited Authorised Signatory

**FORM G INVITATION FOR EXPRESSION OF INTEREST**

**Blackberry Overseas Private Limited**

**Operating In Manufacturing and Trading of Bathroom Accessories**

(Under Regulation 36A (1) of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India (Insolvency Resolution Process for Corporate Persons) Regulations, 2016)

**RELEVANT PARTICULARS**

|                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Name of the corporate debtor along with PAN/ CIN/ LLP No.                                                                                                                              | <b>Blackberry Overseas Private Limited</b><br>CIN :- U51909DL2010PTC329742                                                                                                                                                |
| 2. Address of the registered office                                                                                                                                                       | G-11 : North Square Mall Netaji Subhash Place, North West, New Delhi, Delhi, India, 110034                                                                                                                                |
| 3. URL of website                                                                                                                                                                         | N/A                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 4. Details of place where majority of fixed assets are located                                                                                                                            | WZ-60, Mukham Garden, Ram Nagar, Tilak Nagar, New Delhi – 110018.                                                                                                                                                         |
| 5. Installed capacity of main products/ services                                                                                                                                          | Trading of home décor, lights, sanitary ware products along with involved in undertaking solid waste management work contracts (The above information is as per the information received from suspended management of CD) |
| 6. Quantity and value of main products/ services sold in last financial year                                                                                                              | Nil (Company is not operated since 2024)                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 7. Number of employees/ workmen                                                                                                                                                           | Nil (Company is not operated since 2024)                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 8. Further details including last available financial statements (with schedules) of two years, lists of creditors, relevant dates for subsequent events of the process are available at: | Detail can be sought by emailing to: <a href="mailto:corp.blackberry@gmail.com">corp.blackberry@gmail.com</a>                                                                                                             |
| 9. Eligibility for resolution applicants under section 25(2)(h) of the Code is available at:                                                                                              | Detail can be sought by emailing to: <a href="mailto:corp.blackberry@gmail.com">corp.blackberry@gmail.com</a>                                                                                                             |
| 10. Last date for receipt of expression of interest                                                                                                                                       | 06.09.2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 11. Date of issue of provisional list of prospective resolution applicants                                                                                                                | 16.09.2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 12. Last date for submission of objections to provisional list                                                                                                                            | 21.09.2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 13. Date of issue of final list of prospective resolution applicants                                                                                                                      | 01.10.2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 14. Date of issue of information memorandum, evaluation matrix and request for resolution plans to prospective resolution applicants                                                      | 06.11.2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 15. Last date for submission of resolution plans                                                                                                                                          | 10.12.2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 16. Process email id to submit EOIs                                                                                                                                                       | <a href="mailto:corp.blackberry@gmail.com">corp.blackberry@gmail.com</a>                                                                                                                                                  |
| 17. Details of the corporate debtor's registration status as MSME                                                                                                                         | Registration Number: UDYAM-DL-04-0002632 Enterprise Type: Small Date of UDYAM Registration: 18.11.2020                                                                                                                    |

**Sd/- (Bhavna Bansal)**  
**Resolution Professional for M/s Blackberry Overseas Private Limited**  
Address: E-9/23, LGF, Vasant Vihar, New Delhi-110057.  
E-mail ID: [bhavnabansal@yahoo.com](mailto:bhavnabansal@yahoo.com)  
Date: 22.08.2026 Case Specific Email ID: [corp.blackberry@gmail.com](mailto:corp.blackberry@gmail.com)  
Place: New Delhi Mobile No: +91-9212016744

# Nadda reviews H1N1 preparedness as Delhi reports 1,777 cases

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

Delhi is witnessing a rise in influenza cases, with H1N1. The capital has reported 2,602 influenza-A cases, including 1,777 H1N1 (swine flu) infections so far this year, according to data released by the Directorate of State Health Mission (DSHM).

This has prompted the Union Health Minister JP Nadda to review the prevailing H1N1 influenza situation and preparedness measures in the country with a particular focus on the national Capital and stressed the need for continued vigilance and robust surveillance. Delhi Health Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh also attended the meeting. According to Pankaj

Singh, the city is fully equipped to deal with the seasonal rise in influenza cases.

Of the fresh cases, 155 were classified under Influenza-A and four under Influenza-B, the data showed. Within Influenza-A, the H1N1 subtype accounted for 114 of the day's cases, taking its cumulative total for the year to 1,777, making it the dominant strain currently circulating in the city. Other influenza A subtypes reported on the day included two cases of H1 and one case of H3, with cumulative totals of 37 and 138, respectively, for the year.

An additional 38 cases were recorded under the "others" category within Influenza-A, taking that subcategory's cumulative count to 440. In total, influenza-A cases have

reached 2,392 for 2026.

Under Influenza-B, four Victoria lineage cases were reported on the day, with no fresh cases of the Yamagata lineage or other Influenza-B subtypes. The cumulative figures for the year stand at 200 for Victoria, zero for Yamagata, and 10 for other Influenza-B subtypes, taking the total Influenza-B count to 210 cases in 2026. Additionally, Delhi has reported 246 dengue cases and 80 malaria cases this year, with zero deaths from either disease. Chikungunya cases stood at 19, also with no deaths.

As part of vector-control measures, local bodies have conducted 2.38 crore house visits, sprayed 3.20 lakh houses, identified 91,217 mosquito-positive houses, issued



74,591 legal notices and launched 6,724 prosecutions, the statement said.

Delhi has 35 designated sentinel surveillance hospitals, two apex referral laboratories at AIIMS and NCDC, and a malaria reference laboratory at Maulana Azad Medical College.

In an official statement issued after the meeting, Singh said there was no shortage of beds, doctors, medicines or essential medical equipment in the capital, adding that the patient tally was being monitored and hospital arrangements being strengthened according to requirements.

According to the statement, the Delhi State Health Mission is maintaining close surveillance through the Integrated Disease Surveillance Programme (IDSP), with daily monitoring of influenza-like illness (ILI), severe acute respiratory infection (SARI) and influenza cases reported through the IDSP-IHIP (Integrated Health Information Platform) portal. Regular updates are being shared with senior authorities.

Advisories have been issued to chief district medical officers, district surveillance officers and hospitals for screening, reporting and monitoring of ILI, SARI and influenza cases, the statement said, adding that technical guidelines covering patient categorisation, treatment protocols, ventila-

tory management, masks and home care have also been circulated. Healthcare workers are being sensitised and trained on symptoms and follow-up protocols, while a refresher training programme for district officers was held recently, the statement said.

An inter-sectoral meeting involving the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD), New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC), Delhi Cantonment Board, the education department, the Delhi Development Authority (DDA) and other stakeholders has directed that public awareness and IEC (information, education, and communication) activities on influenza prevention and control be intensified, it said.

Hospitals have been directed to maintain mosquito-free

campuses, ensure timely reporting and keep adequate diagnostic kits, medicines, intravenous fluids, blood products and dedicated beds wherever required, the statement said. The Delhi Government is coordinating with the MCD, NDMC, Delhi Cantonment Board and other departments for prevention and control, while dengue and malaria surveillance, training, awareness and door-to-door outreach through ASHA workers continue, it added.

According to the statement, Delhi's malaria annual parasite incidence remains below one, placing it in the pre-elimination phase, with the "Test, Track and Treat" strategy being implemented under the 2025-27 malaria elimination plan.

## DU student blinded by pellet during July 20 protest; FIR filed after a month

ABHINAV KUMAR JHA  
■ New Delhi

A 20-year-old Delhi University student has permanently lost vision in his right eye after being struck by a pellet during a protest near Jantar Mantar on July 20. The Delhi police registered an FIR only on August 21, more than a month after the incident, according to the complaint filed with Parliament Street police station.

The complainant, Sahil, son of Deepak, a resident of Aggarwal Colony near New Anaj Mandi in Najafgarh, Dwarka, is a student at Delhi University's School of Open Learning. In his complaint, he said he had gone to the Jantar Mantar area out of curiosity on the afternoon of July 20, when students protesting against alleged irregularities in the Delhi Police constable recruitment exam and the NEET paper leak had gathered and begun marching toward the venue. According to the complaint, the situation turned chaotic in the afternoon when police used tear gas



Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi stages a dharna seeking the registration of an FIR over pellet injuries suffered by a youth during the CJP-led July 20 protest at Parliament Street police station in New Delhi

and a lathicharge to disperse the crowd.

Sahil said in the ensuing chaos, he was struck by a pellet in his right eye, along with injuries to his face and body. He said hundreds of students had gathered at the spot when the disturbance broke out.

Following the injury, Sahil was taken to Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital and later shifted to AIIMS, where he

was examined at the RPC Eye Centre and the AIIMS Trauma Centre. His complaint states that his right eye's vision deteriorated significantly and eventually went completely dark.

A CT scan conducted at AIIMS reportedly showed more than 200 pellets lodged in his body, some of which could not be surgically removed due to their proximity to nerves.



The registration of an FIR over pellet injuries suffered by a youth during the CJP-led July 20 protest at Parliament Street police station in New Delhi

Sahil underwent his first surgery on July 21 and a second one on July 22, following which he was referred for a Medico-Legal Case (MLC) examination.

On July 25, he returned to the RPC Eye Centre for a follow-up, where doctors reportedly told him his eye could not be saved and that the vision loss was permanent. A second surgery on his eye was performed on July 31,

after which doctors confirmed the permanent loss of vision in his right eye, according to the complaint.

In his complaint, Sahil alleged that despite repeated attempts to get an FIR registered, Delhi Police did not act promptly. He said he visited multiple hospitals over a period of nearly three weeks trying to secure his MLC and file a formal complaint but was repeatedly

told to wait despite his serious medical condition.

The FIR was eventually registered on August 21 under Section 118(1)/125 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, which pertains to voluntarily causing hurt through dangerous weapons or means against unknown persons. According to the FIR, the occurrence took place between 12 pm and 5 pm on July 20 at Jantar Mantar, near Connaught Place in New Delhi.

The case has been assigned to Sub-Inspector Mohit Verma for investigation. Police records show the FIR was registered following a written complaint received at the police station, with the matter forwarded to senior officials for further action.

The incident adds to scrutiny over the police response to the July 20 protest, which saw students demonstrating against alleged exam-related irregularities, with Sahil's case highlighting the gap between the date of the alleged injury and the formal registration of the FIR.

## Traffic congestion at CDR Chowk, Mandir Wali Road reviewed

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

The Delhi Traffic Police has directed coordinated measures to ease congestion at CDR Chowk on MG Road and Mandir Wali Road in south Delhi's Mehrauli area, where a large number of commuters use public transport to travel to and from the Chhattarpur metro station.

The Southern Range DCP (traffic) inspected the two stretches to assess traffic congestion and pedestrian movement as he interacted with drivers of Gramin Seva vehicles, e-rickshaws and auto-rickshaws, urging them to cooperate with the traffic police.

The assessment found that the area witnesses heavy pedestrian and vehicular movement throughout the day, particularly during peak hours. Thousands of commuters depend on buses,



auto-rickshaws, e-rickshaws and Gramin Seva vehicles for onwards journeys from the metro station.

Traffic police said in a statement that unregulated parking and haphazard stopping of public transport vehicles were reducing the available carriageway and affecting the movement of pedestrians and other road users.

Following the inspection, a committee comprising representatives of auto-rickshaw and e-rickshaw drivers has been constituted to improve coordination and ensure compliance with traffic discipline norms.

## MPD plans more commercial activity along wider roads

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

The Master Plan Delhi (MPD)-2047 proposes allowing commercial activity on residential plots along roads wider than 30 metres, even if the roads are not officially notified as mixed-use or commercial streets. This means no new mixed use or commercial streets will be notified in Delhi over the next two decades, with only those already notified by the Delhi government continuing to permit the commercial activities allowed on them so far.

The provision in the master plan effectively freezes the current list of 2,183 notified mixed-use streets and 355 notified commercial streets across the city, without scope for expansion through fresh notifications over the plan's tenure up to 2047. Interestingly, the master plan



remains silent on 351 roads awaiting notification as mixed-use and commercial streets, leaving traders worried. A proposal was passed and forwarded to the Delhi government by MCD in 2007, but the clearance and notification remain pending.

The master plan further adds that commercial activi-

ty will be allowed on the ground floor or the first floor above still parking on residential plots abutting roads with a right of way (ROW) of more than 30 metres, subject to payment of applicable charges.

The provision will apply across all categories of residential colonies and allow all

types of commercial activities, except those involving hazardous, inflammable, polluting or otherwise incompatible substances or processes. Existing mixed-use and commercial streets already notified by the Delhi government will continue to operate under the activities currently permitted on them.

The plan, however, does not extend the mixed-use policy to areas such as the Lutyens' Bungalow Zone, Civil Lines Bungalow Zone, Government and institutional housing, staff housing and listed heritage buildings or precincts. Separate rules will continue to govern non-residential activities in these areas.

Under the existing notified-street system, mixed-use streets allow commercial activity only on the ground floor, while commercial streets can use the entire

permissible floor area ratio (FAR) for commercial purposes. The plan says mixed use is intended to bring shops and other services closer to residential areas and reduce the need for people to travel long distances. At the same time, it acknowledges that unchecked commercial activity can increase traffic, congestion and pressure on civic infrastructure.

It also says any change in the earlier A-to-H categorisation of residential colonies, which was used to determine mixed-use permissions, will require prior approval of the central government. Traders have raised their concerns regarding a few provisions of the new master plan, as the provisions assume Delhi's population will grow to around 3.2 crore by 2047, raising demand for housing, jobs, infrastructure and commercial spaces.

## Narrow Delhi streets to become pedestrian shopping streets under MPD 2047

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

Streets with a width of six metres or less will be mandatorily declared pedestrian shopping streets under the Master Plan for Delhi (MPD) 2047, which proposes several measures to promote walking and non-motorised transport.

The plan, notified by the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs, stipulates fully segregated space for pedestrian and non-motorised traffic (NMT) movements along all arterial roads with 45-metre and above right of way (ROW), subject to feasibility.

Arterial roads provide long-distance mobility, connecting one part of the city to another, and carry high volumes of traffic. The plan



also recommends segregated pedestrian space on sub-arterial roads with 30-45 metre ROW, subject to feasibility. Local streets with less than 12-metre ROW in city neighbourhoods will be designed for a mix of slow-moving traffic, NMT or pedestrianised streets, according to the master plan.

Road safety audits will be conducted annually by road-owning agencies and traffic police to create a safe travel

environment, particularly for pedestrians, NMT users and two-wheelers.

A key feature of the master plan is the development of Active Travel Areas (ATAs) in places with high pedestrian footfall, including commercial spaces, heritage precincts, streets and areas identified for a 24X7 economy. Active travel routes will also be identified in areas with a high share of pedestrians and cyclists.

Active travel involves physical activity such as walking and cycling for travelling from one place to another. Agencies will identify specific high-footfall areas as 'pedestrian-only' or 'NMT-only' zones. Tactical urbanism measures may be adopted to transform streets into fully pedestrian zones, the plan says.

## 4-year UG programme students with 7.5 CGPA can directly enrol in PhD: Delhi University

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

In a special measure for the first batch of students completing four-year undergraduate programmes (FYUP), the University of Delhi will allow those securing a minimum of 7.5 CGPA (7 CGPA for SC/ST) to directly enrol in PhD programmes.

The decision comes as the first batch of students admitted under the Four-Year Undergraduate Programme (FYUP), introduced in 2022-23 under the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020, completes the four-year course this academic session.

"In the interest of the first batch of students who have completed the FYUP in 2026, the University will admit students who have 7.5 CGPA (7 CGPA for SC/ST) and above in the FYUP directly to the PhD programme only for the academic session 2026-27 as a special measure as per rules of the University,"



DU said in a press release on Friday. The move follows a recommendation in an Academic Council agenda to create supernumerary seats for FYUP graduates seeking direct admission to PhD programmes.

The proposal had suggested eligibility for undergraduate students completing four-year programmes with at least 6 CGPA for UR/OBC/EWS candidates and 5.5 CGPA for SC/ST/PwBD candidates, along with at least one research publication in a Scopus-indexed journal as the first, second or corre-

sponding author. The proposal also stated that a faculty member who supervised a student's undergraduate research could continue as the student's PhD guide, if the student wished to continue under them and the faculty member had a PhD degree and a research laboratory, wherever applicable.

DU Registrar Vikas Gupta said the university was considering relaxing the rules for the first batch of students.

"This is for the first batch of FYUP students. We are considering relaxing the

rules, so they will not require the publication of a research article. Consequently, the students who have completed the fourth year in their UG can opt for a one-year or two-year PG programme or even take the PhD route, subject to the eligibility," Gupta said.

The university said it had already amended its ordinances, with the approval of the Academic Council and Executive Council, to enable fourth-year students to apply directly for PhD programmes after completing their FYUP.

For the 2026-27 admissions, the university has, however, set a higher CGPA threshold of 7.5, or 7 for SC/ST students.

DU said it had rolled out the FYUP in 2022-23 under the Undergraduate Curriculum Framework 2022, based on NEP 2020, with the optional fourth year intended to bring research and entrepreneurship into undergraduate education.

## Retired Army Colonel loses ₹15.5 Lakh in digital arrest fraud, four arrested

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

A retired Indian Army colonel was cheated of ₹15.50 lakh by fraudsters who kept him under a "digital arrest" by posing as police and enforcement officials, Delhi Police said on Friday. The police announced the arrest of four people accused of supplying bank accounts used in the scam.

Police said the four accused had been supplying mule bank accounts to cyber fraud networks with links to operators based in Cambodia and the UAE. They were arrested in Punjab and Rajasthan, and police recovered four mobile phones and six SIM cards allegedly used in the crime.

According to police, the bank account into which the retired colonel transferred the money has been linked to 17 separate complaints filed on the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal



across multiple states and union territories, involving fraudulent transactions worth crores of rupees.

The case came to light after the victim, a resident of Munirka Enclave, filed a complaint alleging he had been cheated of ₹15.50 lakh, a senior police officer said.

Police said the fraud began on April 15, when the victim received a call from a person claiming his telephone connection would be disconnected on the orders of Maharashtra Police. He was then transferred to another number, where a second caller, posing as a police officer, told him his personal details had been

used to open an illegal bank account in Mumbai linked to money laundering, investment fraud and terrorist financing.

To lend credibility to the claims, the accused allegedly sent the victim forged documents, including a fake Enforcement Directorate arrest warrant, fabricated court papers, an anticipatory bail document, and fraudulent communication purportedly from the Bombay High Court and the Reserve Bank of India, the officer said.

The victim and his wife were then placed under sustained psychological pressure, described by police as a "digital arrest," during which he was made to share details of his assets and eventually transferred ₹15.50 lakh, believing he was complying with instructions from the Reserve Bank of India.

An e-FIR was registered on April 19 at the Cyber Police Station in the Southwest district, following which police

began tracing the money trail, beneficiary accounts and digital footprints.

Investigators traced the funds to a current bank account in Ludhiana held by accused Sarbjit, 38, who was arrested and told police he had handed over his account to Suraj, 30, after being contacted through Sandeep, 32, a bank employee.

Suraj later transferred the account to another accused, Naresh alias Lucky, whom he had contacted through social media. Police said Sarbjit, Suraj and Sandeep travelled to Jaipur to hand over the account details to Naresh, who allegedly supplied it to cyber fraud operators abroad.

Acting on these leads, police raided Rajasthan and arrested Naresh, a resident of Sikar, who told investigators he sourced current accounts from Suraj and passed them on to fraud operators in Cambodia and the UAE.

## IN FOCUS



A common myna feeds a fledgling Asian koel perched on a rooftop in Morigaon district of Assam on Friday

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ Ayodhya

Dr Anil Mishra, a former member of the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust, spoke to the media for the first time on Friday since the recent controversy over alleged embezzlement and misuse of offerings at the Ram temple. On the first anniversary of the daily Ramkot Parikrama, Mishra said that the ritual is closely connected to the faith of Ram devotees and Ayodhya's old religious traditions.

"Ramkot Parikrama is linked to the faith of Ram devotees and religious tradition," Mishra said. He explained that doing the Ramkot parikrama covers the sacred routes of Lord Ram, Hanuman Garhi, and other major temples in Ayodhya. "This is not just an organised event," he said. "It is based on



the deep devotion of Ram bhaktas and Ayodhya's long religious history."

Thousands of devotees and hundreds of saints joined the morning procession, which started at the Jagadguru Ramanandacharya entrance gate and followed a 3.5-kilometre route through the main Ramkot area. As they passed important sites like Kanak Bhawan, Dashrath Mahal, and other temples, participants chanted "Jai Shri Ram" and sang devotional hymns. The

route goes through the historic area linked to Lord Ram's kingdom.

The daily Nitya Ramkot Parikrama began a year ago, thanks to the trust and local saints. It turned an occasional tradition into a regular morning ritual that now attracts over a thousand people most days. Mishra, who resigned from the trust during the donation controversy, led the anniversary procession. He appeared in public soon after the Special

Investigation Team (SIT) gave its final report on the alleged diversion of cash and valuables from temple hundi to the trust.

The controversy began in June when claims of regular theft during the counting of offerings came up. Eight people involved in handling the cash were arrested, and nearly 780 lakh was recovered. Mishra and then-general secretary Champat Rai resigned, saying they were taking moral responsibility, while the investigation continued. After finishing the parikrama, Mishra spoke briefly to reporters but did not comment on the investigation or the trust's internal matters.

Instead, Mishra talked about the spiritual and cultural value of the parikrama. Devotees and local saints welcomed his presence at the event. Ramesh Das, the

senior priest of Hanuman Garhi, wished him well and hoped the temple administration would keep improving systems for pilgrims. The Ramkot area, seen as the heart of old Ayodhya, includes the Ram Janmabhoomi temple complex and over a hundred other shrines.

According to tradition, completing the full circuit gives the same merit as visiting many sacred sites at once. Since the Ram temple was consecrated in January 2024, many more devotees have come, and organisers see the regular parikrama as a way to deepen visitors' spiritual experience from all over India. Locals and regular participants said the anniversary was especially meaningful. Many believe that the daily practice over the past year has built a sense of community among saints,

residents, and pilgrims.

The route starts early in the morning and ends near the main temple entrance. It has become a regular part of life, with flower showers and sankirtan on special days. On Friday, Mishra's careful comments showed that religious life in Ayodhya continues, even as questions about temple management are still being looked at.

While the SIT's findings and the trust's next steps may affect future management, Mishra chose to focus on the lasting connection between the parikrama and the faith that supports it.

As the procession ended and people left, the mood stayed calm and devotional. For many, the day showed that traditions like the Ramkot Parikrama transcend controversy and are rooted in centuries of respect for Lord Ram.

## Ban on construction activities in Delhi from December 10 to January 20 to curb air pollution

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

Construction activities will be completely banned in Delhi from December 10 to January 20 as part of the Government's measures to curb air pollution during the winter season, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said on Friday.

In a post on X, Gupta urged citizens to report violations, saying construction sites measuring above 500 square metres would be monitored through the Delhi Government's Dust Portal and AI-enabled cameras. "Construction will be com-



pletely banned from 10 December to 20 January. If you spot any violation, inform MCD, your MLA, or me directly," she said. Gupta said that during the previous winter, construction activities

had continued at some sites despite the implementation of the Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP), with work being carried out behind covers. "Last time, even under GRAP, some construction con-

tinued behind covers," she said. This year, such sites will be monitored in real time through the Dust Portal and AI-enabled cameras, with alerts being sent to the Government's Control and Command Centre, she said.

"Notices, warnings and fines will follow," Gupta wrote, urging people to "inform, tag, complain and stop them". The Delhi Government had in July launched the AI-powered Dust Portal 2.0 to strengthen monitoring of construction and demolition sites and improve enforcement of dust pollution control measures.

## Haryana Chief Minister Saini issues directions for registration of farmers on AgriStack platform

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Chandigarh

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Friday directed all districts to complete the targeted registration of farmers on the AgriStack platform within the next three days, setting August 24 evening as the deadline.

He directed deputy commissioners to assign specific targets to officials and employees of the revenue and agriculture departments and ensure that the registration drive is completed on a war footing. The AgriStack platform has been developed by the Central Government to enable farmers to access benefits under various central and state government schemes swiftly and effectively.

Farmers registered on the platform will be provided a unique Farmer ID,



while their agricultural land parcels will be linked with digital records, according to an official statement.

The CM issued these directions while reviewing the progress of AgriStack, digital crop survey and auto-mutation

at a meeting held. Saini said the Central Government has introduced AgriStack to ensure that benefits under various schemes reach farmers effectively.

Under the platform, every farmer is being provided a unique Farmer ID, while parcels of agricultural land belonging to the farmer are linked with digital land records. The platform will maintain a digital record of which crop has been sown by a farmer in a particular field. It will also facilitate digital and geographical mapping of villages and agricultural land, he stated. Saini said AgriStack will help deliver services under PM-KISAN, crop insurance, agricultural credit, MSP-based procurement, distribution of fertilisers and seeds, and other Government schemes more effectively to eligible farmers.

## CJP team on school inspection forcibly sent back from Rajasthan village; Dipke claims BJP goons behind attack

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ Jaipur

A Cockroach Janta Party team that had gone to inspect a Government school in a Rajasthan village on Friday was attacked and forcibly pushed back allegedly by locals, resulting in a scuffle with the youth group warning of a bigger protest in the state if the attackers are not arrested within 48 hours and an order restricting outsiders entry into schools is

not revoked. The incident took place in Rampura Kanwarpura village in Jaipur district when the CJP team, as part of its ongoing 'School Thik Karo' campaign to inspect the condition of Government schools and interact with students and teachers, faced opposition.

The CJP claimed its workers were attacked and pelted with stones by "BJP goons", with CJP convener Abhijeet Dipke slamming the police for being "mute spectators

while goons attacked CJP volunteers". DCP (South) Rajarshi Verma did not respond to calls while Bagru DSP Dharmendra Sharma earlier in the day said he was not aware of any such development. School Education Minister Madan Dilawar alleged that the CJP wants to create disturbance in Rajasthan similar to what it did at Jantar Mantar.

CJP co-convener Ashutosh Ranka alleged that despite members of his team being



Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) co-convener Ashutosh Ranka addresses the media during the party's 'School Thik Karo' campaign in Jaipur

assaulted, vehicles damaged and women supporters roughed up, the police did not intervene.

The state education department had issued a directive on Monday, restricting unauthorised entry, photography and videography in Government schools after CJP announced it would visit schools across Rajasthan. The CJP team had planned to visit two Government schools on Friday. Giving an ultimatum to the Government, Ranka

said, "We are giving you 48 hours. All these people should be arrested, and the order restricting outsider entry into schools should be withdrawn. Otherwise, this movement will go beyond education and target Madan Dilawar."

Dipke, in a post on X, asked, "Goons of BJP are after the blood of Ashutosh and other CJP volunteers. How can @PoliceRajasthan allow this kind of attack?"

Videos of the incident

showed a large number of people engaging in a heated exchange with the CJP team, pushing and shoving its members as they tried to enter the village. Some clips also showed smashed windows of cars, believed to belong to the visiting CJP team.

"All levels of disgust were crossed today. For the past several years, the school at Rampura Kanwarpura has been running from a buffalo shed.

## FROM PAGE - 1

### Rahul's dharna spurs FIR in pellet gun case

Targeting the Home Minister, Rahul asked why Shah is so afraid of justice.

"There are pellets in his body, and he cannot even see, as he has suffered injuries in his eye. This is injustice to this youngster. For almost a month, he has been calling for the registration of an FIR and moving from one police station to another. Turning to the victim's mother, who also sat on the protest, Rahul asked her, "Are you happy now?" The Congress leader, who had earlier alleged that police are "under pressure from the top" for not registering a complaint, claimed that the FIR was lodged only after clearance from top authorities in the Home Ministry.

Visuals showed Rahul walking into the police station with Lochab and others, taking the officials by surprise. As the cops refused to register an FIR, Rahul staged a sit-in outside the police station in protest. Rahul said he would stay put at the police station until the complaint was formally registered.

As the sit-in dragged on for several hours, a waiting Rahul Gandhi, along with the victim, stepped in front of a swarm of cameras and microphones and held up a small plastic box. Opening the box, he spilt the contents onto his palm and showed them to the reporters. "Ye hai pellets, dekh lijiye inko, achhi tarah se dekh lijiye, ye hain pellets (These are pellets; take a look at them - look at them closely - these are pellets)," he said. This was the first time the pellets were displayed publicly.

Where did they (pellets) come from? The Congress leader asked and then answered it himself. Ye inke shareer se aaye (These came from his body)," Gandhi said, urging the student to show the injuries. The Student, who was wearing dark glasses, then rolled up his T-shirt sleeve and showed the injuries. "Ye inke yahan lage hain charre. 200 charre inke shareer ke andar hain aur teen charre inki aankh main hai (These pellets are lodged in his body. There are 200 pellets inside him and three are lodged in his eye)," Rahul said.

Meanwhile, the Delhi Police said that an FIR has been registered under sections 118 (voluntarily causing hurt or grievous hurt by dangerous weapons or means) and 25 (act endangering life or personal safety of others) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita. The Delhi Police had earlier informed the protesting Congress leader that the Supreme Court has constituted a High-Powered Expert Committee (HPEC) to examine allegations of excessive and disproportionate use of force by the police and

paramilitary forces during the student protests, as it refused to file the FIR.

The high drama by Rahul Gandhi led to a political slugfest between the BJP and the Congress here. Addressing a press conference here, senior BJP leader and MP Ravi Shankar Prasad claimed that Gandhi was staging the protest to divert attention as the Congress had realised that its stand on the Vande Mataram issue was wrong. "I have my doubts and allegations that the Congress is trapped over its stand on Vande Mataram and is trying to divert attention," he told reporters here. Prasad added that the matter was also before a high-powered committee constituted by the Supreme Court in connection with the case. "Congress has become a party driven by Rahul Gandhi's appeasement politics," Prasad said. Accusing the ruling party of communalising the situation in the country, evading accountability and raising non-issues, the Congress asserted that the dharna would continue till an FIR is registered by Delhi Police over pellet injuries suffered by a youth, 19-year-old Sahil Lochab, during the CJP-led July 20 protest. "Our demand is simple -- register an FIR and give us the FIR number. LoR Rahul Gandhi is giving voice to this demand," Congress general secretary in-charge of communications Jairam Ramesh told reporters at the Parliament Street police station.

### Delhi embraces urban farming for a greener...

It adds that expanded green-blue infrastructure can improve living environments and quality of life. The plan envisages these initiatives not merely as a way of growing vegetables but as part of efforts to increase greenery within Delhi's built environment. It encourages green features such as roof gardens, terrace gardens and green walls in buildings and plots. Local bodies and the Delhi Government may also consider tax incentives for maintaining green roofs and vertical greenery in existing buildings and reconstructed plots.

The plan links greater green cover with several environmental benefits, including lower temperatures, reduced pollution, better biodiversity and greater resilience to climate change. It also says expanded green-blue infrastructure can improve living environments and quality of life. Urban farming could also help make use of spaces that otherwise remain underutilised. The plan specifically proposes grass and shrub cover on vacant land as a measure to reduce dust and allows such plots to be used for urban farming and gardening in the interim.

The plan, however, leaves implementation largely to local bodies, agencies and communities, which will have to develop appropriate guidelines and ensure that activities such as rooftop and vertical farming meet structural and other safety requirements.

The push for urban farming comes as the master plan seeks to increase green spaces and green-blue features within Delhi's built-up areas while addressing pollution, rising temperatures and the pressures of urbanisation.

### Back-channel talks underway on PM...

The uncertainty surrounding the visit was also reflected in an official communication from Rashtrapati Bhavan earlier on Friday. The communication, which had referred to the cancellation of Saturday's Change of Guard ceremony to facilitate a full rehearsal for Rahman's ceremonial welcome, was subsequently withdrawn.

According to people familiar with the matter, discussions between the two governments remain underway as officials work towards resolving the outstanding issues and determining a fresh schedule for the visit.

Amid the continuing uncertainty, Trivedi met Bangladesh Finance Minister Amir Khosru Mahmud Chowdhury. Their discussions covered bilateral development projects and other matters of mutual interest.

The proposed visit comes against the backdrop of renewed strains in India-Bangladesh relations. New Delhi said earlier this week that it wants to develop "positive and constructive" relations with Dhaka, guided by mutual interests and reciprocity.

Tensions increased after former Bangladesh Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina addressed a virtual media interaction from New Delhi on August 5. Dhaka subsequently renewed its demand for her extradition and sought to connect the issue with Rahman's prospective visit to India.

India has maintained that it had no role in organising Hasina's media interaction and did not endorse the remarks made during the event. The Bangladesh Government, however, reacted strongly, saying it was angered that the interaction had been allowed to take place despite Dhaka having communicated its concerns to New Delhi about the possible impact on bilateral relations.

Hasina, 78, has been living in India since August 2024, when she left Bangladesh amid large-scale student-led protests that brought an end to her

long tenure in power. During Friday's briefing, Jaishwal was also asked about the 1996 Ganga Water Treaty between India and Bangladesh.

He noted that the agreement was signed for a 30-year period and said river-related matters between the two countries are addressed through the Joint Rivers Commission.

Jaishwal added that meetings of the Joint Committee established under the Ganga Water Treaty continue to take place at the technical level. The ongoing diplomatic engagement indicates that both New Delhi and Dhaka are continuing discussions despite recent disagreements, with the timing of Rahman's India visit still to be settled.

### Political stability makes India a bright spot...

"Earlier, the approach to regulations was 'prohibited unless permitted' - meaning you could not do something unless the government permitted you. We are changing this approach to 'permitted unless prohibited'. That means, for anything that is not explicitly prohibited by law, there should be no need to seek permission at every step."

He said the shift was intended to recast the relationship between the state, citizens and businesses around trust rather than suspicion.

"The relationship between the Government and citizens should be based not on suspicion, but on trust," PM Modi added.

The Prime Minister also highlighted legislative work undertaken during the Monsoon Session of Parliament.

In the Monsoon Session of Parliament, we have passed the Bankers' Books Evidence Bill, even as the Opposition has continued to create disruptions in Parliament. We did not allow the work of serving the country to stop," he said.

"We are not just changing regulations; we are changing the entire policy of regulations," PM Modi said.

### Mamata hindered border security measures...

"Today, we inaugurated projects worth Rs 179 crore focused on the SSB's infrastructure and administrative needs. Whether it is the SSB, Assam Rifles or the BSF, forces that guard our borders are always the top priority of the Union Home Ministry," Shah said, reminding how the Government had taken all measures to make the Siliguri Corridor impregnable with addition-

al deployment of forces and conducting exercises like Teesta Prahar.

Praising the Adhikari Government for its sustained "effort to turn Bengal into a Sonar Bangla" once again, the Home Minister said, "Suvendu ji is doing a great job towards stopping infiltration and establishing rule of law in Bengal." He said, "Today Bengal has come a long way from cadre raj of the Left to goonda raj of the Trinamool Congress to rule of law of BJP."

The Home Minister also praised the Bengal Government for facilitating the implementation of the Citizenship Amendment Act. "Mamata ji blocked its passage in Bengal, but now the people of Bengal are realising the benefits of the Act ... which is, however, not meant for the illegal infiltrators --- not mentioned in the CAA --- whom the Government is determined to find and deport," Shah said.

He also praised the Adhikari Government for quick implementation of the three criminal laws in the State. "We brought BNS, BNSS and BSA replacing the colonial laws like IPC, CrPC and BSA... but despite these laws being in force in the rest of the country, the Mamata Banerjee Government stonewalled its implementation in Bengal... but today these laws have been officially implemented in the State," he said.

Earlier, the Chief Minister too vouched for his intention to implement all the pro-people policies of the Centre. "When I became the Chief Minister, I cleared three files immediately: the one on clearance of land for border security, two files on conducting the census, which is in process and three on the implementation of the new laws BNS, BNSS and BSA," he said.

### 2 ships hijacked off Yemen, Somalia...

According to the official, eight pirates armed with AK-47-type weapons approached the vessel in two skiffs and boarded it.

The crew initially moved to the vessel's designated citadel, a secure area used during pirate attacks. However, the pirates managed to enter the citadel and later took the crew to the bridge. The vessel remains under the control of the pirates. No injuries among the crew have been reported so far.

The two incidents underline the continuing risks faced by commercial shipping and seafarers operating in waters around the Gulf of Aden and the Horn of Africa, where pirate attacks have periodically threatened international maritime traffic.

# Jharkhand exam protest turns violent in Ranchi

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ Ranchi

A scuffle broke out on Friday between police and students protesting against alleged Jharkhand recruitment exam irregularities in Ranchi, with the agitators attempting to burn effigies of Chief Minister Hemant Soren and Congress leader Rahul Gandhi, officials said. Student leaders under the banner of the 'JPSC-JSSC Reforms Manch' have accused the Jharkhand Government of "deceiving" and "betraying" job aspirants, after the high court stayed some notifications cancelling appointments through the 11th and 13th JPSC exams besides the JSSC-CGL.

"They gathered in large number at the prominent Albert Chowk to burn effigies of CM Soren and Rahul Gandhi. When the police tried to control them, a scuffle broke out... JMM workers were also present at the spot," an official said. Officer-in-charge of Lalpur Police Station, Rupesh Kumar Singh, said the scuffle broke out after protesting students changed the designated route and brought traffic to a halt. "The students changed the route defined for the march and effigy burning... They went to the JPSC office and brought traffic to a halt there. The agitators did not listen to our repeated pleas to adhere to the designated route,"



Security personnel try to control the situation after a clash between members of the JPSC-JSSC Reforms Manch and Jharkhand Mukti Morcha (JMM) workers during an effigy-burning protest against Jharkhand Chief Minister Hemant Soren at Albert Ekka Chowk in Ranchi, Jharkhand on Friday

Singh said. The student leaders alleged that the police and workers of the ruling Jharkhand Mukti Morcha (JMM) tried to prevent them from holding a peaceful march.

"They cannot stop us from holding peaceful and democratic protests," JPSC-JSSC Reforms Manch leader Ravindra Paswan said. Piyush Kumar Singh,

another student leader, claimed that one of the core committee members of the Manch, Kunal, was detained by the police, but he fainted and was subsequently taken to Sadar Hospital. The agitators also alleged that even female protesters were thrashed during the scuffle by JMM workers. Similar incidents were reported from Hazaribag and Giridih, where JMM workers clashed with students trying to burn effigies of Soren. Meanwhile, JLMK leader Devendra Nath Mahto said it would launch a 'Recruitment System Reforms Yatra' from August 24, alleging that the Jharkhand Government was not strongly defending cases related to the cancellation of

several recruitment examinations in the high court. He warned that if the Government failed to effectively present its case before the Jharkhand High Court on September 15, when matters are scheduled for hearing, they would plan to gherao the chief minister's residence. The high court on Friday stayed notifications cancelling the appointments of Child Development Project Officers (CDPOs) and those recruited through the JSSC-CGL examination. On Thursday, the court had stayed notifications cancelling the 11th and 13th Jharkhand Public Service Commission (JPSC) examinations, and also stayed the order cancelling the appointments of food safety officers.

## Rahul Gandhi doing his job as LoP by making Govt accountable: Omar

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ Srinagar

Defending Rahul Gandhi's aggressive posture against the ruling dispensation, Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah on Friday asserted that the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha is simply fulfilling his constitutional duty by holding the Government accountable.

Talking to reporters after inaugurating a 'waste to wonder' themed garden near Polo View, Abdullah said, "If the Leader of the Opposition does not oppose, what good is he?"

When asked questions about Gandhi's repeated protests, he took a dig at the media for applying double standards when evaluating opposition leaders and pointed out that while journalists appear to enjoy the "needless" questioning raised by the Leader of Opposition in Jammu and Kashmir Sunil Sharma, they routinely question Gandhi's motives for mounting similar challenges against the Central Government.

"I haven't heard you ask the Leader of the Opposition in J-K why he keeps asking the same questions repeatedly.



When Mr Sharma does it, you enjoy it; but when Rahul Gandhi does it, you ask, 'Why is Rahul Gandhi doing this?' "You cannot weigh opposition leaders by different standards like this. Rahul Gandhi is simply doing what the country expects of him," Abdullah said. He stressed that the primary function of an opposition leader is to demand answers from those in power and expressed hope that Gandhi would continue to press the administration on key national issues. "The job of the Leader of the Opposition is to hold the Government accountable. Rahul Gandhi is doing just that, and I hope he continues to do so, because that is precisely the role of the opposition," he added. Referring to alleged

remarks by Sharma concerning the spread of Islam in the region, the chief minister remarked that his Government's administration must be performing exceptionally well if the state opposition leader could find no governance issues to criticise and had instead resorted to giving discourses on religious history. "I will only say this: our Government's performance must be remarkably good, given that the Leader of the Opposition found nothing to criticise about this administration. Now, he is shedding light on how Islam originated in Jammu and Kashmir. I consider this our success," Abdullah said. However, he asserted that Sharma should refrain from commenting on religious affairs.

## BRICS tourism ministers adopt Jaipur Declaration to deepen cooperation

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ Jaipur

The BRICS Tourism Ministers' meeting, under India's chairship, concluded in Jaipur on Friday with the adoption of the BRICS Tourism Ministers' Communique 2026, also known as the Jaipur Declaration, aimed at strengthening tourism cooperation among member countries.

The meeting, chaired by Union Culture and Tourism Minister Gajendra Singh Shekhawat, marked the culmination of the BRICS Tourism Track under India's 2026 chairship, which was conducted under the theme "Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability." Tourism ministers and heads of delegation from nine BRICS member states participated in the meeting. Ministerial participation included Brazil's Tourism Minister Gustavo Costa Feliciando, Iran's Minister of Cultural Heritage, Tourism and Handicrafts Reza Salehi Amir, South Africa's Tourism Minister Patricia De Lille and UAE's Minister of Economy and Tourism Abdulla Bin Touq Al Marri. Heads of delegation from



China, Ethiopia, Indonesia and Russia also attended the meeting. The Indian delegation included Tourism Secretary Bhuvnesh Kumar and Joint Secretary Harikishore S, among other officials. The Jaipur Declaration builds on the work undertaken by the BRICS Tourism Working Group during India's chairship and focuses on four key priorities: artificial intelligence and tourism, sustainability and responsible tourism, tourism skill and capacity building, and tourism exchanges and seamless travel facilitation. The communique, adopted by consensus, recognises the potential of responsible, safe and human-centred artificial intelligence and digital technologies to transform

tourism. It calls for cooperation among BRICS countries in areas such as tourism planning, destination management, visitor services, multilingual communication and travel facilitation. The declaration also emphasises sustainable and community-centred tourism, protection of natural and cultural heritage, tourism investment and infrastructure development, and promotion of diverse tourism products. It further calls for continuous skill and upskilling of tourism professionals, stronger industry-academia partnerships, exchange of tourism data and statistics, sharing of best practices and enhanced people-to-people connectivity among BRICS countries.

## Jitendra Singh calls for future-ready framework to address global challenges



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ Chennai

Union Minister Jitendra Singh on Friday called for a future-ready framework to address global challenges and support the developmental aspirations of the Global South. Inaugurating the 14th BRICS Science, Technology, and Innovation (STI) Ministerial Meeting here, the Minister of State for Science and Technology, said India as the Chair for 2026 BRICS Presidency under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, has adopted the overarching theme: "Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability." He stressed that science and technology must serve as vehicles for driving inclusive economic growth, enhancing climate resilience, and establishing equitable international partnerships. Highlighting the rapid global shift toward emerging domains - including Artificial Intelligence (AI), quantum computing, biotechnology, and advanced materials — Singh stressed that international collaboration is essential to ensure scientific breakthroughs remain accessible, affordable, trusted, and sustainable. He invited member nations to pursue actionable pathways in frontier research,

infrastructure sharing, startup partnerships, and talent mobility to build a robust, responsive innovation ecosystem for the future. The Minister said cooperation among BRICS partners can help create a future-ready BRICS STI architecture that is responsive to global challenges and supportive of the aspirations of the Global South. Later, speaking to reporters he said, "we have had a very fruitful, very constructive and very productive BRICS Science, Technology and Innovation meeting, represented by the Science Ministers of the various member countries of BRICS." "In the true spirit of cooperation, collaboration and collective effort, we aim to create innovation for the welfare of the rest of the world as well, and more so for the betterment of the citizens of the BRICS countries. We have followed the theme of building an innovation system that is resilient, sustainable and guided by the spirit of what Prime Minister Modi keeps reiterating, 'Vishwa Bandhu Bharat'," he said. Jitendra Singh expressed confidence that the deliberations in Chennai would further strengthen the spirit of BRICS partnership and contribute meaningfully to a more innovative, resilient and sustainable world.

## 1,499 auto, taxi drivers get notices over lack of working knowledge of Marathi

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ Mumbai

On the second day of the state-wide drive, the Regional Transport Offices (RTOs) issued notices to 1,499 non-Marathi-speaking auto-rickshaw and taxi drivers across Maharashtra on Friday for not having enough working knowledge of Marathi language. A senior official said 5,299 auto-rickshaw and taxi drivers were subjected to the language test across Maharashtra, excluding the Mumbai Metropolitan Region (MMR), of whom 777 were found to be

lacking the working knowledge of Marathi. "Notices were issued to all such drivers," he said. In the MMR, 3,482 drivers were assessed, of whom 722 failed to clear the test, and notices were issued to 622 of them, the official said. The exercise, which began on Thursday, is being carried out as part of the Transport Department's drive to ensure that auto-rickshaw and taxi drivers possess working knowledge of Marathi. On the first day of the month-long drive, 8,217 drivers were put to test and 1,268 commercial passenger



vehicle drivers, including auto-rickshaw and taxi drivers, were issued notices for failing the language proficiency test. Of these, 604

notices were issued in the MMR. According to the RTO officials, checks are being carried out by flying squads

as well as during the renewal of vehicle fitness certificates at RTO offices. During the exercise, the drivers are being put through a 16-question test based on everyday situations, including communicating with passengers about destinations, directions, fares, meters, routes and stands. The drive will continue till September 30. The move follows the state Government's decision to make working knowledge of Marathi mandatory for taxi and auto-rickshaw drivers. The state has also amended the

Maharashtra Motor Vehicles Rules, 1989, to give effect to the requirement. The Government had earlier launched Marathi-language training for non-Marathi-speaking drivers, with 1.65 lakh drivers completing the course and receiving certificates during a 105-day campaign. However, some drivers' union leaders and retired RTO officials have questioned the lack of a clear definition and standardised benchmark for "working knowledge" of Marathi, saying this could lead to arbitrary assessments.

## Bihar facing serious financial crisis, claims Tejashwi Yadav

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ Patna

Bihar's Leader of Opposition Tejashwi Yadav on Friday said the state's fiscal situation has become a matter of "serious concern", with public debt rising sharply and fiscal deficit touching 5.8 per cent of GSDP. Describing the situation as a "serious financial crisis", the RJD leader accused the BJP-led NDA Government of corruption and financial mismanagement, alleging that it was incapable of addressing the state's mounting fiscal challenges. "Bihar's fiscal situation has become a matter of serious concern, with the state's public debt rising sharply and the fiscal deficit touching 5.8 per cent of Gross State Domestic Product (GSDP) in 2025-26, the highest among major states. The state is passing through a serious financial crisis," he said in a social media post. Yadav claimed that funds were falling short for timely payments to Government



employees and pensioners, social security pensions, contractors and developmental programmes. He also claimed that allocations under the Student Credit Card scheme have been reduced and scholarships are being curtailed. Yadav said Bihar's revenue deficit is rising alongside a mounting debt burden, and claimed that the NDA Government lacks a long-term strategy to boost revenue collection, strengthen budgetary management and contain the fiscal deficit. He alleged that the state Government had raised record debt over the past two years despite the treasury being under severe strain.

## India rejects remarks by USCIRF officials

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

India on Friday trashed remarks by senior officials of US Commission on International Religious Freedom (USCIRF) calling for sanctions against the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) and asked Washington not to extend diplomatic courtesies to its leaders. External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal, rejecting the remarks described the USCIRF as a "biased" organisation. "We are all aware that the organisation that you are referring to has been making disparaging and inflammatory remarks about India," he said at his bi-weekly media briefing. "It is a biased organisation. I would say that we should keep away from such organisations as they have their own agenda and lack any credibility," he said. Jaiswal was responding to a question on the remarks by the USCIRF officials. USCIRF Commissioner Gene Mills said RSS leaders,



even when affiliated with the Indian Government, should not be honoured with high-level meetings or diplomatic courtesies. "Instead, the USG (US Government) should focus on imposing sanctions on RSS members found responsible for FoRB (freedom of religious belief) violations," Mills said. USCIRF chair Asif Mahmood described RSS as an umbrella organisation whose sub-groups have perpetrated attacks on religious minorities. USCIRF posted the remarks by Mahmood and Mills on its X account.

In March, the USCIRF annual report criticised India for alleged violations of religious freedom and backed "targeted sanctions" on individuals and entities such as the RSS and Research and Analysis Wing, holding them responsible for the matter. In its recommendation, the USCIRF also called for designating India as a "country of particular concern" or CPC, for engaging in and "tolerating systematic, ongoing, and egregious religious freedom violations, as defined by the International Religious Freedom Act (IRFA)".

## National symbols should not be politicised, says Himachal CM

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ Shimla

Himachal Pradesh Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu on Friday alleged that the BJP MLAs insulted the National Anthem by raising objections regarding the tradition of singing the National Anthem before the National Song. He emphasised that the National Anthem commands its own respect, and the National Song is also sung in the House with full dignity. The chief minister remarked that both the National Song and the National Anthem have always been accorded respect, from schools to public events. The chief minister said that the manner in which the controversy over the National Song has been "manufactured" has caused resentment among the public. He urged the BJP not to "stoop to such a low level of politics" that the issue of respecting national symbols becomes a subject of political confrontation.

### Nation Focus



## Odisha floods ease as rivers recede; heavy rain alert issued

The flood situation in Odisha showed signs of improvement on Friday as water levels in major rivers receded below their danger marks amid no significant rainfall, allowing the state Government to speed up restoration work. However, the respite may be short-lived. The India Meteorological Department has forecast a wet spell from Friday to August 27, including heavy rain in coastal and northern Odisha, already hit by a second round of floods this year. The state Government, in a statement, said it faced a challenging task during its rescue and relief operations in flood-hit districts of Balasore, Bhadrak, Jajpur, Kendrapara, Mayurbhanj and Keonjhar, where more than 13.44 lakh people were affected. (PTI)



## Govt announces National Teachers' Awards 2026

The Government on Friday announced the National Teachers' Awards 2026 for 48 teachers in recognition of their contribution to school education and literacy. The awardees, listed by the Department of School Education and Literacy, include teachers from states and Union Territories as well as institutions such as the Kendriya Vidyalaya Sangathan, Navodaya Vidyalaya Samiti, Sainik Schools, Adarsha Tribal School, and PM SHRI schools, among others. Among those selected are J Prakash Rao from Andaman and Nicobar Islands, Rajesh Kouluri from Andhra Pradesh, Yaku Tame from Arunachal Pradesh, Rajesh Bordoloi from Assam, Suman Goel from Delhi and Zafar Alam from Eklavya Model Residential Schools under the Ministry of Tribal Affairs. (PTI)

■ States Focus ■



### ARSON, PETROL BOMB ATTACKS REPORTED ACROSS MEGHALAYA

Incidents of arson and petrol bomb attacks on Government properties were reported across Meghalaya on Friday, as tensions prevailed following violence during the Khasi Students' Union black-flag bike rally two days ago. An office that housed the National People's Party previously at Lachumiere was targeted with a petrol bomb around 5 am, but it did not explode, police said.

A police and forensic team reached the spot, collected evidence and registered a case, they said.

In West Khasi Hills, two Government vehicles were gutted after miscreants set them ablaze at Nongstoin on Thursday night.

(PTI)



### MAHARASHTRA, GERMANY'S HESSE SIGN MOU TO BOOST INVESTMENT

The Maharashtra Government and Germany's Hesse state on Friday signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) to strengthen cooperation in investment, innovation, employment and skill development.

The MoU was signed by Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis and Hessen President Boris Rhein at Sahyadri Guest House here.

Fadnavis described the partnership as cooperation between two economically strong regions and said Hesse could serve as Maharashtra's gateway to Germany and Europe, while Maharashtra could become Hesse's gateway to India and the Indo-Pacific region.

"The Maharashtra-Hesse partnership will boost investment, innovation, employment and skill development and create new opportunities for citizens," Fadnavis said.

(PTI)

## Himanta discusses Assam issues with Union Ministers

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma on Friday called on Union Ministers Nirmala Sitharaman and Prahlad Joshi in the national capital and discussed issues concerning key sectors of the State. He updated Sitharaman on the State Government's response to the flood situation and the roadmap to rehabilitate the affected people.

"It is always a pleasure to meet Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman ji, who has consistently been a strong champion of Assam's interests and aspirations," said Sarma said in social media. "As always, she heard our concerns with great attention and sensitivity. I am deeply grateful for her posi-



Assam CM Himanta Biswa Sarma meeting Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman in Delhi on Friday

tive response and assurance that the Government of India will stand firmly with Assam as we work to help every flood-affected family rebuild their lives," Sarma added.

During the meeting at

Kartavya Bhawan, the Chief Minister apprised the Union Finance Minister of the Assam flood response, with particular focus on the ongoing assessment of damage caused by the floods and the

slew of measures on the anvil for the rehabilitation and reconstruction of affected areas. He also outlined the state Government's roadmap for restoring livelihoods and extending assistance to

flood-affected families as part of the next phase of the response. Sitharaman assured the Chief Minister that the Government of India would continue to stand firmly with Assam as the state works towards helping flood-affected families rebuild their lives.

The Chief Minister's meeting with the Union Finance Minister comes as Assam continues to assess the impact of the floods and work on rehabilitation, reconstruction and restoration of livelihoods in the worst-hit Sivasagar, Charaideo and Jorhat districts.

Sarma also had a "very productive meeting" with Joshi, the Union Minister for Education, Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution, and New and Renewable Energy. "Our discussions

covered key priorities for Assam across education, food and civil supplies, and renewable energy. Grateful to Joshi ji for his positive approach and continued support for Assam," Sarma said in another social media post.

The Union Minister further said that the two leaders discussed ensuring seamless fund flow under the SNA-SPARSH mechanism, in line with the scheme's framework, to facilitate timely salary disbursement and strengthen the delivery of quality and equitable school education across Assam.

The meeting also covered key issues relating to food and civil supplies and renewable energy, reflecting the continued focus on strengthening Centre-State cooperation for Assam's development.

## MEA denies political clearance for Telangana CM Reddy's US visit

ASHOKE RAJ ■ New Delhi

The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) on Friday said it had denied political clearance for Telangana Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy's proposed visit to the United States, stating that the programme did not conform to established norms.

The clarification came hours after the Telangana Chief Minister's Office announced that Reddy had been forced to cancel his planned US visit after the Centre declined permission for the trip.

MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said visits by chief ministers and other dignitaries are assessed by the ministry before political clearance is granted. He said the proposed programme must be appropriate to the office held and the purpose of the visit.

"In this particular case, that was not so in respect of the US," Jaiswal said at the MEA's media briefing. "Therefore, clearance has not been given. Incidentally, his visit to the UK has been cleared."

Reddy is currently in London and had planned to travel to the US after



completing his UK engagements. Following the denial of clearance for the American leg of his tour, he is scheduled to return to Hyderabad on August 30, according to his office.

The Telangana Government said it had sought the Centre's permission for both the UK and US visits in accor-

dance with Government policy and protocol. While the UK visit was approved, clearance for the US trip was not granted.

According to the Chief Minister's Office, Reddy had intended to use the US visit to explore opportunities for bringing leading American educa-

tional institutions to Telangana.

Reddy said the proposed initiative was aimed at expanding educational, skills and training opportunities for young people in the state, including through partnerships with Ivy League and other globally recognised institutions.

The chief minister stressed that efforts to strengthen education and youth opportunities should be viewed beyond electoral politics.

The denial of political clearance is not without precedent. The MEA has previously declined permission for foreign visits by chief ministers, including Arvind Kejriwal during his tenure as Delhi chief minister and Mamata Banerjee while serving as West Bengal chief minister.

The latest episode comes against the backdrop of the Centre's established practice of assessing foreign travel by state chief ministers and other public dignitaries on the basis of the nature and purpose of the proposed engagements.

For Reddy, the decision means that his planned US engagements will not go ahead as scheduled, while his UK visit remains unaffected.

## JU files police complaints over campus violence, forms probe panel



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ Kolkata

Jadavpur University (JU) authorities on Friday lodged police complaints over the violence that broke out on its campus here, officials said.

One of the complaints was lodged over a crowd's entry to the campus at midnight, the attempt to damage the main gate, setting on fire festoons and locking some students inside one of the buildings, they said.

"The complaint sought an investigation, and asked the police to prevent recurrence of such incidents on the campus," an official of the state-run varsity said.

The university also formed a high-level committee comprising three members to look into the circumstances and factors that led to the August 19 midnight incident, when a group entered the campus, and subsequent developments, including damage to two heritage emblems, Vice-Chancellor Chiranjib Bhattacharya told reporters.

The committee will pass on its recommendations to the police.

"Another complaint was lodged in connection with scaling the varsity's gate number 4, damaging the historic emblem of the varsity crafted by legendary painter Nandalal Bose, and the pelting of stones and water bottles," he said.

A clash broke out between members of ABVP and Left-leaning student groups at the Jadavpur University early Thursday, with both sides accusing each other of bringing outsiders into the campus.

## Govt tightens SIM card limits; telcos to deny new connections beyond 9 from August 24

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH  
■ New Delhi

The Department of Telecommunications (DoT) has told telecom companies to stop giving new mobile connections to anyone who has already reached the allowed limit. This rule will start on August 24, 2026.

The DoT issued a circular on August 17 instructing operators to implement technical and organisational measures to detect customers who seek to open more connections than the prescribed number. These applicants should be informed that they have reached the maximum permitted number and therefore cannot be issued a new mobile connection.

Since August 9, 2012, the rules have been that a person may have a maximum of nine mobile connections in their name throughout all telecom operators and licensed service areas in the country.

In Jammu and Kashmir, Assam and the North-Eastern states, a ceiling of six applies. This limit is cumulative and not based on individual operators. Having nine connec-



tions with various companies amounts to the full allowance. To identify them, the operators will use the DoT's Digital Intelligence Platform (DIP). This central system collects the subscriber data uploaded by the telecom companies.

From 23rd August onwards, the platform will provide representative photographic images of subscribers who have already reached the relevant limit.

Operators will have to download these images daily and use them alongside other records when screening new applications. At first, the checks may be carried out on a post-facto basis. Any connection activated beyond the

limit, even for just one day, must be suspended immediately until the problem is resolved.

Telecom providers are to incorporate real-time verification into their enrolment and activation procedures by 30 November 2026. When applying for a new SIM card, customers must still declare on the Customer Application Form all mobile connections currently in their name, including those with other operators or in other service areas. Responsibility for dealing with any implementation-related problems remains with the Licensed Service Areas.

The Government has made it clear that the aim is to

make sure that each subscriber uses their mobile connection only within the specified limit. Greater enforcement is anticipated to prevent the misuse of multiple numbers for cyber fraud, financial scams, and other illegal activities. People who currently have nine (or six in areas where restrictions apply) SIMs will no longer be able to get another one from 24 August onwards. Individuals who are unsure about the number of SIMs registered in their name can check this through the *Sanchar Saathi* portal or app.

The directive reinforces an existing regulation rather than establishing a new numerical limit; the DoT intends to eliminate gaps that had previously allowed some users to exceed the limit when using different operators by combining data consolidation, photographic verification, and the mandatory denial of excess connections.

Telecom companies must now implement the required systems without delay to meet the August 24 deadline and achieve full real-time compliance by the end of November 2026.

## Congress opposing Vande Mataram unconstitutional, reprehensible: Rajnath

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh on Friday criticised the Congress for its opposition to singing Vande Mataram in its entirety, terming it "unconstitutional" and "reprehensible".

The Congress on Wednesday decided to abide by the 1937 resolution of the Congress Working Committee (CWC), the party's highest decision-making body, on Vande Mataram, saying that only two stanzas of the national song would be sung at all party events henceforth.

In a post on social media, Rajnath Singh said the Congress' "formal refusal to honour" Vande Mataram is a "very serious matter" from a constitutional perspective. "The Congress' formal refusal not only to honour Vande Mataram but to outright oppose it is extremely regrettable and, from a constitutional perspective, a very serious matter. According to the Constitution of India, Parliament is the supreme institution of the country, and any law passed by



Parliament is binding on every individual," he said.

He termed the party's decision a "serious warning sign" for the future of the country and said it could create a "serious crisis" politically. "I believe that this decision of the Congress is entirely unconstitutional and reprehensible, and from a political perspective, it is one that will create a serious crisis in the future. By opposing Vande Mataram, the Congress has revealed its foolish and dangerous intentions to the country," he added.

He said the "refusal to abide by the law" raises questions over a person's loyalty to the Constitution. "If someone refuses to honour the national song, a question mark is placed on their patriotism as well,"

he said. Rajnath Singh also hit out at the Congress for referring to its 1937 resolution on Vande Mataram, alleging that the resolution was passed by the party "by bowing down to the radical demands of the Muslim League".

"The resolution of 1937 that the Congress refers to was one that the Congress passed by bowing down to the radical demands of the Muslim League, and its consequence was witnessed by the country in the future in the form of partition," he added.

"Compromising with radical elements has always proven fatal for the country," Rajnath Singh said, alleging that the Congress is once again "surrendering to radical elements".

## Govt will fully back young space entrepreneurs: PM at meet with 20 startups

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Friday assured full support of the Government to young space entrepreneurs and urged them to explore how space technology can be used in agriculture, livestock management, dairy, environment and other areas that affect people's everyday lives.

Interacting with CEOs and founders of 20 space startups here, Modi also hailed them for showing remarkable courage by entering a new and demanding domain of space startups as they have taken risks, trusted the reform process and remained consistent in their efforts.

He assured them of the Government's full support and called for greater collab-

oration between space companies and organisations in other sectors to expand the use of their technologies.

"I assured the space startups that Government of India will continue to stand with them as they build India's capabilities for the future. India can offer the world a strong, innovative and commercially viable model in the space sector," he said.

Modi also urged the startups to explore how space technology could contribute to "agriculture, livestock management, dairy, environment and many other areas that touch everyday lives".

The prime minister suggested, "Companies working on space debris could work with environmental organisations to scale up their tech-

nologies. Space technology companies working with the agriculture sector could collaborate with agricultural universities and departments to help farmers make better informed decisions and maximise their output."

The prime minister said the startups made insightful presentations on their work and appreciated the Government's space reforms and the opportunities they had created for the industry to grow. "It was wonderful to meet the Yuva Urja of India's space sector... young entrepreneurs and innovators who have shown remarkable courage by entering a new and demanding domain. They have taken risks, trusted the reform process and remained consistent in their efforts. Due to this, India has



Prime Minister Narendra Modi interacts with young entrepreneurs and innovators from India's space sector

PTI

achieved a lot in the space sector in the last few years," he said.

He said India's private space ecosystem could become a major force for the country and the world and called for an ecosystem

in which the world looks to India when thinking about the space sector.

India's space sector can act as a magnet to attract global talent, companies and investment to the country, Modi said, urging industry

players to rapidly strengthen India's position globally.

The prime minister also encouraged space startups to engage with Atal Tinkering Labs, saying they could spark curiosity among schoolchildren and inspire the next generation to participate in the space sector.

He recalled that opening the space sector to private participation had generated significant enthusiasm and created new opportunities for industry.

The prime minister said many countries either could not invest in the space sector or did not wish to do so, presenting India with a major opportunity to rapidly strengthen its position in the global space industry.

He also encouraged space companies to explore new

applications of their technologies and focus on how these could make people's lives easier, while calling for greater collaboration between space-sector firms and companies working in other areas.

The CEOs of leading companies in the space sector working in diverse fields ranging from building rockets and reusable semi-cryogenic launch vehicles, avionics, satellites, advanced propulsion system, space and defence intelligence, removing space debris, AI-powered hyperlocal weather and climate intelligence, among others, participated in the interaction.

The prime minister said the confidence shown by the private space sector had strengthened the vision

behind opening the industry to private participation.

The CEOs highlighted the rapid progress being made by India's private space industry and shared their vision for its future.

They said their companies had invested significant time and effort in building capabilities and developing the required technologies indigenously in the country, while expressing gratitude for the support received from the Prime Minister.

They also highlighted the strong support from the Government and collaboration within the industry, saying their teams were highly motivated and working with determination to achieve ambitious goals in the space sector.

# PM chairs 3rd high-level meet with secretaries, calls for long-term vision

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday late evening chaired the third high-level meeting with Secretaries to the Government of India during which he discussed the future action agenda of Ministries and Departments dealing with Infrastructure and Connectivity, Security and External Affairs, and Governance.

Noting that deliberations had already been held with two groups of Secretaries, sources said Prime Minister conveyed that Secretaries, in addition to thinking about immediate issues and statistics, should also think with a long-term perspective on how the country's future should be shaped.

Prime Minister called for greater engagement between Government departments, universities and young people to bring fresh perspectives in policymaking. He said wider engagement with universities and young people can bring new and unconventional ideas.



The Secretaries shared their experiences on sectoral priorities, emerging challenges and implementation issues. The meeting was attended by the Cabinet Secretary, Secretaries of key Ministries and Departments, and senior officials from the Prime Minister's Office at the residence of PM Modi.

Discussing the challenge of overcoming silos, Modi stressed that silos are not merely an organisational problem but also a problem

of mindset. He said silos can be both horizontal and vertical. He stressed that officials must take ownership of their responsibilities and work with a spirit of belongingness.

Emphasising the importance of collective effort, Prime Minister cited the experience of the COVID-19 pandemic and the West Asia crisis, when officials across departments worked together effectively. He said that such coordination mechanisms should become a

natural part of the Government's work culture.

Prime Minister called for effective use of Artificial Intelligence while ensuring human intervention and judgement. He called for exploring innovative ways of combining the capabilities of AI with human expertise.

Modi emphasised that data is a national asset and a resource for the future. He noted that the Government invests resources in collecting, storing and managing data, but its full potential is not always realised because of departmental silos and fragmented systems.

He pointed to differences in the manner in which data is collected and managed for various purposes, and called for finding solutions that enable greater interoperability and effective use of data.

Sources said PM emphasised the need for better connectivity between manufacturing units and export-oriented units, so that India's manufacturing and export capabilities can fully benefit from its maritime infrastructure.

# VP inaugurates MALHAR 2026 classical music festival in Delhi

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

Vice President CP Radhakrishnan on Friday inaugurated 'MALHAR 2026', a youth-centric, monsoon-themed celebration of Indian classical music by Antar Hriday Connect, in the national Capital.

Addressing the gathering, the Vice President appreciated Antar Hriday Connect for creating opportunities for young people to experience and engage with India's rich classical music heritage, particularly through free classical music concerts.

Radhakrishnan said that across Bharat, every region has its own musical traditions, sounds and styles, yet music remains one of the strongest threads connecting the country. He described India's cultural diversity as "many musical traditions, one shared spirit; many voices, one Bharat."

He noted that the Malhar family of ragas is traditionally associated with the monsoon and described 'MALHAR' as a symbol of renewal, with music having the power to refresh the



human spirit, awaken imagination and inspire hope.

The Vice President emphasised that India's classical music tradition has remained a living tradition because it has continuously evolved. He urged the youth to become custodians and ambassadors of India's civilisational heritage and encouraged them to take the country's classical music and cultural traditions to communities across the world.

He also highlighted music as one of India's greatest forms of soft power, capable of transcending language and borders and fostering friendship, understanding and goodwill.

The Vice President congratulated all those associated with MALHAR and expressed hope that the celebration would become a recurring musical journey, returning every monsoon with greater energy, wider participation and an ever-growing love for Indian classical music.

Member of Parliament, Rajya Sabha and Chief Patron, Antar Hriday Harsh Vardhan Shringla; President, Corporate Affairs, ITC Anil Rajput; Chairman, Galaxy and Sawasdee Group Pradeep Kumar; and Antar Hriday Youth Cultural Ambassador for India Saurav Sharma and other dignitaries were present during the occasion.

# Pregnant woman carried 8 km on stretcher due to no road in MP; baby dies

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ Bhopal

A pregnant woman in Chhindwara district's Junnardeo block had to be carried nearly 8 km on a makeshift stretcher after an ambulance reportedly could not reach her hamlet due to the absence of a motorable road.

The unborn baby later died, while the woman remains in serious condition. The incident has raised fresh questions over basic road connectivity and emergency healthcare access in remote areas.

The incident was reported from Chitipatha Jamundong hamlet, where Sonu Malgam's wife Kustariya developed labour pains on Thursday morning.

According to local residents, the lack of a pucca road prevented a 108 ambulance from reaching the hamlet. The sarpanch, family members and villagers subsequently made a makeshift stretcher using wooden poles and cloth.

They carried Kustariya on foot through difficult terrain for around 8 km and took her to Gop Village. From there, she was transported by a 108 ambulance to the Damua health centre.

Doctors at the health centre, after assessing her serious condition, referred her to the district hospital. According to the family, Kustariya had to be carried over a considerable distance through difficult terrain before she could reach medical assistance.

Doctors at the hospital later confirmed the death of the unborn baby. The woman has been admitted to the ICU and is undergoing treatment.

The incident has also brought attention to the long-standing demand for better connectivity in the hamlet.

Residents said around 125 families live in Chitipatha Jamundong and claimed that the demand for a pucca road has been raised before the administration and public representatives since 2016.

# UPI scam cluster in Vijayawada: How one tap emptied four accounts in minutes

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH  
■ New Delhi/Vijayawada

Four people went to the Patamata police station in Vijayawada on the same day to report cybercrimes. A different scam, such as fake KYC alerts, suspicious links, or unusual account activity, tricked each person. In every case, their bank accounts were emptied within minutes of them using their phones. Police have registered all four cases on the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal and are working with the Vijayawada City Cyber Crime Wing to track down the stolen money.

One thing that stands out is who the victims are. Rajendra, a retired bank manager from Nagarjuna Nagar, worked in banking for years but was still targeted by scammers. It shows that even people familiar with banking systems can fall victim, not just those less comfortable with technology.

Paklapati Ravivarman from Nidamanuru also installed an APK that appeared to be a legitimate update, allowing attackers to control his phone remotely.

Manoj Kumar from Prasadampadu lost money through unauthorised UPI transactions after his phone was hacked. In Rajendra's case, he clicked a link for SBI reward points, which took him to a fake page that collected his banking details.

The money was taken out right away. These attacks are more sophisticated than regular phishing. In APK-based scams, the fake app requests many permissions, such as access to your SMS, accessibility services, and device administration.

If you grant these, the malware can read your OTPs, display fake login screens to steal your PIN, track your typing, and even approve UPI transfers without you knowing.



You do not have to share any codes; the malicious software collects them on its own. Scammers usually send urgent messages, but real banks or Aadhaar KYC processes in India give customers

several weeks' notice and do not require immediate action. The reward-link scam works differently. Victims are asked to claim points on a page that closely copies a real banking website.

In real bank or Aadhaar KYC processes in India, customers get several weeks' notice and do not need to act immediately. The reward-link scam works differently. Victims are asked to claim points on a page that closely resembles real banking websites.

These incidents in Vijayawada are part of a larger trend. Since early 2025, the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal has received over 12 lakh complaints about APK scams. Cyber fraud has gone up by several hundred per cent in recent years.

Organised groups send the same malware through WhatsApp to thousands of people, using the same tricks each time.

The stolen money is moved through several accounts, then turned into cryptocurrency or withdrawn as cash. This makes it hard to recover unless the crime is reported within a few hours. The city cyber wing is now tracking the

flow of money by checking bank accounts, UPI handles, and digital footprints linked to the stolen funds.

Acting quickly by calling the 1930 helpline or visiting cybercrime.gov.in can stop the money before it is fully withdrawn. Reporting right away is crucial. Taking preventive steps is still the best way to stay safe.

Do not install apps received through WhatsApp, SMS, or Telegram. Official banking apps are only available on authorised app stores.

It is best to turn off the "Install from Unknown Sources" option in your phone settings. Treat any request with a same-day deadline as suspicious. If you have installed a suspicious APK, turn off mobile data and Wi-Fi, uninstall the app, change your passwords and UPI PIN on another device and report the incident to the police immediately.

# Congress doing communal lynching of Vande Mataram: Mukhtar Naqvi

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

Former Union Cabinet Minister and senior BJP leader Mukhtar Abbas Naqvi on Friday slammed the Congress and the "Vande Mataram Bashing Brigade", saying that these "pseudo secular chieftains" are doing "communal lynching" of "Vande Mataram" "by choice and not by chance" only to appease the "communal Mogambo".

While talking to media Naqvi said that the Congress' stance on "Vande Mataram" is riddled with "self-goals and communal cunningness". Instead of atoning for the "sin" committed in 1937, when the Congress truncated the national song to appease the "Mogambo" of the Muslim League, the Congress is still engaged in the foolishness and absurd bravado of justifying that very act.



Naqvi said that following the restoration of the full spirit of "Vande Mataram" in the Parliament, the Congress had an opportunity to rectify the "criminal misdeed" it had committed against the national song under Muslim League pressure and to stand by Parliament's decision; yet, even today, the Opposition party is appeasing the "spirit of the Mogambo".

Naqvi said that during the Congress party's Kakinada session, the great freedom fighter and prominent Muslim woman Raihana Tybji sang "Vande Mataram" despite opposition from the then-Congress leader Muhammad Ali Jauhar. Pandit Vishnu Digambar Paluskar, who was present, reprimanded the dissenters, stating, "This is not a religious gathering but a social and political event; no one can stop the chanting of the mantra of national consciousness and nationalism here."

However, ignoring that historic event, the Congress is now busy trying to awaken "Jinnah's Jinn."

Naqvi said that the insult to the national song is not a coincidence but a communal play, "Vande Mataram" does not endanger anyone's religious faith—rather, it demolishes the design to denigrate the democracy.

# SC lets down Indian working class in industry definition case

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

A nine-member Constitution Bench of the Supreme Court, constituted, inter alia, to adjudicate on the application of the triple-test formula laid down by a seven-judge Bench to define 'industry' in Bangalore Water Supply & Sewerage Board v R Rajappa & Others, has pronounced a 5:4, viper-thin majority judgment.

The judgment has immunised the Industrial Relations Code, 2020 from the application of the expansive definition of 'industry' interpreted in 1978 by the seven-judge Bench led by Justice VR Krishna Iyer in Bangalore Water Supply & Sewerage Board v R Rajappa & Others, which had laid down the famous triple test to determine the term 'industry'.

Justice VR Krishna Iyer had held that if there is any systematic activity, an employ-



er-employee relationship, and production or distribution of goods or services for human wants, the organisation may qualify as an "industry", even if there is no profit motive. Since 1978, this has stood the test of time and has become the law of the land.

The definition has been disputed by the employer class continuously since then. In the context of State of Uttar Pradesh v Jai Bir Singh, the issue was revisited

by a nine-member Constitution Bench of the Supreme Court, which delivered its judgment on August 20, 2026.

The ruling says that all matters presently pending before courts, tribunals, labour authorities or other fora under the Industrial Disputes Act, 1947, may be adjudicated in accordance with the triple test laid down in the Bangalore Water Supply case. At the same time, the thin-majority judg-

ment has refrained from examining the new definition of 'industry' under the Industrial Relations Code, 2020, in the light of the triple test laid down in the Bangalore Water Supply case. It is nothing but dancing to the tune of the neo-liberal ecosystem that is mercilessly depriving workers of their hard-earned rights.

Accordingly, the Supreme Court concluded in its judgment: "It is apposite to note that the ratio in Bangalore Water Supply (supra) limited itself till a new definition was introduced. As a new law redefining 'industry' has come into force, the ratio in Bangalore Water Supply (supra) would remain restricted to the proceedings pending under the repealed law and the provisions of the new law, ie IR Code, shall be independently interpreted."

The entire process of labour law codification in

general, and the Industrial Relations Code, 2020, in particular, has already excluded millions of working people from coverage through increased threshold limits for the application of the law. This means that they have been kept out of legal entitlements and protections.

Now, the Supreme Court has gone further through its judgment in this case. It has not only lent credence to this cruel exclusion but, by refraining from upholding the application of the judgment of the Justice VR Krishna Iyer-led seven-judge Bench in Bangalore Water Supply & Sewerage Board v. R Rajappa & Others to the Industrial Relations Code, where there are huge exclusions aimed at keeping workers away from the ambit of the law, it has facilitated corporate interests by excluding its own citizens — the working population — from the protection of law.

# Protests erupt in J&K's Kishtwar after 14-year-old girl allegedly impregnated by teacher dies; accused held

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ Jammu

Massive protests broke out in the remote Kishtwar district of Jammu division on Friday after a 14-year-old school-girl, allegedly impregnated by her teacher, died when she was being shifted to a hospital in Doda to terminate her pregnancy.

A Grade-II Government school teacher identified as Khalid Hussain Sheikh has been placed under suspension by the Chief Education Officer, Kishtwar, pending an inquiry into the matter.

A large number of college students and residents in Kishtwar staged protest demonstrations seeking justice for the minor tribal girl and severe punishment for



the accused in the case.

According to official sources, the victim, a resident of Kishtwar district's Chhatroo area, was referred from the District Hospital in Kishtwar to Doda for specialised treatment for termination of the pregnancy but died en route on Thursday.

Following the incident,

police registered FIR No. 34/2026 at Police Station Chatroo under Sections 61(2), 65(1), 90, 91 and 92 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), 2023, besides Sections 4, 6, 8, 10 and 17 of the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act, 2012.

Police subsequently arrested Khalid Hussain Sheikh,

who is identified as a Teacher Grade-II at Middle School Bumalpora, Zone Inderwal.

The Chief Education Officer, Kishtwar, through an order issued on August 21, placed Sheikh under suspension in terms of Rule 31 of the Jammu and Kashmir Civil Services (Classification, Control and Appeal) Rules, 1956, pending an inquiry into the matter.

The suspension order specifically refers to the FIR registered at Police Station Chatroo and notes that the accused teacher is under police custody.

Further investigation into the case is underway, while the circumstances surrounding the minor's pregnancy and death are being investigated by the concerned authorities.

# FM directs early completion of DPR for high-level dam on Kosi River

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi/Patna

Bihar Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary, along with Deputy Chief Minister Vijay Kumar Choudhary and Rajya Sabha MP Sanjay Kumar Jha, met Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman and Union External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar in New Delhi and held discussions on several key issues related to Bihar's development.

The meeting with Sitharaman focused extensively on the release of funds to Bihar and the implementation of various schemes in accordance with the announcements made in the Union Budget.

The requirement of funds for Phase I of the Kosi-Mechi Inter-State River Link Project and technical approval for Phase II was also discussed. The Union Finance Minister directed the National Water Development Agency (NWDA)



and the Ministry of Jal Shakti to take necessary action in this regard.

The Chief Minister said that progress on the project would provide significant benefits to the Seemanchal region of Bihar in terms of irrigation, agriculture and water management.

The proposed Sapt Kosi Project was also discussed. Following the Chief Minister's request, the Union Finance Minister directed relevant department to complete the Detailed Project Report

(DPR) for a high-level dam on the Kosi River at the earliest. It was also agreed that Bihar will have one representative on the Joint Technical Expert Committee to ensure that the state's interests are effectively represented in technical matters related to the project.

The meeting also discussed the implementation of SNA & SPARSH by September 30 with the objective of enabling Bihar to access greater Central assistance. The effective implementation of Reform-Based Incentives under SASCI was also discussed.

The Chief Minister said these measures would help the state mobilise additional financial resources for development projects.

The establishment of Vikramshila University was also discussed during the meeting. The Chief Minister informed that the Bihar Government has made available 219 acres of land in Bhagalpur for the university.



Editor's  
TAKE

## Convergence amid constraints

India and Japan are now strategic partners, hedging against a region in flux and China's growing influence

On August 20, Defence Minister Rajnath Singh and his Japanese counterpart Shinjiro Koizumi signed a Memorandum of Arrangement on Maritime Security Cooperation in New Delhi – a document with considerable strategic weight. It builds on Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi's July visit to Delhi, when the two governments unveiled over \$10 billion in agreements spanning artificial intelligence, clean energy and defence, and set a target of 10 trillion yen in Japanese investment over the coming decade.

The new arrangement gives the Indian Navy and Japan's Maritime Self-Defense Force a formal framework for sharing maritime domain awareness, conducting search-and-rescue and disaster-relief operations, exchanging ship visits, and, crucially, exploring joint warship design and reciprocal repair facilities. Both countries have watched China's naval footprint expand across the Indian Ocean even as Beijing presses claims in the East and South China Seas. Tokyo's calculus has hardened since Takaichi's remarks last November that Japan could respond militarily to a Chinese move on Taiwan, comments still colouring ties with Beijing. Japan's recent easing of decades-old defence export restrictions, welcomed openly by Singh, signals a country recalibrating post-war pacifism to build real production capacity rather than lean solely on American guarantees. For India, the pact goes well with the 'Make in India' push in defence manufacturing and offers access to Japanese shipbuilding expertise that could speed naval modernisation. Both governments describe this as advancing a "free and open Indo-Pacific" – carefully avoiding the word China even as everyone understands the signal.

The challenges are real. Beijing's foreign ministry has already signalled discomfort with the broader partnership, warning that cooperation between neighbours must not target third parties. India must walk a tightrope: deepening security cooperation with a Quad partner while preserving the strategic autonomy that has long defined its foreign policy, and without irking China. The Quad has not held a leaders' summit since 2024, and doubts about how reliably Washington will stay invested in the region are precisely why bilateral hedges like this one matter more. Converting memoranda into genuinely interoperable navies also takes years – technology absorption, joint doctrine, and shared threat perception across two very different theatres – the situation in South China sea is very different from Indian Ocean. The way forward lies in patient institutionalisation rather than symbolism. Regular 2+2 ministerial dialogues, expanded logistics-sharing arrangements on the model of India's agreement with Washington, and genuine co-production projects – building on the newly launched UNICORN mast programme – would give this partnership operational substance. Anchoring bilateral gains within broader Quad initiatives. India and Japan are not building an alliance against China but coming closer to safeguard their own maritime interests, something that must be reiterated to keep tempers low in Beijing.

# Education reform must factor in well-being

As classrooms evolve with new curricula, technology and changing approaches to assessment, emotional wellbeing can no longer remain a peripheral concern. A child's ability to handle anxiety, failure, relationships and uncertainty is as fundamental to preparing for life as academic achievement – and it is time education reform recognised that



NEERJA  
BIRLA

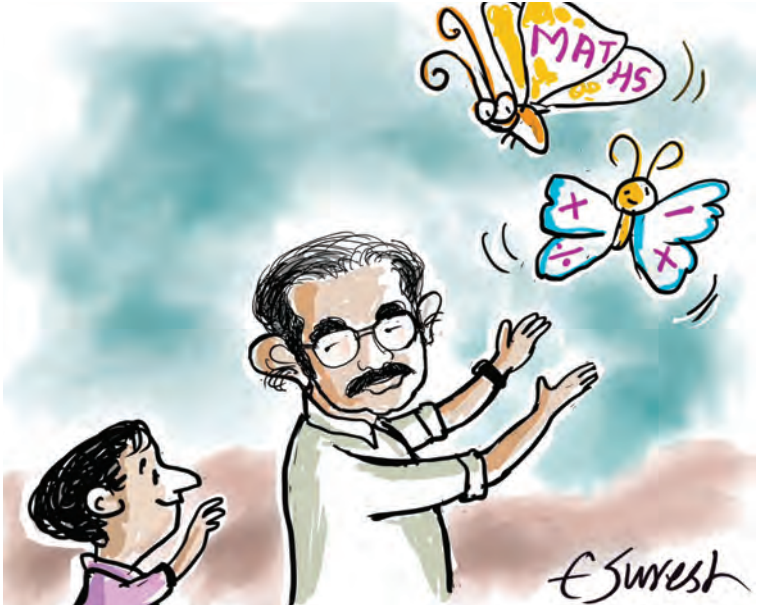
We have spent decades asking what our children need to learn. Perhaps it is time to ask another question: what do they need in order to learn well? Education in India has changed significantly. Curricula have become more progressive; technology has expanded access to knowledge and assessment is gradually moving beyond rote learning. These changes reflect a larger shift in how we think about preparing young people for an uncertain future. Yet one part of that preparation is still often treated as secondary: the emotional experience of learning.

A child does not leave their worries at the classroom door. Pressure to perform, fear of disappointing parents, friendship struggles, loneliness or uncertainty about the future can influence how they concentrate, participate and respond to challenges. If education is meant to prepare young people for life, then how they feel while learning cannot remain separate from what they learn.

This is why I believe the next chapter of education reform must place emotional wellbeing alongside academic development. Not instead of excellence, but as an essential part of enabling it. The need is increasingly visible. An NCERT survey conducted in 2022, cited by UNICEF India, found that 11% of students reported anxiety, 14% experienced extreme emotions, and 43% reported mood swings. The importance of early intervention is equally clear half of all mental health disorders begin by age 14, and 75% by the mid-20s. These figures should prompt us to look beyond whether a child is keeping up academically and consider whether they are developing the emotional resources to cope with the demands placed upon them. Emotional literacy is not a soft skill. It is a life skill. It begins with giving children the vocabulary to understand what they are experiencing. A child who can recognise frustration before it becomes anger, understand anxiety rather than simply fear it, or articulate that they need help is developing a capacity that will remain valuable far beyond school.

A psychologically safe classroom allows children to question, disagree, make mistakes and try again without feeling diminished. If children associate mistakes with embarrassment or failure with loss of worth, they may become more focused on avoiding errors than on discovering, experimenting and learning. The role of the teacher is therefore changing too; not into that of a mental-health professional, but into that of an informed and observant adult within a child's support system.

A sudden withdrawal, behavioural change or



A SUDDEN  
WITHDRAWAL,  
BEHAVIOURAL  
CHANGE OR  
DISENGAGEMENT  
CAN SOMETIMES  
SIGNAL THAT A  
CHILD IS  
STRUGGLING.  
TEACHERS NEED  
NOT BECOME  
MENTAL-HEALTH  
PROFESSIONALS,  
BUT THEY DO NEED  
THE AWARENESS  
TO RECOGNISE  
SUCH SIGNS,  
RESPOND WITH  
EMPATHY AND  
KNOW WHEN  
PROFESSIONAL  
SUPPORT MAY BE  
REQUIRED

The author is Founder and  
Chairperson, Aditya Birla  
Education Trust, and Founder,  
Mpower

disengagement can sometimes signal that a child is struggling. Teachers need not become mental-health professionals, but they do need the awareness to recognise such signs, respond with empathy and know when professional support may be required. This also means rethinking how we interpret behaviour. Children facing mental-health concerns may be labelled "lazy", "hyperactive" or "naughty" when they may actually need understanding and support. In one school-based intervention, 95% of teachers reported a positive change in how they perceived students with mental-health concerns. Student referrals offer another important insight: 20% were related to poor academic performance, while others involved aggressive behaviour. Such changes should not automatically be viewed as disciplinary issues; they can also signal that a child may be struggling emotionally. But recognition is only the first step. Students must also have access to the right support, without placing the entire responsibility on teachers. But recognition must lead to access. UNICEF India notes that India has only 0.75 psychiatrists per 100,000 people, with shortages extending to psychologists and psychiatric social workers. This is why strengthening mental wellbeing in education cannot mean placing another responsibility on teachers and schools without strengthening the wider support system.

Schools need clear pathways to professional care, while counselling must be normalized as a resource rather than viewed as a last resort. Equally important is bringing parents into the conversation and strengthening relationships between students, teachers and families.

Often, meaningful support begins with something simple: an adult who listens without immediately comparing, correcting or trying to solve everything.

The experience of implementing the curriculum demonstrates how strengthening emotional skills and relationships can create a school environment that is more conducive to learning, while also contributing to academic outcomes. Across all grade levels, students became better at managing their emotions and more willing to seek help when needed. Both coping skills and help-seeking behavior improved significantly from baseline to endline across every age group.

The impact was also visible beyond the classroom, with parents observing positive changes in how children handled everyday conflicts. When students are equipped to regulate emotions, seek help and build healthier relationships, classrooms can become more supportive spaces where both well-being and learning can thrive. The approach must also recognise that wellbeing does not look the same for every young person. The pressures faced by a school student may differ from those experienced in university. Adolescence, young adulthood, family circumstances, social environments and individual experiences all shape how challenges are experienced. A responsive approach to wellbeing must therefore be responsive rather than one-size-fits-all.

When a young person is unable to cope, the consequences can affect attendance, learning, educational progression and, later, employability and participation in the workforce. Supporting wellbeing early is therefore not merely an investment in individual children. It is an investment in the country's human potential. A report card can tell us what a child has learnt. It cannot tell us whether they have developed confidence, empathy, adaptability or the ability to recover from disappointment. These qualities shape how young people navigate relationships, decisions, setbacks and opportunities.

That does not mean lowering academic expectations. Quite the opposite. We should want young people who can pursue excellence without tying their entire sense of worth to achievement; who can experience failure without seeing themselves as failures. The next education reform, therefore, should not ask us to choose between achievement and wellbeing. It should recognise that the two are deeply connected. Education has always been about preparing the mind for what lies ahead. The next step is to recognise the person behind that mind, their emotions, relationships, confidence, vulnerabilities and capacity to adapt. Perhaps the question for the next education reform is no longer only what do we want our children to learn? It is also: what do we want them to be equipped to handle when the lesson ends? If the answer includes uncertainty, failure, relationships, change and the inevitable challenges of life, then emotional wellbeing cannot remain at the margins of education.

## When no one owns the problem

During my wait, I noticed several other irate customers. Some appeared to be daily-wage earners, conscious that every hour spent waiting meant lost income. A few struggled to communicate their problems and were asked to return another day. I could afford the time and had the confidence to persist. I wondered how easily they could.

Amazon scheduled the pickup for the day I was travelling. Since I was leaving early, the customer-service executive suggested that I leave the phone with a neighbour. After reaching my destination, I checked with the neighbour. The phone had been collected. Later that evening, however, I received a message saying that the pickup could not be completed because I was unavailable. From overseas, I tried contacting customer service. Automated calls offered no opportunity to explain the situation. Emails promised that an executive would contact me. Nobody did.

An escalation email directed me back to the same helpline. On returning to India, I resumed my calls. The system continued to maintain that the phone had not been collected. Eventually, I traced the pickup person through our condominium records. He remembered collecting it and, after checking, told me that the phone had been lying in the warehouse for almost a month. It could not be verified because it could not be switched on. That was precisely why I had returned it!

I called Amazon again. The executive was categorical that nothing could be done. Even speaking to a

senior, I was told, would make little difference. I then mentioned that I understood such calls were recorded and that, if nobody could resolve the matter, I might have to consider legal recourse. Things suddenly began to move. Someone contacted me, the pickup details were verified, and after another round of follow-up, my money was refunded. My purpose in recounting this experience is not merely to complain about a defective phone or poor service. Each person appeared constrained by the part of the system visible to them.

And still, for almost a month, the problem belonged to nobody. More troubling is what happens to those who do not have the time, confidence or resources to persist. Technology and standardised processes allow large organisations to handle millions of transactions efficiently. They are indispensable. But systems inevitably encounter situations they were not designed to anticipate. At that moment, someone needs both the willingness and the authority to look beyond the screen and ask whether what the system is saying actually makes sense. Perhaps the true test of a good system is not how smoothly it handles the routine, but how humanely it responds when something goes wrong. Ultimately, someone must be willing to own the problem.

The writer is a founder of Kala - Crazy About Literature And Arts, is an author, speaker, coach, arbitrator, and strategy consultant

PIC TALK

Artists perform during a 'Kalash Yatra' during the holy month of Shravan, at Badi Chaupar, in Jaipur. PHOTO: PTI

### DIGITAL EXPERIENCE

www.dailypioneer.com

facebook.com/dailypioneer

@TheDailyPioneer

instagram.com/dailypioneer

linkedin.com/in/The Pioneer

### VANDE MATARAM BELONGS TO EVERY INDIAN CITIZEN

As an octogenarian from a freedom-fighter family, though apolitical, I extend my full support to the Congress Working Committee's reaffirmation that only the first two stanzas of Vande Mataram should be sung at party programmes.

As a true patriot and free-minded citizen, how can I accept the last four stanzas, which the Modi Government has politically added to the patriotic narrative? Previous BJP governments under Atal Bihari Vajpayee and Lal Krishna Advani did not pursue this issue in the same manner.

Patriotic Indians are shocked, though not surprised, by the changing position of Prime Minister Narendra Modi. The RSS, the BJP's ideological parent, did not participate in the freedom movement and, until 2002, did not fly the Tricolour at its

headquarters. The attempt to impose a particular interpretation of patriotism also ignores the historical context surrounding Vande Mataram. In 1937, Rabindranath Tagore advised that the first two stanzas could be treated separately because they had a broader national character, while the later verses contained imagery that could be unsuitable for inclusive national gatherings. Mahatma Gandhi, Jawaharlal Nehru, Subhas Chandra Bose and Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel were also part of that larger national movement.

India's patriotism cannot be reduced to political ownership. Vande Mataram belongs to the entire nation, and no political party should issue certificates of patriotism.

BIDYUT K CHATTERJEE | FARIDABAD

### Sanctions tighten pressure on Iran

The United States is preparing its toughest sanctions in history against Iran, seeking to squeeze Tehran economically and cut off the financial lifelines sustaining it. Washington has also urged other countries, particularly China, a major buyer of Iranian oil, to join the effort. The proposed sanctions come alongside a revived US naval blockade, creating a pincer-like strategy designed to restrict Iran's access to trade, energy revenues and international markets. For Iran, the consequences could extend far beyond government corridors. Years of sanctions have already strained its economy, while the latest measures threaten to deepen Tehran's isolation amid heightened regional tensions. Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi has dismissed the US campaign as a failed strategy, arguing that intensifying economic pressure will not force Tehran into submission.

China, meanwhile, has rejected the premise that greater economic pressure will resolve the dispute, calling instead for diplomatic efforts. Its position could prove consequential as Washington seeks to restrict one of Iran's most important economic outlets.

The confrontation risks becoming a struggle over Iran's economic survival and its government's future.

BHAGWAN THADANI | MUMBAI

### Vande Mataram must unite India

The controversy raging across the nation over Vande Mataram is nothing short of tragic. A song that once united millions under the banner of freedom now finds itself entangled in divisive politics. During colonial rule, Indians sang it with pride; today, in an independent India, hesitation to sing it feels like a betrayal of that very spirit.

What is perplexing is the Congress party's decision to rake up the issue. Once built on Vande Mataram, the party now faces criticism for fragmenting its legacy. From Partition and the Syndicate-Indicate split to the division of Pakistan, critics point to a history of fractures. Now, they ask: "Is this the same Congress that fought for freedom?" The shame lies not in debate but in the perception that the party places itself above the nation. For the common Indian, the creed is simple: Rashtra Sarvopari – the nation above all. Mahatma Gandhi himself had warned that Congress might one day descend into a struggle for power rather than principle, even suggesting its dissolution after independence. Had that advice been heeded, perhaps the spectacle of public disrespect towards the national song would never have arisen. Every citizen must resist attempts to divide Vande Mataram. It is more than a song; it symbolises India's sacrifice, unity and pride. To diminish it is to diminish the nation's soul.

ARVIND TAPKIRE | MUMBAI

### Can growth come without integrity?

Amicus curiae and senior advocate Vijay Hansaria has informed the Supreme Court that serious criminal cases are pending against the chief ministers of 14 of the 28 states. Revanth Reddy of Telangana tops the list, while West Bengal's Suvenud Adhikari follows close behind.

At the same time, Prime Minister Narendra Modi speaks proudly of India crossing the \$4-trillion GDP mark and dreams aloud of a "trillion-dollar economy". But is this financial optimism worth celebrating if constitutional heads of states themselves stand tainted? Can India afford to bid adieu to morality in its quest to become a financial superpower? Economic growth is undoubtedly important, but prosperity without ethical governance risks undermining public trust. Political leaders hold immense responsibility, and allegations of serious criminality involving those at the highest levels of government inevitably raise questions about accountability, integrity and the standards expected in public life.

What we need is to moralise politics, not politicise morals. As philosopher Karl Popper warned, ignoring this distinction comes at our own peril. Development and ethical governance must go hand in hand. Without morality, even the most ambitious economic dreams risk becoming castles built on sand.

AVINASH GODBOLEY | MADHYA PRADESH

# Are we fair to the young of India?

India cannot afford to treat education merely as another administrative department. It is the principal instrument through which the nation prepares its future. And none should ignore the fundamental truth that the future of India is initially being shaped primarily in its classrooms, and only afterwards in other places



There are occasions in the life of every nation when generational transition suddenly attracts far greater attention than it usually receives. People tend to take the growing up of the next generation as a routine process, overlooking the fact that this process is profoundly influenced by the rapid changes in knowledge and technology, which in turn affect the psyche of every human being. The transition of a child from innocence to a fully developed personality depends significantly on the external socio-cultural environment, which, too, is changing dramatically and continuously.

The beginning of the academic year 2026-27 has been disturbed in several ways. One is not referring only to the agitations witnessed at Jantar Mantar in New Delhi and in Ranchi, Jharkhand. There are also reports from several places of school students protesting against the absence of basic amenities such as functional toilets and drinking water, as well as the shortage of teachers. One often wonders whether the Right to Education Act has truly delivered what it promised to the children of India. Needless to repeat, it is the quality of school education that ultimately determines the quality and level of excellence in higher education. Education systems that nurture students' ideas and imagination—the two divine gifts that every child receives at birth—are obviously destined to excel in innovation. If the power of ideas and imagination is not impeded by the uncritical pursuit of routine, outdated pedagogies and assessment systems, and is not further weakened by inadequacies in basic support structures, creativity would become evident everywhere and in every field. Such an environment would also provide fertile ground for curiosity, which is again a common human possession. It serves no professional or academic purpose if the establishment simply blames “outsiders” for agitations such as those witnessed at Jantar Mantar and Ranchi.

It is a hard fact that external elements sometimes intrude with borrowed agendas of disruption and sabotage, often with political support from those who have been ousted from power and are eager to return. They attempt to push their own hidden agendas into otherwise genuine movements. The presence of politicians and known disruptors in large numbers at Jantar Mantar was evident to everyone. The general perception is that the presence of antisocial elements and political proxies contributed to the escalation of the situation and the subsequent use of force and unacceptable violence. The young students and ideologically unconstrained citizens have also noticed how some of the most vocal politicians and intellectuals have maintained silence over the student agitation in Jharkhand.

Over the years, agitations, demonstrations and protests in India have often followed a familiar pattern. There is sufficient evidence from numerous instances of external elements intruding into movements and attempting to destroy their original purpose, even when the cause is entirely genuine. An agitation may begin with sincerity of purpose and raise an issue that deserves the serious attention of those in power and of the nation at large. Yet the intrusion of politicians—particularly unscrupulous politicians seeking to score political points—sometimes assisted by criminal elements, can deprive a genuine agitation of its positive intent.

In a democratic system, there is no need to convert every protest into a political tug-of-war between the government and the Opposition. When this happens, the original goal is gradually lost. This appears to be what happened during the Delhi agitation. The education minister resigned. But so what? Was the resignation the only goal identified by the students? Certainly not. The political class may naturally have been pleased with the development, but the criticality of the issues raised by the students was lost in the political contest. Such political manipulation leaves young students in a state of confusion and dilemma. The ghosts of paper leaks and the cancellation of examinations continue to keep future aspirants on tenterhooks. The role of the coaching mafia is not unknown. It is extremely depressing to observe that teachers and paper-setters—the very people entrusted with the responsibility of protecting the integrity of examinations—have, in some cases, been charge-sheeted for betraying the confidence reposed in them by the nation. The details of how such operations were allegedly planned and executed are



IF WE ARE SERIOUS ABOUT BECOMING A KNOWLEDGE-DRIVEN NATION, THE FIRST QUESTION WE MUST ASK OURSELVES IS SIMPLE BUT PROFOUND: ARE WE REALLY BEING FAIR TO THE YOUNG OF INDIA?

The author is an educationist, a Padma Shri awardee, and works in religious amity and social cohesion

# Gen Z: A vibe is not a revolution



ACHARYA PRASHANT

Look at him on the road to Parliament. Twenty-two, hoarse from sloganeering, phone held high, live streaming his defiance to the nation, background music perfectly chosen. The country has decided he is a revolution.

Now look at the same phone an hour later, on the bus home. The astrology app is open, because a job interview is coming and the stars must be consulted. There are three messages from his mother about a girl his parents have shortlisted; he will oblige. And there is the spicy reel served by a machine that knows him better than he knows himself.

Both screens are real. The country has chosen to see only the first, and has begun garlanding it. I have spent more than twenty years looking at the second, in direct question and answer with the young, one person at a time, in lakhs. I am writing this to say: withdraw the garland. It is the surest way to make certain the young man never changes.

Every generation is certain that the next one is more rebellious. Hardly anyone asks: rebellious against what, and from where? The rebel himself has been assembled, by school, media, peer pressure, religion and culture. What they have produced is a type, and notice the type's very name: “Gen Z” was coined not by this generation but by marketers, people who slice the population into cohorts to sell to. A generation that wears its price sticker as its identity has already told you something about its condition.

I do not think anything has arrived. Leave the placards aside and see where this generation actually stands in line.

The astrology app market, worth some fourteen hundred crore rupees in 2024, is projected to grow tenfold by 2030; investors call it faith tech. Who pays? By the industry's own account, eighty-five per cent of users are under thirty-five. The market for superstition is being sponsored by the generation that calls itself forward-looking. And a person who cannot even beat imaginary stories will not stand up to a living oppressor.

The Lokniti-CSDS youth surveys complete the picture: more than half the young want a government job against a quarter who want to build their own; six in ten want a film banned if it hurts religious sentiment; eighty-four per cent of married youth had arranged marriages, overwhelmingly within caste.

I know the private face behind the placard; it sits before me daily. The questions are not about transforming the system. They are: my parents want me married, what do I do? The caste is different, how do I tell my father? A generation whose most urgent private question is how to find the courage to speak to its own father is being garlanded as the force that will confront the State!

Then there is love, the oldest school of intensity. A revolutionary is first a lover; both run on the capacity to stake everything on one thing. The heart that will not burn for a beloved is not about to burn for a nation.

The crowd wanted one minister to go. He went. And the education system that exists for the sake of “placements”, and the social system that pressures youth into suicides, stand exactly where they stood.

The grievances are legitimate: the queues for institutions and government jobs are long, and somebody breaking a queue is a fraud, and fraud deserves anger. But the anger was not against the queue; it was for the queue. A rebellion whose maximum demand is better admission into the machine is not a rebellion against the machine. It is the machine's own quality-control department, staffed free of cost.

Rebellion here is a mood one puts on, an aesthetic, what they themselves would call a vibe. And a vibe does not make a revolution. A vibe lifts when the weather changes. A revolution is what remains when the weather turns against you, and the weather turned the day one minister resigned.

There is a name for the root of all this: ahankaar, the ego. The ego is the first superstition. So long as there is an I here that must be secured at any cost, everything else follows. The ego is not afraid of revolutions; it steps into them happily. It is afraid of reality. Bring down one system, and the same centre hands you a brand new institution the next morning. Iran threw out the Shah in 1979 and put its women in the veil. Change of generation changes nothing. Change of centre is everything.

So, my young friends: everything above was said about you; now something to you. I am being blunt because I am your well-wisher, not your enemy. The ones celebrating you have known you for one news cycle; I have heard your silent wails for twenty years. Your restlessness is real, and it is the truest thing about you. My complaint is only with where you have been taught to fire from it: at the minister, at the system, at everything except the place it comes from.

Do not accept those coming to garland you; flattery is the cheapest salary ever invented, and it is paid to keep you asleep. The revolution you are capable of is nearer and harder: telling your father the truth this evening, deleting the app you consult before you dare to live, asking, when the anger rises, who exactly is burning in here. Stay with the question, because you will see your falseness on Tuesday and be back inside it by Friday, unless the seeing is joined by the intent to be free of it. That intent is the only thing entirely yours to give.

You have been cheated, yes, but the exam leaks and the rest are the small cheating. The big cheating is that in all your years of education, nobody ever turned your attention toward the one doing all the wanting and fearing. That education was your birthright, and it was withheld. Go get it: it requires one honest person, and you are allowed to be the first one you meet.

So drop the tag; it was never your name. You are not Gen Z or any fancy thing. You are not special, and hear that as the liberation it is. The work is the work it has always been.

It is open. It has always been open. Come.



Acharya Prashant is a philosopher and author whose work centres on self-inquiry and its application to contemporary life

# The next farm reform must protect India's harvest



As India marks Reforms Utsav, celebrating 12 years of governance reforms under the leadership of the Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi, agriculture stands out as a major success. The Government's farmer-first approach has focused on raising incomes, reducing cultivation costs, strengthening risk protection and bringing modern infrastructure and services from farm to market. Direct benefit transfers, crop insurance, institutional credit, irrigation, digital markets, farm infrastructure, soil health, mechanisation and technology-enabled advisories have together improved the operating environment for farmers.

The results are visible. India's total foodgrain production is estimated at 376.56 million tonnes in 2025-26, the highest ever in the country's history. Agricultural exports, which stood at USD 32.08 billion in FY 2014-15, are projected to reach a record USD 52.55 billion in FY 2025-26. Recent GST rationalisation has also supported this direction by reducing rates on tractors below 1800 cc, several bio-pesticides, micronutrients and other farm-linked inputs. On the farm advisory side, initiatives such as the National Pest Surveillance System and Bharat-VISTAAR are helping improve pest intelli-

gence and decision-making. These initiatives are laying the foundation for an integrated ecosystem where production, pest surveillance and market access are increasingly interconnected.

This is why crop protection should become a central part of the next phase of reform. A country producing and exporting at record levels needs a modern system to protect crops and preserve its competitive edge in global markets. Crop protection sits at the intersection of productivity, farmer income, food safety and export readiness. A pest outbreak can reduce yield. The wrong product or improper application can jeopardise residue compliance. A spurious input can damage the farmer's crop and weaken trust across the value chain.

These pressures are intensifying. Climate variability is changing pest behaviour and infestation windows. A study published in Science estimated that for wheat, rice and maize, yield losses from insect pests could increase by 10-25% for every degree Celsius of warming. Official estimates placed before Parliament suggest that pests, diseases and weeds account for about 10-35% of annual crop losses in India, depending on the crop and season. Separately, a CropLife India and YES Bank knowledge report estimates that nearly 72 lakh crore worth of crop yield is lost annually due to pests.

Pests are creating a market-access challenge as well. The EU RASFF system, the US FDA import refusal system and APEDA's export advisories show that residue compliance has become a recurring concern across high-value markets. APEDA's advi-



sory on rice exports to Lebanon illustrates how quickly residue-related concerns in one market can influence requirements elsewhere. Assam tea faces a similar challenge, with reports warning that tighter European residue limits could affect around 40 million kg of high-end Assam tea exports to Europe and the UK.

India's response must begin at the production stage. Compliance depends on farmers knowing which product is approved for which crop, how it should be applied, when it should be applied and how long the crop must wait before harvest. Integrated Pest Management must become more central in practice. Surveillance, correct diagnosis, economic thresholds, resistant varieties, field hygiene and responsible use of crop protection products all have a role. Better pest management is ultimately about correct use, not more use.

Access to a wider basket of crop protection technologies enables farmers to choose the most effective solutions for their crops and pest pressures. Yet India has only around 380 registered molecules, compared with nearly 1,200 available globally, limiting access to newer tools needed to manage resistance, improve productivity and meet evolving export standards. One reason for this gap is the absence of Protection of Regulatory Data (PRD) in India. A well-designed PRD framework can encourage innovation and facilitate faster access to newer, more selective and lower-dose crop protection solutions with improved stewardship practices. When used in accordance with approved labels and Good Agricultural Practices, these technologies can help farmers manage pests pressure more effectively, optimise spray intensity and better align with the increasingly stringent residue requirements of international markets. At the same time, farmer training, adherence to approved uses and pre-harvest intervals, along with robust testing and traceability systems, remain critical for ensuring compliance with prescribed Maximum Residue Limits (MRLs). Major agricultural economies, including the EU, the US and China, provide time-bound regulatory data protection to encourage innovation. India too can design a calibrated framework for new molecules that promotes earlier access to advanced technologies while preserving competition through independent data generation and eventual generic entry. Such a model would benefit farmers today and expand opportunities for domestic manufacturing and exports over time. Reforms Utsav should be seen not as the culmination of agricultural reforms, but as a call for the next phase. India has strengthened its

production base, built export-oriented systems and embraced digital agriculture. Crop protection regulation must now keep pace with this transformation. A Protection of Regulatory Data (PRD) framework can accelerate access to newer crop protection technologies and enhance the competitiveness of Indian agriculture. The proposed Pesticides Management Bill, 2025 presents a timely opportunity to provide the regulatory foundation for this transition by replacing the framework established under the Insecticides Act, 1968. Its focus on digitisation, stronger action against spurious products, improved compliance and enhanced regulatory oversight is a welcome step. To serve farmers in the next decade, the legislation should also enable faster registration pathways for innovative molecules, lower-risk products and new uses, alongside greater emphasis on label expansion for export-oriented and minor crops. As global markets become more demanding, these reforms are essential to protect yields, raise farm incomes and reinforce India's position as a trusted supplier in global agricultural trade.

The next milestone should be an ecosystem where crop protection decisions are guided by science, traceability, timely advice and access to modern tools, all geared towards improving outcomes for farmers. That is how India can secure farmer incomes, enhance food safety and build high-value agricultural exports that meet the standards of increasingly discerning global markets.

The writer is agriculture-policy analyst, writes on agro, issues, policies and reforms

## Your Trusted Management Advisory

[www.transglobeadvisors.in](http://www.transglobeadvisors.in)

## Order Order

### Saurav Das approaches Delhi HC over privacy breach



Cockroach Janta Party spokesperson Saurav Das on Friday approached the Delhi High Court seeking action against commentator Abhijit Iyer Mitra and several other law portals and media platforms for allegedly putting his residential details in public domain.

In his suit, Das has sought protection of his right to privacy, dignity and security and damages for alleged violation of his privacy rights.

The plaintiff has sought permanent and mandatory injunction against Iyer, X, Google and several law portals and media platforms from publishing, circulating or disclosing his residential details and direction to them to remove and disable public access to the videos and posts giving such details.

The plea sought a direction to X and Google to take down the content revealing the information.

Das, in his plea, said he has been living in a rented room in Greater Kailash here since last year and the defendants have unlawfully discovered, recorded, published and repeatedly disseminated his residential address and other personal details including his background, particulars of his parents and sexuality. (PTI)

### SC disposes of petitions concerning *The Kerala Story*



The Supreme Court on Friday closed the proceedings on a batch of petitions relating to the controversial 2023 film, *"The Kerala Story"*, while leaving open the question of law relating to challenges to certification of films by the Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC).

Chief Justice of India Surya Kant-led bench on Friday disposed of dozens of cases which were filed either during the COVID-19 period or became infructuous due to passage of time.

Dealing with two pleas seeking cancellation of CBFC certification of *"The Kerala Story"*, the bench, which also comprised Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, said that the petitions have become infructuous.

The third plea filed by the film's producers, Sunshine Pictures Pvt Ltd and Vipul Amritlal Shah, was withdrawn. The petition had challenged the then West Bengal Government's decision to ban the film.

The top court, in May 2023, had stayed the ban imposed by the state Government. Advocate Nizam Pasha, appearing for petitioners Qurban Ali and BR Aravindakshan in the other two matters, submitted that the issues raised by his clients continued to survive despite the film having already been released.

Pasha pointed out that the Kerala High Court had disposed of a writ petition concerning the film after observing that the plea was not maintainable against the grant of a certificate to a movie by the CBFC. (PTI)

## Supreme Court relaxes 3-year mandatory law practice norm for entry level judicial exam

**PIONEER NEWS SERVICE**  
■ New Delhi

In a major relief to law graduates, the Supreme Court on Friday reduced to a year the earlier mandatory requirement of three-year legal practice for them to take entry level judicial service examination.

However, the selected candidates will have to undergo training at the judicial academy and a further one-year clerkship, a bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices AG Masih and K Vinod Chandran said in a split decision of 2:1.

On May 20 last year, a bench headed by then Chief Justice of India BR Gavi, since retired, had barred fresh law graduates from appearing in the entry-level judicial services examination, fixing a minimum three-year law practice criterion.

On Friday, a three-judge



bench headed by CJI Kant, in a majority verdict of 2:1, modified the May 2025 verdict and relaxed the mandatory three-year legal practice criteria for law graduates aspiring to become judicial officers.

"All law graduates shall be eligible to apply, notwithstanding the three-year practice requirement. Having regard to the fact that more than a year has elapsed since the judgment under review was pro-



## Jharkhand HC gives relief to CDPOs

**PIONEER NEWS SERVICE**  
■ Ranchi

The Jharkhand High Court on Friday stayed the notifications cancelling the appointments of Child Development Project Officers (CDPOs) and those recruited through the JSSC-CGL examination.

The court on Thursday had stayed the notifications cancelling the 11th and 13th Jharkhand PSC exams, besides putting a clamp on the order cancelling the appointments of food safety officers.

"A bench of Justice Deepak Roshan today stayed the operation of the notification cancelling recruitments through Jharkhand Staff Selection Commission-Combined Graduate Level examination (JSSC-CGL), besides the one cancelling the appointments of CDPOs," petitioner's counsel Indrajit Sinha said.

He said a counter affidavit will be filed by the state on September 7, and by September 14, petitioners will submit a rejoinder.

"Also, the court has made it very clear that on September 15 it will hear the matter at 12.15 pm, earlier than scheduled 2.15 pm. The court also said that the matter has been taken on a priority basis," he said.

Advocate Amritansh Vats, who also represented the



petitioners, said the court was of the view that if the need arises, it will dispose of the matter by conducting day-to-day hearings from September 16.

"Today, the CDPO and JSSC-CGL matters were listed afresh. The court has granted an interim stay on both these matters on the ground of the principle of natural justice," he said. Vats said a PIL was earlier filed regarding the JSSC-CGL examination.

Hailing the stay, the Government employees protesting the cancellation of their appointments said the decision was unjustified.

"The abrupt decision to cancel our exams had taken a toll on my mental health. Today, I am relieved that my 11 years of hard work is not a complete waste. Since 2015, I had been preparing for the JSSC-CGL exam. I am confident that we will get justice

and our jobs will be safe," said Avinash Gupta, who is posted at the secretariat.

"Over the past few days, we were forced to sit in protest outside the secretariat," he added.

Meanwhile, the courtroom was packed with Government employees affected by the notifications. Celebrations broke out after the high court pronounced its order, giving relief to about 2,000 employees recruited through the JSSC-CGL exam.

In Thursday's order, the court said the JPSC exam was cancelled without following due process of law and principles of natural justice.

"This court is prima facie of the view that a regular appointment cannot be disturbed/terminated without following principles of natural justice," said the order, a copy of which was made available on Friday.

"This court feels that interest of justice and balance of convenience is paramount and in the instant case, the balance of convenience is in favour of the petitioners; inasmuch as, in effect they have been terminated without following any due process of law. Further, operation of this notification is also against public interest," it added.

The court also directed the Government's pleader to inform the department concerned to allow the petitioners as well as others, who are similarly situated and affected by this notification, to continue their work till disposal of the writ application.

"However, looking to the overall facts and circumstances of the case, all the petitioners are directed to file an affidavit/undertaking to the effect that the final order passed by the trial court in the connected criminal case shall be binding on them and the Government would be free to take appropriate action in accordance with law," the order said.

Amid a 25-day students' agitation over alleged irregularities in recruitment exams, the JMM-led Government on August 18 cancelled 22 exams and ordered a probe into 23 others, conducted since 2014.

## Jharkhand HC gives CBI 8 weeks to obtain documents in fodder scam cases

**PIONEER NEWS SERVICE**  
■ Ranchi

The Jharkhand High Court on Friday granted eight weeks to the CBI to obtain documents related to fodder scam cases involving RJD chief Lalu Prasad.

Devrshi Mandal, counsel for Prasad, said all the cases related to the fodder scam were listed for hearing before the court. "During the hearing, the CBI requested time from the court, stating that they do not have the documents. The court then directed the probing agency to obtain all documents from the registry within eight weeks, after which the next hearing date will be fixed," Mandal said.

He said the CBI had approached the Supreme Court seeking enhancement of Prasad's sentence and cancellation of his bail.

There are five fodder scam cases involving Prasad — two related to the Chaibasa treasury and one each to the Dumka, Deoghar and Doranda treasuries, Mandal said.

The Supreme Court on July 14 had refused to interfere with the Jharkhand High Court order granting bail to RJD chief Prasad in a fodder scam case. The top court was hearing CBI's plea challenging a July 2019 order of the high court.



"We are not inclined to interfere with the impugned order..." the bench had said.

The CBI had challenged the high court order, saying it had "erroneously" suspended the sentence awarded by the trial court and released the Rashtriya Janata Dal chief on bail in one of the fodder scam cases. Prasad, a former chief minister of Bihar, was convicted in the case related to the Deoghar treasury, which involved alleged defalcation of ₹89 lakh. The special CBI court convicted Prasad and sentenced him to three-and-a-half years in jail.

The high court had suspended the sentence and granted bail to Prasad in the case of alleged fraudulent withdrawal of ₹89.27 lakh from the Deoghar treasury on the ground that he had already completed half of the sentence.

## Calcutta HC grants interim protection to TMC MP Abhishek Banerjee in 3 FIRs

**PIONEER NEWS SERVICE**  
■ Kolkata

The Calcutta High Court on Friday granted interim protection to TMC MP Abhishek Banerjee from coercive police action in three FIRs lodged against him at different police stations in South 24 Parganas district.

Banerjee challenged the three criminal prosecutions — two at the Bishnupur and one at the Rabindranagar police stations in South 24 Parganas district in July.

Justice Saugata Bhattacharyya directed that no coercive steps be taken against Banerjee in connection with the three FIRs in this petition till September 11.

Justice Bhattacharyya said that since three other criminal prosecutions pending against Banerjee are questioned in a different petition, the order for which is scheduled to be delivered on August 25 by this court, the hearing of this petition stands adjourned till September 7.

The court directed that the protection order will not prevent police authorities from carrying out the investigation.

The court had already granted protection to Banerjee in the earlier three FIRs and in an FIR before the Bidhannagar police cyber crime cell.



The court was earlier informed that 16 FIRs are registered against Banerjee at different police stations.

On a plea by Additional Advocate General Rajdeep Majumdar that protection not be given to Banerjee before hearing the prosecution in

these three FIRs, the court said it has been hearing several petitions by the TMC MP challenging FIRs against him in different police stations lodged from May this year.

Majumdar claimed that Banerjee is a highly influential person and it was not possible for the complainants to lodge police cases earlier.

The BJP came to power in May, defeating the Mamata Banerjee-led Trinamool Congress Government, which governed West Bengal for 15 years from 2011.

The Diamond Harbour MP is the national general secretary of TMC and nephew of the former chief minister.

## Calcutta HC upholds FIR in ₹50 crore gold, cash seizure case

**PIONEER NEWS SERVICE**  
■ Kolkata

The Calcutta High Court on Friday dismissed a petition by the sister of alleged illegal sand and stone trader Tulu Mondal, challenging an FIR lodged against her in connection with the seizure of gold and cash worth ₹50 crore.

Petitioner Kabira Khatun's lawyer alleged illegality in the registration of the FIR, claiming that it was lodged after search, seizure and arrest of an accused.

He asserted that the sequence should have been registration of FIR, then arrest and there after seizure. Justice Saugata Bhattacharyya dismissed the petition, holding that this



Tulu Mondal

order is governed by a judgment of August 20 in which the court dismissed Mondal's petition, seeking that the FIR against him be quashed.

Khatun's petition challenged an FIR registered at

Mohammedbazar police station in Birbhum district in connection with the seizure of gold bars and cash worth around ₹50 crore from the residence of Mondal's brother-in-law Minar.

Police arrested Minar Mondal following the seizures on July 29, while Tulu Mondal, alias Mohammed Nazibuddin, is abroad since May 23.

The FIR was drawn up on July 30 following the seizures. Justice Bhattacharyya noted that the court had already dismissed a challenge by Tulu Mondal against an identical criminal prosecution based on the FIR, holding that this petition would be governed by the judgment delivered on August 20.

## SC refuses to quash criminal defamation complaint against Sukhbir Singh Badal

**PIONEER NEWS SERVICE**  
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Friday dismissed a plea filed by Shiromani Akali Dal (SAD) chief Sukhbir Singh Badal seeking quashing of a 2017 criminal defamation complaint against him.

Badal had moved the apex court challenging an October 2025 order of the Punjab and Haryana High Court refusing to quash the complaint and a March 2020 summoning order passed by a judicial magistrate.

According to the complaint, Badal, the then deputy chief minister of Punjab, alleged in January 2017 that religious organisation 'Akhand Kirtani Jatha' (AKJ) was a "political front" of terrorist outfit Babbar



Khalsa International.

The complainant, who filed the complaint in individual capacity, had claimed that he was the chief spokesperson of AKJ.

Badal's plea came up for hearing on Friday before a bench of Justices Dipankar Datta and Sheel Nagu.

"We have read this order. What is alleged against you (Badal)? You

said that this organisation is a terrorist organisation and this complainant is the spokesperson of the other organisation which is the political front..." the bench told Senior Advocate Kapil Sibal, who was appearing for Badal.

Sibal said Badal had not said that the complainant was the spokesperson of the organisation.

## SC sets aside order to summon telecom secretary in Dayanidhi Maran case

**PIONEER NEWS SERVICE**  
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Friday set aside an order of the Madras High Court which directed the trial court to summon the Union Telecom Secretary as a court witness in a case against DMK MP Dayanidhi Maran relating to the alleged setting up of "illegal" telephone exchanges.

A bench comprising Justices KV Viswanathan and Arun Palli was hearing a plea filed by the CBI challenging the March 25 order of the high court.

"Now that we are inclined to restore the order of the trial court, we permit the respondent (Maran) to summon the secretary telecom as a defence witness as indicated in our August 10 order.

"We set aside the high court's order and restore the trial court's order. We



DMK MP Dayanidhi Maran

permit the respondent to have the option to summon the secretary, telecom, as a defence witness, if he so desires," the bench said.

During the hearing, senior advocate Siddharth Luthra, appearing for Maran, objected to the telecom secretary being summoned as a defence witness and said it would be appropriate if he summoned as court witness.

On August 10, the apex court had asked advocates appearing for Maran as to why the secretary, telecom

cannot be summoned as a defence witness. It had also asked Additional Solicitor General SV Raju, appearing for the CBI,

whether he would have any objection if the secretary, telecom, is summoned as a defence witness.

Raju had told the court that he would not object to such a direction.

On March 25, the high court had allowed a plea by Maran to summon the Union Telecommunication Secretary to depose as a court witness before the

trial court in Chennai in the case.

The high court had said that Secretary's evidence was relevant to determining whether Maran, who was Minister of Communications and Information Technology between 2004 and 2007, was entitled to service-category telecom connections during the relevant period.

The trial court by its order dated October 10, 2025, had rejected Maran's prayer to summon the telecom secretary as the court witness.

The charges date back to the time when Maran was the Union minister for telecommunications and information technology in the UPA-I Government.

The CBI has alleged that he misused his official position and got private telephone exchanges installed at his various residences here which were used for business transactions of the Sun Network.

iexceed

Appzillon™

AI Powered Digital Banking Solutions

WWW.i-exceed.com

The Pioneer



NEW DELHI | SATURDAY | AUGUST 22, 2026

BUSINESS11

# Govt debunks ethanol link to sugar price surge

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

With sugar prices increasing rapidly, the Government has taken a series of measures to ensure a steady supply and has debunked claims that the surge was due to sugar diverted for ethanol production. In a related development, Pakistan sugar producers have urged the Government to explore possibilities to export the item to India after it allowed duty-free imports. Sugar is being sold from ₹68 to ₹72 a kg in the retail markets.

The Government attributed the increase to lower-than-expected sugar production, stronger demand ahead of the festive season, weather-related crop damage, tightening global supplies and speculation and hoarding by some

sections of the industry. "It is incorrect to attribute the recent increase in sugar prices to diversion of sugar for ethanol production," the Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food & Public Distribution said in a statement. The Government also stated that the global market is also facing tighter supplies.

According to the government's website, retail sugar prices rose to ₹55.70 a kg on August 20 from ₹48.18 a kg on July 20. The share of sugar diverted for making ethanol for doping in petrol, has, in fact, declined to around 9 per cent in the 2025-26 season from about 12 per cent in 2022-23, while nearly three-fourths of India's ethanol production now comes from grains, particularly maize, it said. To curb the price rise and ensure adequate avail-

ability, the Government has imposed a stock limit of 400 tonnes on sugar dealers nationwide until November 30. From September 1, bulk consumers will also be barred from holding stocks exceeding 15 days of consumption. The government has also approved duty-free imports of 1 million tonnes of raw sugar and ordered physical verification of stocks at

mills by joint central and state government teams to check hoarding and artificial scarcity. The ministry said domestic sugar production in the current season is expected to be around 30.6 million tonnes, compared with an initial estimate of about 34.3 million tonnes by sugarcane-growing states.

It attributed the shortfall to Red Rot and Top Borer dis-

eases affecting sugarcane, as well as waterlogging caused by excess rainfall. It said existing stocks remain adequate to meet domestic demand until the new crushing season begins in October.

The government estimates a sugar deficit of about 3.3 million tonnes in 2026-27, while international sugar prices have risen more than 16 per cent to \$ 552 a tonne on August 20 from \$ 474 a tonne on June 30.

The government said the ethanol programme has helped address structural surpluses in the sugar industry, strengthening mill finances and improving payments to farmers. India typically produces 32-34 million tonnes of sugar annually against domestic consumption of about 28-29 million tonnes. In surplus years, excess invento-

ries can lock up working capital at mills and contribute to delays in payments to sugarcane farmers.

As of August 20, 97 per cent of sugarcane dues for the 2025-26 season had been paid, the government said. It added that the industry's improved finances had reduced its dependence on government support, with around ₹14,600 crore in subsidies provided between 2014 and 2021 but no similar subsidy announced since 2021-22. The Government has also advised states and mills to begin crushing from October 15. This is expected to lift October sugar production to more than 1 million tonnes, compared with the usual 300,000-400,000 tonnes, helping strengthen supplies during the festive season.

## India's forex kitty swells \$9.9 to \$716.9 billion

India's forex reserves jumped \$9.905 billion to \$716.907 billion during the week ended August 14, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) said on Friday.

In the previous reporting week ended August 7, the overall kitty had jumped \$14.136 billion to \$707.002 billion. Reserves had expanded to an all-time high of \$728.494 billion during the week ended February 27 this year before the onset of the Middle East conflict that led to several weeks of a drop as the rupee came under pressure and the RBI had to intervene in the forex market through dollar sales. For the week ended August 14, foreign currency assets, a major component of the reserves, increased \$7.225 billion to \$ 581.851 billion, the central bank's data showed.

Expressed in dollar terms, foreign currency assets include the effects of appreciation or depreciation of non-US units, such as the euro, pound, and yen, held in foreign exchange reserves. The RBI and the government had launched a series of measures to attract more forex flows into the country last month, including the FCN (B) measure. The country has so far received \$56.85 billion under the concessional swap measures till August 13. (PTI)

## Stock markets end flat as elevated oil prices cap gains

Market benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty ended flat on Friday, a day after registering a rebound, as elevated crude oil prices induced by geopolitical uncertainties and a sharp fall in the US markets made investors cautious. In a largely range-bound trade, the 30-share BSE Sensex ended almost unchanged from the previous close at 77,540.83, up 3.11 points. During the day, it hit a high of 77,725.67 and a low of 77,445.86, gyrating 279.81 points. The 50-share NSE Nifty also ended flat, up 20.15 points, or 0.08 per cent, at 24,252.

A rebound in US Treasury yields and persistently elevated crude oil prices discouraged investors from taking aggressive directional positions, an expert said. (PTI)

## Foreign trade policy changes to add flexibility for exporters

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

The amendment in certain provisions of the Foreign Trade Policy to make it easier for exporters to invoice overseas sales and receive payments in Indian rupees will promote rupee internationalisation in trade settlement while providing exporters greater flexibility and certainty, CII said on Friday.

Sanjay Budhia, Chairman of the CII National Committee on EXIM and MD — Patton International, said Indian

industry remains committed to working closely with the Government to build on this momentum and further deepen India's global trade competitiveness.

The notification by the directorate general of foreign trade (DGFT) has made it easier for exporters to invoice

overseas transactions and receive payments in Indian rupees. He said that Indian industry welcomes the Government's continued efforts to simplify and modernise India's foreign trade framework, further easing the ecosystem for exporters.

Rupee export proceeds, other than for Nepal and Bhutan, routed through approved banking channels will now qualify for FTP benefits and count toward fulfilment of Export Obligations, at par with foreign-currency realisations, he said.

## Auto LPG industry seeks 5-year extension for commercial vehicles

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

The Indian Auto LPG Coalition (IAC) on Friday urged the Government to include Auto LPG-powered commercial vehicles in a proposed five-year extension of the age limit for certain vehicles operating under the national permit system.

The Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH) has proposed extending the prescribed vehicle age limit by five years for battery-operated, hydrogen fuel-based and natural gas-driven commercial vehicles covered by the national

permit regime. Welcoming the proposal, the IAC said Auto LPG vehicles that meet prescribed safety, fitness and emission standards should also qualify for the extension, arguing that cleaner-mobility policy should remain technology-neutral.

"The proposed five-year extension for EVs, hydrogen and natural gas vehicles is a welcome step, but cleaner mobility policy cannot be technology-selective. Auto LPG must also be included. It is a proven, readily available and cost-effective transport fuel that can reduce vehicular emissions today, including through the conversion

of suitable existing petrol vehicles. If the objective is to encourage cleaner transportation, every viable technology should have an opportunity to qualify based on its emissions performance, safety, affordability,

infrastructure readiness and contribution to energy security," said Suyash Gupta, Director General, Indian Auto LPG Coalition. The coalition

said any age extension for Auto LPG vehicles should remain conditional on com-

pliance with mandatory fitness, safety, emission and other regulatory requirements. The IAC's proposal comes as India seeks to accelerate the shift toward cleaner road transport while a large existing vehicle fleet remains on the country's roads.

The coalition said EVs and hydrogen-powered vehicles could play a growing role in the longer-term transition, but replacing the existing fleet entirely would take years. Converting suitable petrol vehicles to Auto LPG, it said, could offer an alternative way to reduce emissions from vehicles already in operation.

## Govt says 29 FDI proposals worth ₹4,895.65 cr reported after easing 10% Chinese stake rule

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

As many as 29 FDI proposals totalling about ₹4,895.65 crore (over \$ 500 million) have been reported so far following the government's decision in May to permit overseas companies with up to 10 per cent Chinese shareholding to invest in India under the automatic route, an official statement said on Friday.

Before May, these companies, even with a minor stake held by an individual or firm from a country sharing land

border with India, were required to seek government approval to invest in any sector in India. Following the demand from the stakehold-

ers, the government amended the norms.

As per the amendments, foreign companies having a Chinese/Hong Kong share-

holding of up to 10 per cent are eligible to invest in India in sectors where FDI is permitted under the automatic route, subject to sectoral conditions. However, these relaxed FDI rules do not apply to entities registered in China or Hong Kong or other countries sharing land borders with India. Countries that share land border with India are China, Pakistan, Bangladesh, Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar, and Afghanistan. The finance ministry notified the changes to this effect under FEMA on May 1, 2026.

## US markets struggle to find positive ending

ASSOCIATED PRESS  
■ Hong Kong

US markets pointed higher early on Friday, but for the first time in a month, major indexes are all at risk of closing the week in negative territory.

The futures for the S&P 500 rose 0.3 per cent, the Dow Jones Industrial Average gained 0.4 per cent and Nasdaq futures climbed 0.6 per cent. For the week, the Dow and the S&P are down 1.81 per cent and 1.85 per cent, respectively, before the opening bell, and the Nasdaq is down 2.48 per cent. It would be the second consec-

utive week of losses for the Dow. Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent this week attempted to put a lid on longer-term borrowing costs, which have weighed on

markets, but the results have been muted.

The Treasury announced Wednesday that it will at least double the size of its planned purchases of longer-

term government debt, and Bessent signalled Thursday that the repurchase program could be larger.

The announcement temporarily brought down government bond yields, which have been elevated by concerns about high inflation partly caused by the war in Iran and rising US government debt. But economists believe the effect on bond yields is temporary.

The yield on the US 10-year Treasury was around 4.70 per cent, up from nearly 4.64 per cent on Thursday and back near its level before the Treasury Department's announcement.

## US to accept new Form I-485 for green card applications

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
■ Washington

A new application form for green card will come into effect next month and any submissions made using the older versions will be rejected after September 18, the US Citizenship and Immigration Services (USCIS) has said.

The new Form I-485 to Register Permanent Residence or Adjust Status replaces the January 20, 2025 edition and aligns with the new public charge rules that come into effect from September 18, said the USCIS, operating under the Department of Homeland Security. The USCIS will reject the January 20, 2025 edition of Form I-485 if it is postmarked or electronically submitted on or after September 18. The agency is providing a preview



version of the new edition of Form I-485 and its instructions because there is no grace period for accepting the revised edition. It has made it clear to applicants not to file the revised edition of Form I-485 before September 18.

The old version of Form I-485 will be accepted only if it is postmarked or electronically submitted before September 18. Earlier, the US expanded the definition to deny immigration applications of those availing benefits such as Medicaid, food stamps or any subsistence aid from the Government.

## Myanmar military strike kills 14 at Buddhist monastery

ASSOCIATED PRESS  
■ Bangkok

An airstrike on Friday by Myanmar's military on a Buddhist monastery in Myanmar's central Sagaing region killed 14 people who were taking part in a week-long meditation retreat, an Opposition group and a resident said.

The attack is the latest in a series of frequent and deadly aerial strikes targeting armed pro-democracy forces and ethnic armed



groups in the country. The strikes often cause civilian casualties.

The attack occurred on

Friday at 9 am in Swel Le Oh village in Myaung township, about 75 kilometers (45 miles) west of Mandalay,

the country's second-largest city, according to Nway Oo, a spokesperson for the Civil Defence and Security Organisation of Myaung Township, or CDSOM. Nway Oo said 14 people, including three women, were killed and 20 others were wounded when a jet fighter dropped a bomb in the compound of the village's monastery.

A villager who spoke on condition of anonymity also confirmed the death toll to *The Associated Press*.

## Alamgir takes oath as Bangladesh's President

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
■ Dhaka

Veteran politician Mirza Fakhrul Islam Alamgir was on Friday sworn in as Bangladesh's 23rd President.

Alamgir, a longtime secretary general of the ruling Bangladesh Nationalist Party, was administered the oath by Jatiya Sangsad (Parliament) Acting Speaker Kayser Kamal at the Darbar Hall of Bangabhaban, the official office-cum-residence of the head of State. Prime Minister Tarique



Rahman, Opposition Leader Shafiqur Rahman, former Chief Adviser Muhammad Yunus, Cabinet ministers, top army brass and several other

officials were present at the oath ceremony. Ahead of his oath ceremony, Alamgir visited the graves of BNP founder Ziaur Rahman and former prime minister Khaleda Zia, and offered prayers. Alamgir, a close ally of Khaleda Zia, defeated his lone rival Colonel (retd) Oli Ahmed, the nominee of the Jamaat-e-Islami-led 11-party opposition alliance, in the first contested poll for the post in 35 years.

The 78-year-old BNP stalwart secured 255 votes while Oli Ahmad bagged 88 votes.

| AXIS BANK                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                 |                                                |                                                                              |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Retail Asset Centre: Axis House, Jaypee Green Wsh Town, Tower-2, 4th Floor, Sec-128, Noida Expressway, Noida-201301 Corporate Office: Axis House, Block-B, Bomsay Dyring Mills Compound, Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai-400025 Registered Office: "TRISHUL" - 3rd floor, opposite Samarathwas Temple, Near Law Garden, Ellisbridge, Ahmedabad-380006 Also at Axis Bank Ltd. Himsleya House, Upper Ground Floor & First Floor, KG Marg, Connaught Place, New Delhi-110001                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                 |                                                |                                                                              |
| Publication of Notice regarding possession of property u/s 13(4) of SARFAESI Act 2002                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                 |                                                |                                                                              |
| Notice is hereby given under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (SARFAESI Act) and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13 (12) read with rule 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, a demand notice was issued on the dates mentioned against each account and stated herein after calling upon them to repay the amount, within 60 days from the date of receipt of said notice. The Borrower having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him/her under section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 9 of the said Act on the dates mentioned against each account. The Borrower in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of the Axis Bank Ltd. for an amount and interest thereon. The borrowers attention is invited to provisions of sub-section (8) of Section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available to redeem the secured assets. |                                 |                                                |                                                                              |
| Name of Borrower/Co-borrower: 1. Mr. Rajiv Kumar S/o. Mr. Pawan Kumar R/o. H. No. 111, Bassapur Ghazabad, UP-245301 Also At: Mr. Rajiv Kumar S/o. Mr. Pawan Kumar H. No.-C-370, Tower No-9, 3rd Floor, Densh Nagar Pithuwa, Hapur, UP-245304 2. Mr. Rishu Saini S/o. Ram Singh Saini H. No.-140, Dr. Madanlal Wale Chh, Pithuwa, Hapur, UP-245304 Also At: Mr. Rishu Saini S/o. Ram Singh Saini H. No.-C-370, Tower No-9, 3rd Floor, Densh Nagar Pithuwa, Hapur, UP-245304                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                 |                                                |                                                                              |
| PROPERTY ADD: Property Bearing No. Flat No. C-370, Located In Mohalla Dinesh Nagar, Near Rampura Pithuwa Pargana, Dasha Tehsil, Dhauwala District Hapur, Tower No-09, Block No- 11, Tind Road, Having An Area Of 505 Sq. Feet, 146 Sq. Meters, Which Is Fully Covered (Does Not Include Ownership Of Rights Of The Road), And Bounded As Under: North-As Per Title Deed, East-As Per Title Deed, West-As Per Title Deed, South-As Per Title Deed                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                 |                                                |                                                                              |
| Date of Demand Notice: 14-Sep-2023                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Date of Possession: 18-Aug-2026 | Amount in Demand Notice (Rs.): 9,64,622/-      | (Rupees Nine Lakh Sixty Four Thousand Six Hundred Twenty Two Only)           |
| Name of Borrower/Co-borrower: Late Mr. Umesh Kumar Through Legal Heirs 1. Mrs. Sunita Kumari W/o. Late Umesh Kumar G-1004, Annapurna Platinum Appis, 10th Floor, Sector-119, Noida, Uttar Pradesh-201301 Also At: Mrs. Sunita Kumari Village Arjunpur, Post Beksar, Bihar-856033 Also At: Mrs. Mr. Sandeep Kumar Apartment No.-C-1802, 18th Floor, Block No-12, 18th Floor, Sector-119, Noida, Uttar Pradesh-201301 Also At: Mrs. Sandeep Kumar Apartment No.-C-1802, 18th Floor, Block No-12, 18th Floor, Sector-119, Noida, Uttar Pradesh-201301 Also At: Mrs. Sandeep Kumar Apartment No.-C-1802, 18th Floor, Block No-12, 18th Floor, Sector-119, Noida, Uttar Pradesh-201301 Also At: Mrs. Sandeep Kumar Apartment No.-C-1802, 18th Floor, Block No-12, 18th Floor, Sector-119, Noida, Uttar Pradesh-201301                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                 |                                                |                                                                              |
| PROPERTY ADD: Residential Apartment No.-C-1802 On 18th Floor, Block - C, In The Multi-storied Building Constructed Under The Name And Style As "Prithvi Labort", At Gh-6, In Township Known As Crossings Republic, Dundaheha, Ghazabad, Uttar Pradesh And Bounded As Under: East - As Per Title Deed, West - As Per Title Deed, North - As Per Title Deed, South - As Per Title Deed                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                 |                                                |                                                                              |
| Date of Demand Notice: 14-Sep-2023                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Date of Possession: 18-Aug-2026 | Amount in Demand Notice (Rs.): 26,28,849/-     | (Rupees Twenty Six Lakh Twenty Eight Thousand Eight Hundred Forty Nine Only) |
| Name of Borrower/Co-borrower: 1. Amil Kumar 902 Navkarvika Deepa Complex, Adajan Road, Sur, Gujarat-395009 (Borrower) 2. Harshita Chandra 902 Navkarvika Deepa Complex, Adajan Road, Sur, Gujarat-395009 (Borrower) 3. Anil Kumar Verma Flat No-604 Tower-02, Tulsi Garden Sec-70, Gurgaon, Haryana-122001 Guarantor                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                 |                                                |                                                                              |
| PROPERTY ADD: Unit No-C-407, 4th Floor, Block-C, Anshik Sanskriti, Nh-24 Indrapuram, Ghazabad, Uttar Pradesh-201010                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                 |                                                |                                                                              |
| Date of Demand Notice: 14-Jun-2025                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Date of Possession: 17-Aug-2026 | Amount in Demand Notice (Rs.): Rs. 60,18,923/- |                                                                              |
| Name of Borrower/Co-borrower: 1. Amit Kumar 1609 Parkview Ave 149, Near Lake USSA, Cell-95128 (Borrower) 2. Brignata Vanshika Flat No. A-206, Silver Pearls Apartment, Ahar Builder, Chhodasaura, Bangalore, Karnataka-560099 Co-(Borrower)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                 |                                                |                                                                              |
| PROPERTY ADD: Unit No-C-905, 8th Floor, Block-C, Anshik Sanskriti, Nh 24 Ghazabad, -201010                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                 |                                                |                                                                              |
| Date of Demand Notice: 14-Jun-2025                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Date of Possession: 17-Aug-2026 | Amount in Demand Notice (Rs.): Rs. 48,88,000/- |                                                                              |
| Name of Borrower/Co-borrower: 1. Mr. Gopal Singh S/o. Mr. Satya Pal Singh R/o. H. No-2211, Near Namak Mandir, Sector-137, Noida Gh-01 Expressway, Noida-Uttar Pradesh-201301 2. Mr. Poo Doo19-44th Floor Tower-D, Era Divine Court, Sec-5, Palwal, Haryana-121002 3. Mrs. Disha Singh W/o. Mr. Gopal Singh R/o. H. No-2211, Near Hanuman Mandir, Sector-08, Faridabad, Haryana-121004 (co-borrower) PROPERTY ADD: All Piece & Parcels Of PVL- D0019-4F, 4th Floor, Tower-D, Era Divine Court, Sector-5, Palwal, Haryana                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                 |                                                |                                                                              |
| Date of Demand Notice: 24-Nov-2025                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Date of Possession: 17-Aug-2026 | Amount in Demand Notice (Rs.): Rs. 12,26,675/- | (Rupees Twelve Lakh Twenty Six Thousand Six Hundred Seventy Five Only)       |
| Name of Borrower/Co-borrower: 1. Mr. Md. Izzat Alam R/o. House No. E-77, Block-E, Shashi Garden, New Delhi-110029 2. Brignata Vanshika Flat No. A-206, Silver Pearls Apartment, Ahar Builder, Chhodasaura, Bangalore, Karnataka-560099 Co-(Borrower) 3. Mr. Md. Izzat Alam R/o. House No. E-77, Block-E, Shashi Garden, New Delhi-110029 Co-(Borrower)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                 |                                                |                                                                              |
| PROPERTY ADD: All That Piece And Parcel Of Flat No. 06, First Floor, Sector-G-2, Pocket-02, Block-e-1, Narela, New Delhi-110040 And Bound As Under: East - As Per Title Deed, West - As Per Title Deed, North - As Per Title Deed, South - As Per Title Deed                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                 |                                                |                                                                              |
| Date of Demand Notice: 28-Jun-2025                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Date of Possession: 18-Aug-2026 | Amount in Demand Notice (Rs.): Rs. 54,762/-    | (Rupees Five Lakh Ninety Four Thousand Seven Hundred Sixty Two Only)         |
| Name of Borrower/Co-borrower: 1. Mr. Santosh Kumar Singh S/o. Mr. Rameshwar Prasad Singh R/o. H. No-69-B, 3rd Floor, Pocket-B, Janta Flats, Santa Vihar, New Delhi-110076 Also At: Mr. Santosh Kumar Singh S/o. Mr. Rameshwar Prasad Singh S/o. Mr. T-6-504, 5th Floor, La Residencia, Gh-06, Gautam Buddha Nagar, UP-201301 (Applicant) 2. Mrs. Babita Pandey W/o. Mr. Santosh Kumar Singh R/o. H. No-69-B, 3rd Floor, Pocket-M, Janta Flats, Santa Vihar, New Delhi-110076 (Co-applicant)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                 |                                                |                                                                              |
| Date of Demand Notice: 21-Aug-2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Date of Possession: 17-Aug-2026 | Amount in Demand Notice (Rs.): Rs. 17,07,220/- | (Rupees Seventeen Lakh Seven Thousand Two Hundred Twenty Only)               |
| Name of Borrower/Co-borrower: 1. Mr. Dharampal Singh S/o. Mr. Ram Singh H. No-494, Bahatta Hazipur Alapur Loni, Uttar Pradesh-201102 (Applicant) 2. Mrs. Yashoda W/o. Mr. Dharampal H. No-494, Bahatta Hazipur Alapur Loni, Uttar Pradesh-201102 (Co-applicant) 3. Mrs. Jyoti D/o. Mr. Dharampal H. No-494, Bahatta Hazipur Alapur Loni, Uttar Pradesh-201102 (Co-applicant) Property Add: Residential Flat No. 101, Tower-H, 4th Floor, 1st Tower-H, Bharat City Phase-II, Indrapuram Ghazabad, UP                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                 |                                                |                                                                              |
| Date of Demand Notice: 20-Apr-2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Date of Possession: 18-Aug-2026 | Amount in Demand Notice (Rs.): Rs. 17,38,123/- | (Rupees Seventeen Lakh Thirty Eight Hundred Twenty Three Only)               |
| Name of Borrower/Co-borrower: 1. Mr. Bikash Chandra Roy R/o. Plot No. 508, Tower No.26 Paras Teria, Sector-137, Noida Gh-01 Expressway, Noida Uttar Pradesh-201301 2. Asmita Roy R/o. Plot No. 508, Tower No.26 Paras Teria, Sector-137, Noida Gh-01 Expressway, Noida Uttar Pradesh-201301                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                 |                                                |                                                                              |
| PROPERTY ADD: Flat No. 1803, 1st Floor Paras Teria, Tower 25, Sector-137, Noida Gh-01 Expressway, Noida Uttar Pradesh-201301 Bounded As Under: East - As Per Site Plan, West - As Per Site Plan, North - As Per Site Plan, South - As Per Site Plan                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                 |                                                |                                                                              |
| Date of Demand Notice: 21-Apr-2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Date of Possession: 17-Aug-2026 | Amount in Demand Notice (Rs.): Rs. 4,020,574/- | (Rupees Forty Lakhs Twenty Thousand Five Hundred Seventy Four Only)          |
| Name of Borrower/Co-borrower: 1. Mr. Vinod Kumar S/o. Mr. Ram Prasad Lal G 115 Sec 23 Sanjay Nagar, Ghazabad, UP-201012 Mrs. Babita Kumar G 115 Sec 23 Sanjay Nagar, Ghazabad, UP-201012                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                 |                                                |                                                                              |
| PROPERTY ADD: Property Bearing Flat No-1907, 19th Floor, Tower B5 Plot No. GH-01, Sector-16B, Eco Village-II, Greater Noida, UP-201303                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                 |                                                |                                                                              |
| Date of Demand Notice: 20-Apr-2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Date of Possession: 17-Aug-2026 | Amount in Demand Notice (Rs.): Rs. 7,65,265/-  | (Rupees Seven Lakh Sixty Five Thousand Two Hundred Eighty Five Only)         |
| Name of Borrower / Co-borrower: 1. Mohd Parvez S/o. Mr. Nizamuddin R/o C-570, First Floor, Pocket-II, Jasola Vihar, New Friends Colony, South Delhi Delhi-110025 Also At: Mohd. Parvez (Proprietor) TST Garments B-10-11, Gali No-5, Kandi Nagar Extension, Near Railway Line Delhi-110051 Also At: Mohd Parvez S/o. Mr. Nizamuddin Flat No-B-177 Pocket-II, Jasola, New Delhi-110025 2. Mrs. Tabassum Parvez W/o. Mohd. Parvez R/o C-570, First Floor, Pocket-II, Jasola Vihar, New Friends Colony, South Delhi Delhi-110025 Also At: Mrs. Tabassum Parvez W/o. Mr. Mohd. Parvez R/o G-11, Sector-137, Noida Gh-01 Expressway, Noida, UP-201301 Bounded As Under: East - As Per Site Plan, West - As Per Site Plan, North - As Per Site Plan, South - As Per Site Plan                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                 |                                                |                                                                              |
| Date of Demand Notice: 20-Apr-2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Date of Possession: 17-Aug-2026 | Amount in Demand Notice (Rs.): Rs. 7,79,592/-  | (Rupees Seven Lakh Seventy Nine Thousand Five Hundred Ninety Two Only)       |
| Date: 22-Aug-2026, Place: Delhi/NCR Authorized Officer, Axis Bank Ltd.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                 |                                                |                                                                              |

| SMFG India Home Finance Co. Ltd.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Corporate Off.: 503 & 504, 5 <sup>th</sup> Floor, G-Block, Inspire BKC, BKG Main Road, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai - 400051 Regd. Off.: Commercial IT Park, Tower B, 1st Floor, Plot No. 111, Mount Pounamallee Road, Porur, Chennai - 600116, TN                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                           |
| SALE NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTIES                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                           |
| E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE OF 15 DAYS FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE ASSETS UNDER THE SECURITIZATION AND RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS AND ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT, 2002 READ WITH PROVISION TO RULE 9(1) OF THE SECURITY INTEREST (ENFORCEMENT) RULES, 2002.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                           |
| Notice is hereby given to the Public in General and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below listed immovable properties ("Secured Assets") mortgaged / charged to the Secured Creditor, the Possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of SMFG India Home Finance Co. Ltd. (hereinafter referred to as SMHFC) ("Secured Creditor"), will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is" and "Whatever there is" on the date and time mentioned herein below, for recovery of the dues mentioned herein below and further interest and other expenses thereon till date of realization, due to SMHFC Secured Creditor from the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) mentioned herein below. |                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                           |
| Sl. No.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Name of the Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) LAN                                                                  | Description of the Properties                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Reserve Price / Earnest Money Deposit / Date & Time of E-Auction / Date of EMD Submission |
| 1.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Lari No. 620639211948447 & 620639211949221<br>1. Vipin Rajbir W/o. Rajbir<br>2. Mithlesh Rajbir W/o. Rajbir | Flat No. SF-04, Second Floor, LHS Flat With Roof, On Plot No. B-133, B-134, B-135, Area Measuring 46.18 Sq. Meters, i.e. 497 Sq. Ft., Out Of Khassa No. 311 Situated At Rai Vihar, Shekhan Awas Smiti Ltd. In The Area Of Village Sadullabad, Pargana And Tehsil Loni District Ghaziabad Bounded: East -Road 30 Feet Wide, West -Plot No 0b -142, B-143, B-144, North-Plot No -132, South -Plot No -B134                                                                                        | Rs. 14,20,000/-<br>Rs. 1,42,000/-<br>12.09.2026 at 11.00 AM to 01.00 PM                   |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                             | Flat No. UGF-04, Upper Ground Floor, LHS Flat Without Roof, On Plot No. B-133, B-134, B-135, Area Measuring 46.18 Sq. Meters, i.e. 497 Sq. Ft., Out Of Khassa No. 311 Situated At Rai Vihar, Shekhan Awas Smiti Ltd. In The Area Of Village Sadullabad, Pargana And Tehsil Loni District Ghaziabad Bounded: East -Road 30 Feet Wide, West -Plot No 0b -142, B-143, B-144, North-Plot No -132, South -Plot No -B134                                                                              | Rs. 13,90,000/-<br>Rs. 1,39,000/-<br>12.09.2026 at 11.00 AM to 01.00 PM                   |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                             | Flat (Without Roof Rights) Plot No B 42, Khassa No 217 Area Measuring 316 Sq. Ft. i.e. 29.36 Sq. meter., In Rai Vihar Colony Tehsil Loni Distt. Ghaziabad UP Bounded As Under- East- Plot No B-41 West- Plot No B-43 North-Plot No 77 South- Rasta 30 Ft Wide                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Rs. 8,00,000/-<br>Rs. 80,000/-<br>12.09.2026 at 11.00 AM to 01.00 PM                      |
| 2.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | 1. Jitender Jain<br>2. Meenu Jain                                                                           | Residential Flat Bearing No. SF-2, On Second Floor, Front Middle Side, Covered Area Measuring 467 Sq. Ft. "Said Flat", Built On Property Bearing No. B-81, (Area Measuring 260 Sq. Yds), Out Of Khassa No. 218, Situated At Rai Vihar, Shekhan Awas Smiti Ltd, Village Sadullabad, Pargana And Tehsil Loni District Ghaziabad, (U.P.) (Hereinafter Referred As The Said Property). Boundaries: - East- Vacant Plot, West- Plot No B-80, North- Rasta, South- Plot No B-38                       | Rs. 13,50,000/-<br>Rs. 1,35,000/-<br>12.09.2026 at 11.00 AM to 01.00 PM                   |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                             | Flat Bearing No. B 010 Upper Ground Floor H:J Back Side In Block - B, Covered Area 90 Sq Meter, Without Roof Rights "Said Flat" Built On Out Of Khassa No 503/3, "Organic Homes Situated In The Area Of Village Makapur Pargana Loni Tehsil & Distt Ghaziabad -201014                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Rs. 38,90,000/-<br>Rs. 3,89,000/-<br>12.09.2026 at 11.00 AM to 01.00 PM                   |
| 3.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | 1. Kamal Chand<br>2. Sonkar<br>3. S/O-Dallas Chand Sonkar<br>2. Rama Dal Chand<br>W/o. Dallas Chand Sonkar  | Residential Flat Bearing No GF-3, On Ground Floor Rear Rhs Without Roof Rights Said Flat Built On Plot Bearing No A-153, Area Measuring 280 Sq.Yds., Out Of Khassa No 346/1, Situated At Rai Vihar, Shekhan Awas Smiti Ltd In The Area Of Village Sadullabad Pargana And Tehsil Loni Distt. Ghaziabad UP Boundaries - East- Other Property West- Plot No A-54 North- Other Property South- Road 30 Ft Wide                                                                                      | Rs. 14,90,000/-<br>Rs. 1,49,000/-<br>12.09.2026 at 11.00 AM to 01.00 PM                   |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                             | Flat Bearing No. F-05 On First Floor Rear Side Rhs Referred To As The "Said Flat" Of Residential Plot Bearing No. B-133, B-134 & B-135 Area Measuring 100+100+100-300 Sq Yds, Failing In Khassa No. 311, Situated In Rai Vihar, Shekhan Awas Smiti Ltd., Hadbad Village Sadullabad, Pargana & Tehsil Loni, Distt. Ghaziabad (UP) (Hereinafter Referred To As The "Said Property"). Boundaries (As Per Technical) East Entry & Flat No. F1-02 West Vacant Plot North Vacant Plot South Staircase | Rs. 8,00,000/-<br>Rs. 80,000/-<br>12.09.2026 at 11.00 AM to 01.00 PM                      |
| 4.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Lari No. 609139211833923<br>1. Shadab Mirza<br>2. S/o. Aslam Mirza<br>2. Taranum Mirza<br>W/o. Shadab Mirza | Flat No. Ulf-5 On Upper Ground Floor Back Portion Lhs Admeasuring 554 Sq Ft Without Roof Rights Built On Free Hold Plot No B-3 & B-4 Total Land Admeasuring 368 Sq Yds Plot No 1207 Situated At Hayat Enclave Village Loni Pargana & Tehsil Loni Ghaziabad UP-201103                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Rs. 10,90,000/-<br>Rs. 1,09,000/-<br>12.09.2026 at 11.00 AM to 01.00 PM                   |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                             | Flat No GF-3 Ground Floor, Rear Lhs Without Without Roof Rights, Area Measuring 465 Sq.ft Built On Plot No B-15/2 Df, Ankur Vihar Sadullabad Tehsil Loni Distt Ghazabad-201011                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Rs. 12,90,000/-<br>Rs. 1,29,000/-<br>12.09.2026 at 11.00 AM to 01.00 PM                   |
| 5.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Lari No. 605439211525649<br>1. Anand Kashyap<br>2. Vikas Bholanath                                          | Residential Ground Floor Rhs Witout Roof Rights, Built On Plot No 71, Area Measuring 470 Sq.ft Out Of Khassa No 223, Situated At Block B Nearby Rai Vihar Gate, Rai Vihar Shekhan Awas Smiti Ltd. Hadbad Village Sadullabad Pargana & Tehsil Loni Distt Ghaziabad                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Rs. 13,10,000/-<br>Rs. 1,31,000/-<br>12.09.2026 at 11.00 AM to 01.00 PM                   |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                             | Flat No Ulf-07 On Upper Ground Floor (Rear Lhs Middle) Without Roof Rights "Said Floor" Built On Covered Area Measuring 88 Sq.mtrs., Out Of Khassa No 503/3 "Organic Homes" Situated In The Area Of Village Makapur Pargana Loni Distt Ghaziabad                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Rs. 32,30,000/-<br>Rs. 3,23,000/-<br>12.09.2026 at 11.00 AM to 01.00 PM                   |
| 6.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Lari No. 613938011886374<br>1. Deepika Gupta<br>2. Vivek Kumar                                              | Residential Flat Bearing No Ulf 008 On Upper Ground Floor, Hig (Rear Lhs) Without Roof Rights "Said Flat" Area Measuring 90 Sq. mtrs, Out Of Khassa No 503/3 "Organic Home" Situated In The Area Of Village Makapur Pargana Loni Distt Ghaziabad UP-201014                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Rs. 32,20,000/-<br>Rs. 3,22,000/-<br>12.09.2026 at 11.00 AM to 01.00 PM                   |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                             | Flat No. 101, Tower-H, 4th Floor, 1st Tower-H, Bharat City Phase-II, Indrapuram Ghazabad, UP                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Rs. 1,31,000/-<br>Rs. 1,31,000/-<br>12.09.2026 at 11.00 AM to 01.00 PM                    |
| 7.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Lari No. 605439211525649<br>1. Anand Kashyap<br>2. Vikas Bholanath                                          | Residential Flat Bearing No Ulf 008 On Upper Ground Floor, Hig (Rear Lhs) Without Roof Rights "Said Flat" Area Measuring 90 Sq. mtrs, Out Of Khassa No 503/3 "Organic Home" Situated In The Area Of Village Makapur Pargana Loni Distt Ghaziabad UP-201014                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Rs. 32,20,000/-<br>Rs. 3,22,000/-<br>12.09.2026 at 11.00 AM to 01.00 PM                   |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                             | Flat No. 101, Tower-H, 4th Floor, 1st Tower-H, Bharat City Phase-II, Indrapuram Ghazabad, UP                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Rs. 1,31,000/-<br>Rs. 1,31,000/-<br>12.09.2026 at 11.00 AM to 01.00 PM                    |
| 8.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Lari No. 605439211709986<br>1. Rajan Kumar Jha<br>2. Laxmi Vijay Jha                                        | Residential Flat Bearing No Ulf 008 On Upper Ground Floor, Hig (Rear Lhs) Without Roof Rights "Said Flat" Area Measuring 90 Sq. mtrs, Out Of Khassa No 503/3 "Organic Home" Situated In The Area Of Village Makapur Pargana Loni Distt Ghaziabad UP-201014                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Rs. 32,20,000/-<br>Rs. 3,22,000/-<br>12.09.2026 at 11.00 AM to 01.00 PM                   |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                             | Flat No. 101, Tower-H, 4th Floor, 1st Tower-H, Bharat City Phase-II, Indrapuram Ghazabad, UP                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Rs. 1,31,000/-<br>Rs. 1,31,000/-<br>12.09.2026 at 11.00 AM to 01.00 PM                    |
| 9.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Lari No. 613938011886374<br>1. Anuradha Singh<br>2. Rahul Kumar                                             | Residential Flat Bearing No Ulf 008 On Upper Ground Floor, Hig (Rear Lhs) Without Roof Rights "Said Flat" Area Measuring 90 Sq. mtrs, Out Of Khassa No 503/3 "Organic Home" Situated In The Area Of Village Makapur Pargana Loni Distt Ghaziabad UP-201014                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Rs. 32,20,000/-<br>Rs. 3,22,000/-<br>12.09.2026 at 11.00 AM to 01.00 PM                   |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                             | Flat No. 101, Tower-H, 4th Floor, 1st Tower-H, Bharat City Phase-II, Indrapuram Ghazabad, UP                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Rs. 1,31,000/-<br>Rs. 1,31,000/-<br>12.09.2026 at 11.00 AM to 01.00 PM                    |
| 10.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Lari No. 613938011886374<br>1. Anuradha Singh<br>2. Rahul Kumar                                             | Residential Flat Bearing No Ulf 008 On Upper Ground Floor, Hig (Rear Lhs) Without Roof Rights "Said Flat" Area Measuring 90 Sq. mtrs, Out Of Khassa No 503/3 "Organic Home" Situated In The Area Of Village Makapur Pargana Loni Distt Ghaziabad UP-201014                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Rs. 32,20,000/-<br>Rs. 3,22,000/-<br>12.09.2026 at 11.00 AM to 01.00 PM                   |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                             | Flat No. 101, Tower-H, 4th Floor, 1st Tower-H, Bharat City Phase-II, Indrapuram Ghazabad, UP                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Rs. 1,31,000/-<br>Rs. 1,31,000/-<br>12.09.2026 at 11.00 AM to 01.00 PM                    |
| 11.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Lari No. 613938011886374<br>1. Sameer Nasa<br>2. Anju Nasa                                                  | Residential Flat Bearing No Ulf 008 On Upper Ground Floor, Hig (Rear Lhs) Without Roof Rights "Said Flat" Area Measuring 90 Sq. mtrs, Out Of Khassa No 503/3 "Organic Home" Situated In The Area Of Village Makapur Pargana Loni Distt Ghaziabad UP-201014                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Rs. 32,20,000/-<br>Rs. 3,22,000/-<br>12.09.2026 at 11.00 AM to 01.00 PM                   |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                             | Flat No. 101, Tower-H, 4th Floor, 1st Tower-H, Bharat City Phase-II, Indrapuram Ghazabad, UP                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Rs. 1,31,000/-<br>Rs. 1,31,000/-<br>12.09.2026 at 11.00 AM to 01.00 PM                    |

Details terms and conditions of the sale as below and the details are also provided on our/accured creditor's website at the following link website address: (https://BtdDeal.in and https://www.grishashakti.com/pdf/E-Auction.pdf) The Intending Bidders can also contact : Ashish Kaushal, on his Mob. No. 8527134222, E-mail : Ashish.Kaushal.grishashakti.com, Pankaj Kumar, on his Mob. No. 7380950199, E-mail : Pankaj.Kumar38@grishashakti.com, and Mr. Niloy Dey, on his Mob. 86565619157, E-mail : Niloy.Dey@grishashakti.com

Place : Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh  
Date : 22.08.2026

Sd/-  
Authorized Officer,  
SMFG INDIA HOME FINANCE CO. LTD.

|                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                           |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  <b>AXIS BANK LTD.</b> | <b>Axis Bank Ltd., Axis House, Tower T-2, 2nd Floor, I-14, Sector-128, Noida Expressway, Jaypee Greens Wishtown, Noida (U.P.)-201301.</b> |
|                                                                                                             | <b>REGISTERED OFFICE : TRISHUL – 3RD Floor Opp. Samarthwara Temple, Near Law Garden, Ellipz Road, Ahmedabad – 380015</b>                  |

**APPENDIX IV [Refer Rule – 81(i) POSSESSION NOTICE (For Immovable Property)]**

Whereas the undersigned being the Authorized Officer of Axis Bank Ltd. under the Securities and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13 (12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 issued deemed notice dated 14-Jan-2025 calling upon **MAHARAM & ANJU SHARMA (Borrower/Co-Borrower/Mortgagor)** to repay the amount mentioned in the notice being Rs. 19,95,300/- (Rupees Eighteen Lakh Ninety Five Thousand Three Hundred only) against as on 09-JUN-2025 and interest and cost thereon within 60 days from the date of receipt of said notice;

The Borrower(s)/Co-Borrower(s)/Mortgagor(s)/Guarantor(s) above said having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrower(s)/Co-Borrower(s)/Mortgagor(s)/Guarantor(s) and the Public in General that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him/her under Section 13 (4) of the Securities and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 in pursuance of Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 on 14-Jan-2025.

The Borrower(s)/Co-Borrower(s)/Mortgagor(s)/Guarantor(s) above said in particular and the Public in General is hereby cautioned not to deal with the properties and any dealings with the properties will be subject to the charge of the Axis Bank Ltd. for an amount of Rs. 19,95,300/- (Rupees Eighteen Lakh Ninety Five Thousand Three Hundred only) as on 09-JUN-2025 together with further interest thereon at the contractual rate of interest till the date of payment & expenses thereon.

The Borrower(s)/Co-Borrower(s)/Mortgagor(s)/Guarantor(s)'s attention is invited to provisions of sub-section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

**Description of Immovable property All that parcel and part of Property bearing:**  
 Unit No 1005 Tower B17, Eco M Village I, Sect. 7, G Noida, Noida, Uttar Pradesh – 201301 Please Note That As Mention In Sub Section 13 Of Section 13 Of The Aforesaid Act, You Shall Not Transfer By Way Of Sale, Lease Or Otherwise Any Of The Assets Stated Under Security Refered To Without Prior Written Consent Of Our Bank.

Date: 22-08-2026  
 Place: GR NOIDA, NOIDA

Sd/-, Authorized Officer  
 Axis Bank Ltd.



# US, South Korea cut short military drill

HYUNG-JIN KIM ■ Seoul

The US and South Korean militaries wrapped up their annual drill six days earlier than initially scheduled on Friday in a conciliatory gesture toward North Korea, though the North said the step isn't enough to persuade it to return to talks.

US President Donald Trump had earlier abruptly ordered the Pentagon to "substantially reduce" the Ulchi Freedom Shield exercise just before it began on Monday. Trump cited what he described as a good relationship with North Korean leader Kim Jong Un and South Korea's refusal to support him over the war in Iran.

South Korea's military said the Ulchi Freedom Shield, a command post exercise with the US, ended on Friday. This month's exercise was initially reportedly scheduled to be held in two phases for 11 days in simulation of North Korean attacks — the first part until Friday on defensive operations and the



second part until August 27 on counteroffensive operations. North Korea is extremely sensitive to the second phase.

South Korea and the US had also planned to hold 14 joint field training exercises during the Ulchi

Freedom Shield period. But they've agreed to halve them as well, according to South Korea's military. Kim Yo Jong, the influential sister of North Korean leader Kim Jong Un, brushed aside Trump's overture on Wednesday, saying that

reducing the duration and size of the drills won't change their "provocative, aggressive nature."

The next day, North Korea fired about 10 short-range ballistic missiles toward the sea, apparently following through with its previous threat to respond to the US-South Korean drills that it views as an invasion rehearsal.

The US Pacific Command said the events didn't pose an immediate threat to US territory or its allies. The command said the US remains committed to the defence of the US homeland and its allies in the region.

Kim Yo Jong's statement dampened hopes for an early resumption of talks between Trump and Kim Jong Un, whose earlier nuclear diplomacy collapsed in 2019.

Kim Jong Un has used the diplomatic stalemate to increase his leverage by modernising his nuclear and missile arsenals and aligning with Russia over its war against Ukraine. Kim Jong Un sug-

gested last year that he won't return to talks unless the US drops its demand for North Korean denuclearisation as a precondition for diplomacy.

Jong still used relatively measured language, avoided typical harsh North Korean rhetoric and touched upon what she called an "excellent" relationship between her brother and Trump.

This suggests North Korea doesn't want to completely shut the door for future talks and may seek to win bigger US concessions, such as international recognition as a nuclear state and broad sanctions relief.

More nuclear weapons, Russia ties give North Korea greater leverage With its supply of ammunition and troops to Russia, North Korea is likely receiving economic and military assistance in return, and its expanding ties with Russia provide it with leverage to ask for greater support from China, its biggest trading partner. (AP)

# 20,000 Pakistanis deported from South Asia countries due to security concerns

M ZULQERNAIN ■ Lahore

Over 20,000 Pakistani Nationals were deported from Gulf countries, mostly from Saudi Arabia and the UAE, in recent months due to security concerns and multiple reasons, amid the ongoing conflict between Iran and the US, according to official data.

According to the Narcotics Control Ministry data, presented before the National Assembly, several Pakistanis were also reportedly detained or deported for filming or uploading videos and material relating to Iranian attacks in their cities.

The Pakistani Nationals were deported between March 1 and July



13 from the Gulf Cooperation Council, comprising six countries — Bahrain, Kuwait, Oman, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, and the United Arab Emirates, the ministry said. The deportations were executed due to security concerns,

overstaying, illegal entry, begging, drug-related offences, refusal of asylum claims and forged or improper documentation. (AP)

**MADHYA PRADESH STATE TOURISM DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LTD.**  
Paryatan Bhawan, Bhadbhada Road, Bhopal-462003  
Ph. : +91-755-4027100, 2774340/42, www.mpstdc.com  
क्रमांक 395/यात्रिका/पत्रिका/26 दिनांक : 21.08.2026

**NIT No. 308/2026\_STDC\_531451\_1**

MPSTDC invites RFP for Selection of Agency for Plantation, Site Development, Protection and Long-Term Maintenance (11 year maintenance) Works at Identified Locations in Bhopal 2nd call. Project Cost 2272.40 lakhs.

Terms and Conditions can be downloaded from website <https://mptenders.gov.in>. For any other information contact Mrs. Manisha Gautam (EE) Contact No. 9754585667 Mr. Dr. KrapalSingh Verma (Astt. Director Horticulture), Mob. No. 9826479462 and or e-mail at [krapalverma@gmail.com](mailto:krapalverma@gmail.com). Last date and Time for Online Tender Purchase and submission is 07.09.2026 Time 05:00 PM.

M.P. Madhyam/127696/2026 EXECUTIVE ENGINEER

**NORTHERN RAILWAY**  
**E-TENDER NOTICE**

The Director/Admin, Northern Railway Central Hospital, New Delhi-110055, for and on behalf of the President of India invites sealed open electronic-tenders for under noted work:-

| S. No | Name of work                                                                                               | Approximate cost of work | Earnest money to be deposited | Completion period | Date of opening |
|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------|-----------------|
| 1.    | Supply of portable water through tankers at NRCH for one year in the section of SSE/W/NRCH under ADENNRCH. | Rs. 1699907.88           | Rs 34000/-                    | 12 Months.        | 15.09.2026      |

The e-tender is to be submit through railway website '[www.ireps.gov.in](http://www.ireps.gov.in)'. The tenders can be submit on website upto to 15:00 hrs. on 15.09.2026 and shall be opened there after.

NO: 128-W-269-O.E.T-06-26-27-NRCH Date:- 21.08.2026 2924/2026

**SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE**

**INDRAPRASTHA POWER GENERATION CO. LTD. & PRAGATI POWER CORPORATION LIMITED**  
(Govt. of NCT of Delhi Undertakings)  
Corporate Identity No. (CIN)-IPGCL- U40103DL20001SGC11530  
Corporate Identity No. (CIN)-PPCL- U74899DL20001SGC109135  
(ISO 9001-2008, 14001- 2007, 18001-2007 Certified Stations)  
ED(C&M), Pragati Power Station-I, I.P Estate, Ring Road, New Delhi-110002.  
TEL:011-23370541, FAX NO.011 23379164

**NIT No. 06/2026-27 TENDERING FOR ONLINE BIDDING Date: 03/08/2026**

Offers are invited in two parts system on e-tendering on the portal of Delhi Govt. at <https://govtprocurement.delhi.gov.in>, for the below items with tender closing time at 11:00 hrs. on bid submission date:-

| Tender ID & Description |                                                                                     | T-Value (Rs.)  |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| 01                      | 2026_IPGCL_296353<br>Upgradation of existing Pro-control P13 DDC/DCS system at GTPS | 8,30,00,000.00 |

**Corrigendum/Retender**

|    |                                                                                                                                                   |                |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| 01 | 2026_IPGCL_2892277<br>Procurement, installation and commissioning of two nos. Vacuum Pump with replacement of Existing Steam Jet Ejectors at GTPS | 2,95,37,500.00 |
| 02 | 2026_IPGCL_288150<br>Desilting/Cleaning of raw water reservoir compartment No 1 and compartment No2 at PPS-III, Bawana                            | 88,53,787.91   |

Note: 1) Tender Issue Date & EMD details:- Please visit IPGCL-PPCL website ([www.ipgcl-ppcl.gov.in](http://www.ipgcl-ppcl.gov.in))

2) Bid Submission End Date & Bid Opening Date: As per IPGCL-PPCL website and Delhi Govt e-portal

3) No Corrigendum/addendum/modification for tender value up to Rs 50.00 Lacs will be advertised in newspaper and bidders are requested to regularly visit IPGCL-PPCL website as well as Delhi Government E-procurement site for getting themselves updated.

**DIP/Shabdarth/Classification/0191/26-27**

# Russian strike kills 14 at shopping centre in Ukraine



ASSOCIATED PRESS ■ Kyiv

Russian drones struck a shopping centre in the city of Kryvyi Rih in Central Ukraine on Friday, killing 14 people and wounding scores of others, authorities said.

Six children were among the 91 injured in the afternoon strike in the city, which is the hometown of President Volodymyr Zelenskyy, said local administration head Oleksandr Vilkul. He said the rescue operation was ongoing and that the number of casualties could still rise.

Zelenskyy described the strike as a double tap, with an initial wave of drones striking the area, followed by a second wave as rescue workers responded.

"Attacks like these are nothing less than terrorist acts," Zelenskyy wrote on social media. Kryvyi Rih has been hit multiple times during the more than four-year-old war, with one of the deadliest occurring in April 2025,

when 20 people, including nine children, were killed.

Friday's attack came just 24 hours after Russia pounded the Ukrainian capital of Kyiv with scores of missiles and drones in a nighttime aerial attack that killed at least 16 people.

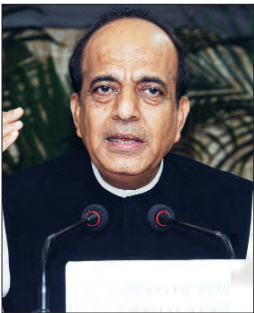
Moscow's forces have in recent months intensified their ballistic missile attacks on Kyiv, exploiting Ukraine's chronic shortage of US-made Patriot air defence interceptors, the sole weapon in its arsenal able to shoot down the missiles.

Large-scale Russian strikes have become a regular occurrence this summer. Just over two weeks ago, a Russian attack on Kyiv and its surrounding region killed 17 people, and nine were killed in the city two days before that.

The United Nations said last week that Kyiv was one of the hardest hit cities in July, with at least 54 civilians killed and 202 injured.

# Indian envoy meets Bangladesh FM

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
■ Dhaka



Indian envoy Dinesh Trivedi met Bangladesh Finance Minister Amir Khosru Mahmud Chowdhury and discussed bilateral development projects and issues of mutual interest.

The visit comes amid uncertainty surrounding Prime Minister Tarique Rahman's visit to India next month for the BRICS Summit following fresh strains in bilateral ties over Dhaka's demand for the extradition of deposed prime minister Sheikh Hasina. "High Commissioner Dinesh Trivedi paid a courtesy call on the Minister of

Finance and Planning of Bangladesh, Amir Khosru Mahmud Chowdhury, and held discussions on mutual interest on economic cooperation and bilateral development projects between India and Bangladesh," the High Commission of India in Bangladesh posted on X.

**GIC HOUSING FINANCE LIMITED**

HEAD OFFICE : National Insurance Building , 6th Floor 14 Jamshed Tata Road, Churchgate Mumbai -400020 GHAZIABAD AREA OFFICE: Shop No - 3, 1st Floor, Astoria Boulevard, RDC, Rajnagar, Ghaziabad - 201002. 0120-4995536/ 9918065222 Ghaziabad.ncr@gichf.co.in

**Ref:-POSSESSION NOTICE UNDER SUB-RULE (1) OF RULE 8 OF THE SECURITY INTEREST (ENFORCEMENT) RULES, 2002**

WHEREAS the undersigned being the Authorized Officer of GICHFL, pursuant to demand notice issued on its respective dates as given below, under section 13(2) of SARFAESI Act 2002 calling upon you/Borrowers (under named), to pay outstanding dues within 90 days from the date of receipt of the respective notices. You all have failed to pay the said outstanding dues within stipulated time, hence GICHFL are in exercise and having right as conferred under the provision of sub section (4) of section 13 of SARFAESI Act 2002 read with rules thereunder, taken POSSESSION of the Secured assets as mentioned herein below.

| Sr. No. | NAME OF THE BORROWER & CO-BORROWER/LOAN FILE NO./BRANCH NAME | ADDRESS OF THE MORTGAGED PROPERTY                                                                                                                                              | 13 (2) DEMAND NOTICE ISSUE DATE | O/S AS ON 20.08.2026 | DATE OF SYMBOLIC POSSESSION |
|---------|--------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|----------------------|-----------------------------|
| 1.      | UP0620600001902/ PRERNA SHARMA / GHAZIABAD                   | House No-2144-1/2, Subhash Nagar, Ghukna, Khasra no. 304, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201001                                                                                      | 15.10.2025                      | 957,324              | 21-08-2026                  |
| 2.      | UP0620600001158 / SHIV LAL / GEETA / GHAZIABAD               | Flat No. T-1, Third Floor, Plot No. 61, Khasra No. 68, (As Per Our System Plot No. Is 61 & 62) Akashawani Samiti, Village: Sadullabad, Loni, State: Uttar Pradesh, Pin 201102. | 15.10.2025                      | 2,219,952            | 21-08-2026                  |

Further, to this notice, borrower are hereby called upon in compliance of Sub-Rule (6) of Rule 8 of Security interest (enforcement) Rule, 2002, NOTICE is also hereby given to the borrowers above named that the GICHFL shall now proceed to sell the above-referred Secured Assets by adopting any of the methods provided under SARFAESI Act 2002 and rules thereunder after 30 days from the date of this notice.

The BORROWERS and the PUBLIC IN GENERAL is hereby cautioned not to deal with the above referred Properties/Secured Assets or any part thereof and any dealing with the said Properties/Secured Assets shall be subject to charge of GICHFL for the amount mentioned hereinabove against Properties/Secured Assets which is payable with the further interest thereon until payment in full.

"This notice is being published under Rule 8 (2) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 and also pasted at conspicuous place of the respective properties."

Date: 22.08.2026 Place: Ghaziabad

For GIC Housing Finance Ltd. Sd/- Authorised Officer

**New Okhla Industrial Development Authority**  
Main Administrative Office, Sector-96, Noida, G.B Nagar (U.P.)  
Website: [www.noidaauthorityonline.in](http://www.noidaauthorityonline.in)

**E-TENDER NOTICE**

E-Tenders are invited for the following job from eligible bidders who are registered on Prahan Software, these may be uploaded by the dates specified below, and the received E-tenders will be opened on the dates indicated against them. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on Noida Authority's official website: [www.noidaauthorityonline.in](http://www.noidaauthorityonline.in) & <https://etender.up.nic.in>. Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/amendments & corrigendum etc.

**A) Fresh-Tender Work:**

| Sl. No | JOB NO                  | NAME OF THE WORK                                                                                            | Tender Amount (Rs. Lacs.) |
|--------|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| 1      | 46/GM/SM (WC-1)/2026-27 | M/o Road (Beautification of footpath and Central verge at Noida Entry Gate on Expressway), Noida.           | 49.87                     |
| 2      | 125/GM/SM(WC-5)/2026-27 | M/o Road (R/o Garbage Collection Points in Sector-67 & 68), Noida.                                          | 66.31                     |
| 3      | 126/GM/SM(WC-5)/2026-27 | M/o Drain (Repair, Raising and Fencing of Boundary wall of Plot No. C-01 and N. School, Sector-121), Noida. | 97.05                     |

The above tenders can be uploaded from dated 24.08.2026 to 08.09.2026 up to 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on dated 09.09.2026 at 11.00 AM.

**B) Re-Tender Work:**

| Sl. No | JOB NO                  | NAME OF THE WORK                                                                                                              | Tender Amount (Rs. Lacs.) |
|--------|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| 4      | 12/GM/SM (WC-1)/2026-27 | D/o Village (R/o Plaster, Painting, Tile, Interlocking Tile etc. in Primary and Junior High School in Village Harola), Noida. | 47.83                     |

The above tenders can be uploaded from dated 24.08.2026 to 31.08.2026 up to 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on dated 01.09.2026 at 11.00 AM.

General Manager (Civil)  
NOIDA

**CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA**

**HINDUSTAN AUTO FINANCE LIMITED**  
CIN: L65910DL1980PLC010617  
Regd. Office: Cabin No. DA-8, 02<sup>nd</sup> Floor, Vikas Marg, Shakarpur, New Delhi-110092  
Email: [hindaf1980@gmail.com](mailto:hindaf1980@gmail.com), Website: [www.hindaf.in](http://www.hindaf.in)

**NOTICE OF 46<sup>th</sup> ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING, REMOTE E-VOTING AND INTIMATION OF BOOK CLOSURE**

NOTICE is hereby given that the 46<sup>th</sup> Annual General Meeting ("AGM") of members of **Hindustan Auto Finance Limited** will be held on Wednesday, 30<sup>th</sup> September, 2026 at 11:00 a.m. at the registered office of the Company to transact the businesses as set out in the Notice convening the AGM.

The Annual Report for the financial year 2025-26 including the Notice convening AGM along with Attendance Slip and Proxy Form has been sent to members whose emails are registered with their depository participants as at close of business hours on Friday, August 14, 2026. Physical copy of the Annual Report along with AGM Notice has been sent by permitted mode to members who have not registered their e-mail address. The emailing and dispatch of Annual Report along with Notice of AGM has been completed on Thursday, August 20, 2026. The Annual Report along with the Notice convening the AGM is available on the website of the Company at [www.hindaf.in](http://www.hindaf.in), website of Metropolitan Stock Exchange of India Limited, and on the website of Central Depository Services (India) Limited (CDSL) at [www.evotingindia.com](http://www.evotingindia.com).

The shareholders whose email ids are not registered with Company/RTA or with respective DPs may temporarily get their email id registered with the Company by sending e-mail at [hindaf1980@gmail.com](mailto:hindaf1980@gmail.com) and follow the temporary registration process as guided thereafter to receive the Annual Report for FY 2025-26 along with the Notice of AGM which inter-alia contains the instructions for attending the AGM. However, for permanent registration of email id, members are requested to approach their respective DPs and follow the process advised by DPs.

Pursuant to provisions of Section 91 of the Companies Act, 2013 ("Act") and the applicable rules framed thereunder and Reg.42 of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, ("Listing Regulations"), the register of members and share transfer books of the Company will remain closed from Thursday, September 24, 2026 till Wednesday, September 30, 2026 (both days inclusive) for the purpose of 46<sup>th</sup> AGM of the Company.

Pursuant to Section 108 of the Companies Act, 2013 and Rule 20 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014, as amended and Regulation 44 of Listing Regulations, the Members are provided with the facility to cast their votes on the resolutions set forth in the Notice of AGM using electronic voting system from a place other than venue of the AGM ('remote e-voting'), provided by Central Depository Services India Limited (CDSL) and the business may be transacted through such voting. The voting rights of members shall be in proportion to the equity shares held by them in the paid-up equity share capital of the Company as on the cut-off date, i.e. Wednesday, September 23, 2026. Any person who is a member of the Company as on the cut-off date is eligible to cast vote on all resolutions set forth in the Notice of AGM using remote e-voting or voting through ballot paper at the AGM.

The remote e-voting period commences on Sunday, September 27, 2026 at 09:00 a.m. IST and ends on Tuesday, September 29, 2026 at 05:00 p.m. IST. During this period, members may cast their vote electronically. The remote e-voting module shall be disabled by CDSL thereafter and remote e-voting shall not be allowed beyond the said date and time. Once vote on a resolution is cast by the member, he/she will be allowed to change it subsequently or cast the vote again. The detailed procedure for voting has been mentioned in the AGM Notice. The facility for voting through ballot paper shall also be made available at the AGM and members who have not cast their vote by remote e-voting shall be able to exercise their right at the AGM through ballot paper. The Members who have cast their vote by remote e-voting prior to the AGM may also attend the AGM, but shall not be entitled to cast their vote again.

A person who acquires shares and become a member of the Company after the dispatch of notice of the AGM and holding shares as of cut-off date, may obtain the login ID and password by sending a request to [helpdesk.evoting@cdslindia.com](mailto:helpdesk.evoting@cdslindia.com). However, if he/she is already registered with CDSL for remote e-voting, then he/she can use his/her existing User ID and password for casting the votes.

The Board of Director has appointed CS Anju Bansal, proprietor of M/s Anju Bansal & Associates, Company Secretary in Practice (COP No. 17594) as the Scrutinizer to scrutinize the 'remote e-voting' process and voting at the AGM, in a fair and transparent manner. The results of AGM will be announced by the Chairman or any other person authorised by him and will be submitted along with report of scrutinizer within two working days from the conclusion of AGM to Metropolitan Stock Exchange of India Limited and also be posted on the Company's website [www.hindaf.in](http://www.hindaf.in).

In case of any queries or grievances regarding e-voting, you may refer the Frequently Asked Questions ("FAQs") and e-voting manual which is available at [www.evotingindia.com](http://www.evotingindia.com) under help section or contact at 022-23058542/43. In case of grievances relating to e-voting, please contact Mr. Rakesh Dalvi, Sr. Manager at 25<sup>th</sup> Floor, A Wing, Marathon Futrex, Mafatlal Mills Compound, NM Joshi Marg, Lower Parel (E), Mumbai-400013; Email: [helpdesk.evoting@cdslindia.com](mailto:helpdesk.evoting@cdslindia.com) or aforesaid number.

**For Hindustan Auto Finance Limited**  
Sd/-  
**Place: New Delhi**  
Date: August 21, 2026

**Rishabh Aggarwal**  
(Company Secretary & Compliance Officer)

PROSPECT

Technology helping ICICI Prudential Life bring down its savings cost-to-premium ratio

ICICI Prudential Life Insurance's sustained investment in technology and automation along with other cost optimisation initiatives has played a central role in bringing down its cost-to-premium ratio for the savings line of business to 13.6 per cent in Q1-FY2027. It has reduced by 50 basis point over the previous year, even as the Company continues to scale its business.

Commenting on this, Ganessan Soundiram, Chief Technology Officer, ICICI Prudential Life Insurance, said, "At ICICI Prudential Life Insurance, our investments in bolstering the Company's digital infrastructure have not only empowered our customers but also enabled us to deliver an enhanced customer experience across their policy life cycle. We are leveraging AI, analytics and platforms such as ICICI Pru Partner Stack, IPRU Edge, etc. to strengthen customer acquisition, distributor effectiveness, servicing and operational efficiency."

TOLIC Delhi-2 presented awards to NBCC and its employees in various categories

On August 19, Anshuli Arya, IAS, Secretary, Department of Official Language, Ministry of Home Affairs, Government of India, and Vikas Kumar, Chairman, TOLIC Delhi (Undertaking-2) and Managing Director, DMRC, presented Trophy/Shield to TD Mairal, GM (HRM/IR/Rajbhasha), along with other officials in token of appreciation for the publication of the 20th edition of NBCC's Hindi In-house magazine & exemplary promotion of official language.

Additionally, during the same meeting in the Individual Employee category, Jai Ram, AGM (Finance), Vandana Ojha, Manager (Official Language), Ramesh Kumar Vaish, Manager (HRM) and Arvind Kumar Srivastava, Executive (NBCC), have also received awards for their outstanding performances in various Rajbhasha competitions.

Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham PhD admissions 2026 to close on August 31

Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham has announced that Ph.D. admissions for the 2026 intake in Engineering, Artificial Intelligence, and Computing will close on August 31, 2026. All selected scholars were awarded grants of up to 25 lakhs, which includes funding for research, publications, and international travel. Additional tuition fee waivers are available for eligible women scholars.

Candidates holding a postgraduate degree with at least 60 per cent marks are eligible to apply. GATE/UGC-NET qualified candidates are exempt from the entrance test. Interested applicants must apply before the deadline via [www.amrita.edu/phd](http://www.amrita.edu/phd) or contact [phd@amrita.edu](mailto:phd@amrita.edu) for details.

Collaboration key to securing India's digital financial ecosystem: IBA CEO

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

Mumbai

Growing cyber threats, digital fraud, data protection and technology risks call for a collaboration among all stakeholders to secure the country's digital financial ecosystem, Atul Kumar Goel, CEO of bankers' body IBA, said on Friday.

No single institution can tackle the challenges of India's growing digital financial ecosystem. Therefore, there is a need for collaboration between the regulator, the bank, fintech companies, technology firms, auditors, forensic experts, academicians, and the law enforcement, the chief executive officer of the Indian Banks' Association (IBA), said, addressing the ICAI-Bharat DIGIT 2026.

"This collaboration is essential in the area of fraud prevention, forensic investi-



Atul Kumar Goel

gation, cybersecurity, data governance, AI and technology-enabled assurance," Goel said.

The two-day ICAI-Bharat DIGIT 2026, organised by the Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI), seeks to strengthen digital governance and trust, promote cyber resilience, encourage technology-



enabled assurance, enhance fraud risk management, build capacity in digital investigation and foster collaboration between regulators, Government and financial institutions.

He said that customer trust is very important in the banking sector and should not be breached at any cost. "If the customer's trust is

breached, then there is a challenge in the industry as well. We look forward to strengthening collaboration in fraud prevention, forensic investigation, cyber security, data governance, AI and technology-enabled assurance.

"The future of digital finance will not be defined only by how fast we can innovate; it will be defined by how confidently people can trust that innovation," Goel added.

Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India (IBBI) Chairperson Ravi Mital, who was also present on the occasion, said as accounting and financial processes become increasingly digital, systems must be designed to be robust, secure and resilient from the beginning.

"Professionals must move beyond routine compliance to early risk identification and actionable insights," he added.

Minister Rajesh Nagar to inaugurate mega health camp in Tigaon today

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

Faridabad

Haryana Government Minister Rajesh Nagar will inaugurate a mega health check-up camp at Ajay Nagar Vatika in Tigaon on Saturday. The camp is being jointly organised by the Rotary Club of Faridabad Excellence and Amrita Hospital with the objective of providing accessible and free healthcare services to people in the region.

The mega health camp will offer free consultation with specialist doctors for a range of health-related problems. Along with general health check-ups, facilities will be available for the diagnosis and consultation of orthopaedic and gynaecological conditions.

Basic health screening tests, including blood pressure, blood sugar, BMI and cholesterol, will also be conducted free of cost. To promote early detection and prevention of breast cancer among women, free mammography tests will be offered at the camp.



In addition, dental and eye examinations will be conducted, and necessary implants and spectacles will also be provided free of cost to eligible beneficiaries.

According to the organisers, a team of specialist doctors will assess the health concerns of visitors and provide necessary medical advice and medicines without charge. The camp is expected to particularly benefit people who face difficulties in accessing regular health check-ups or consulting specialist doctors.

The initiative also aims to create greater awareness among people about preventive healthcare and encourage them to take timely precautions based on their health condition.

Jitendra Prasad, VSM, ADG (East) visits project Udayak

TONY DAS

Guwahati

Jitendra Prasad, VSM, ADG (East), Border Roads Organisation, visited the Area of Responsibility (AoR) of Project Udayak from 16 to 19 August 2026, reviewing the progress of works and interacting with personnel deployed across the challenging terrain of the Northeast.

During the visit, the ADG was briefed at Project Headquarters on the overall planning, priorities and schedule of works for the current year, as well as the proposed plan and schedule for the ensuing year. He provided valuable guidance and direction towards achieving the project's operational and developmental objectives.

The ADG also visited the forward areas of Project Udayak and took stock of the progress of works on the ground. Drawing upon his extensive experience in the Border Roads Organisation



and his years of service in demanding operational environments, he interacted with ground executives, listened to their challenges and provided practical guidance for enhancing the execution, quality and pace of works.

His interaction with the officers and personnel working in the field infused a renewed sense of purpose, energy and enthusiasm among the men and women of Project Udayak.

He urged the entire team to raise the bar, utilise their capabilities to the maximum and achieve targets much beyond what is expected of them.

Gujarat Governor attends EXCEED Awards, calls for rooted sustainability

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

New Delhi

Gujarat Governor Acharya Devvrat attended the 21st EXCEED Environment, HR and CSR Awards and Conference 2026 as chief guest. The event was organised by *Ek Kaam Desh Ke Naam* at Ramada by Wyndham, Motera, Ahmedabad.

Addressing the gathering, the Governor said true sustainability could only be achieved by staying deeply rooted in Indian culture, traditional wisdom and timeless values. He encouraged individuals, institutions and industries to adopt responsible practices aimed at protecting nature, strengthening communities and securing a sustainable future for coming generations.



Rajiv Babbar, President of Ek Kaam Desh Ke Naam, presented an overview of the organisation's vision, journey and nation-building initiatives at the event. He urged every citizen to contribute at least one meaningful action toward the nation, saying that if each of India's 140 crore citizens took up such an effort, their combined contribution could play a transformative role in realising the vision of a developed India.

The conference honoured several leading organisations for their achievements in Environment, Human Resources and Corporate Social Responsibility. Companies recognised for their contributions included GAIL (India) Limited, Lupin Limited, NTPC Limited and Tata Power, among others, for their responsible initiatives and exemplary work in these areas.

Central Bank of India organises mega retail outreach programme in New Delhi

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

New Delhi

A Mega Retail Outreach Programme was successfully organised by the Central Bank of India, Delhi South, at the India International Center Annexe, New Delhi, on Friday

The programme was graced by the presence of Kushal Pal, Chief General Manager; Tarsem Singh Zira, Zonal Head Delhi; Munish Rana, Regional Head — Delhi South; and Mandeep Kumar, Deputy Regional Head — Regional Office Delhi South, whose guidance and encouragement added great value to the event.

The outreach programme



witnessed enthusiastic participation from esteemed customers. During the event, multiple sanction letters were handed over to customers, in addition to reinforcing the bank's commitment towards expanding retail business and strengthening customer relationships.

During the event, a presentation on various retail products was given by the bank staff. A total of approx Rs. 200 crore was sanctioned in the Outreach Camp.

Vigilance Campaign: The ongoing vigilance and compliance initiatives undertaken by the bank to uphold high governance standards, transparency, and consumer trust.

sensation on various retail products was given by the bank staff. A total of approx Rs. 200 crore was sanctioned in the Outreach Camp.

Vigilance Campaign: The ongoing vigilance and compliance initiatives undertaken by the bank to uphold high governance standards, transparency, and consumer trust.

IndianOil's Energy Soldiers to strengthen nation's energy security: Director (Refineries) Arvind Kumar

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

New Delhi

Arvind Kumar, Director (Refineries), IndianOil, led the 80th Independence Day celebrations at IndianOil Township, Noida, joined by Team IndianOil and their families.

The event opened with a rendition of the Rashttra Geet, marking 150 years of Vande Mataram, followed by the National Anthem and flag hoisting by Kumar.

In his address, he reflected on India's journey since Independence and called on employees to help build a nation that is economically resilient, technologically advanced, environmentally responsible and energy self-reliant.



"We inherited a free India. Let us leave behind a stronger one - stronger in energy security, innovation, self-reliance and character," he said.

Kumar highlighted IndianOil's role in sustaining the nation's energy lifelines through conflict, pandemic

and geopolitical disruption, reaffirming the philosophy of "Pehle Indian, Phir Oil." He described IOCIans as "Energy Soldiers" who have optimised operations and reconfigured logistics to keep essential fuel supplies uninterrupted. Looking ahead, he outlined

priorities including safety, operational reliability, innovation, digital transformation - alongside strategic projects, indigenous technologies, specialty products, petrochemicals, and the application of AI and machine learning to shape a sustainable, self-reliant energy future.

Addressing the youngest members of the gathering, Kumar called children "the future of Bharat," urging them to dream fearlessly, stay curious and help shape a Viksit Bharat by 2047.

The celebrations also featured long service and meritorious children awards, along with cultural performances by IndianOil's children, Ladies Club members and the choir group.

DAILY SUDOKU

1526

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★★☆

HOW TO SOLVE IT

Sudoku is a logic puzzle where you fill a 9x9 grid so that numbers 1 to 9 appear once in every row, column, and 3x3 box, using elimination and logical deduction- no maths involved.

SOLUTION (21.8.26)

|   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2 | 7 | 5 | 6 | 4 | 8 | 9 | 3 | 1 |
| 1 | 8 | 6 | 9 | 5 | 3 | 2 | 4 | 7 |
| 4 | 3 | 9 | 1 | 2 | 7 | 6 | 5 | 8 |
| 9 | 6 | 2 | 3 | 7 | 1 | 5 | 8 | 4 |
| 7 | 1 | 4 | 5 | 8 | 9 | 3 | 2 | 6 |
| 3 | 5 | 8 | 4 | 6 | 2 | 7 | 1 | 9 |
| 5 | 4 | 1 | 7 | 3 | 6 | 8 | 9 | 2 |
| 8 | 9 | 7 | 2 | 1 | 5 | 4 | 6 | 3 |
| 6 | 2 | 3 | 8 | 9 | 4 | 1 | 7 | 5 |

DOUBLE CROSSWORD

SATURDAY | AUGUST 22, 2026

ACROSS

1 Mark's dog? (5)

6 Financial houses supporting many anglers (5)

9 When wildly to dash way out to the laundrette? (7)

10 Show no haste to be a toady? (5)

11 Revolutionary linen weaver (5)

12 Birds may or may not pay theirs (5)

13 Decorate by carving of stone (7)

15 Cough or breathe on them (3)

17 Pale due to having a fling? (4)

18 Gloomy and apt to become more so (6)

19 Tough master embraced by a lady at a party? (2-3)

20 Explosive effect created by a boxer? (6)

22 Mention in some excitement (4)

24 Shell-like part of a pearl (3)

25 Vessel useful to a smoker? (7)

26 Wine and a piece of seaside rock? (5)

27 A militant start is as much as you can manage (5)

28 What it is to be wise, proverbially (5)

29 Disadvantages a minister exploits? (7)

30 Caper by a six-footer, I see (5)

31 Tired of attrition? (5)

face? (5)

14 She has far less to cut (5)

15 Escape with a sprained ankle, perhaps? (3,2)

16 It measures many a gnarled tree (5)

18 Spell of wizardry (5)

19 One who believes in being disagreeable? (7)

21 To rain stormily but in small amount (6)

22 Masticates noisily, if you like (6)

23 One you can't bank on to keep a secret? (6)

25 The blooming lot, useless! (5)

26 She provides a duplicate copy for me (6)

28 But they meant a lot as fliers (3)

DOWN

2 Cash prizes arranged by the press around the centre court (6)

3 No longer a teenager, at least (6)

4 In jazz, apparently, there's violent action (3)

5 Sort of reaction to keep watch on? (5)

6 It's an advantage if everybody's in when it goes up (7)

7 They're of one accord (4)

8 The long ones can be deeply penetrating (6)

12 Fighter with whom the old enemy is about to get cross! (5)

13 In which to get a custard pie right in the

24, Car-dig-an

26, Made over

28, Eyes (6)

29, (be)st-ared

31, S-e-n-o-s-up

34, Blueprint

36, Leaves out

38, Cushing

39, Engage

40, Fi-de

41, Mist-rust

42, Threa-tens

1, Spell out

2, Packet

3, Fourso-me

4, Strike

5, Por-tab-le

6, Second-hand

7, Stood in

8, Umb-0-ll

11, Asinine

16, Es-Cu-do

19, Era-se(condi

20, Ten (rev)

22, Press

23, P-ounce

25, Getting out

26, Mad (rev)

27, Her-bag-e

30, Retreats

31, Sta-ge-ers

32, P-at-ro-ast

33, S-prints

35, Uns-aid

36, Lights

37, O-liver

BRIEFLY

Kajal retains U20 World title; Tanu, Savita take silver



Kajal Dhochak won her second consecutive U20 World title while Tanu Sharma and Savita settled for silver medals at the U20 Wrestling World Championship here.

Kajal, 18, won the 76kg title with a commanding 7-0 victory over China's Jingru Sun in the final. She had won the U20 World title in the 72kg category last year.

Kajal is already graduating to the senior level, winning a gold medal at the Ranking Series event in Mongolia in June this year, apart from winning a gold at the Budapest event in July. She also won the U20 Asian Championship in Pattaya.

In the 72kg category, Tanu put up a resilient fight in the gold medal match against Japan's Chisato Yoshida before losing 3-5.

In the 62kg division, Savita faced a formidable opponent in Japan's Sakura Onishi in the gold medal bout and lost by technical superiority (2-12).

Mansi Lather is in gold contention in the 68kg event. She is up against China's Chenling Song in the final, while Komal will fight it out with Spain's Rosa Molina Rodriguez in the 59kg repechage round.

None of India's Greco-Roman wrestlers won a medal. The men's freestyle competition will begin later Friday and conclude on Sunday.

(PTI)

Hyderabad is new host for Tennis Premier League



The eighth season of the Tennis Premier League (TPL) will be held in Hyderabad from December 8 to 13, the organisers announced on Friday.

The eight-team event, in its signature 25-point format, will be held at the LB Tennis Stadium with the support of the Telangana Government.

GS Delhi Aces, Hyderabad Strikers, Lucknow Blazers, Gurgaon Grand Slammers, Gujarat Panthers, Rajasthan Rangers, Kolkata Thunder Blades and Mumbai Royals compete in the league.

"Season 8 is a landmark chapter for TPL, not just because we're bringing world-class tennis to Hyderabad for the first time, but because it's the first season where fans will see our partnership with Kia India come alive. It's a strong signal of how far this league has come, and Hyderabad's sporting culture makes it the perfect city to take that next step in our journey," Kunal Thakkur, co-founder, Tennis Premier League, said.

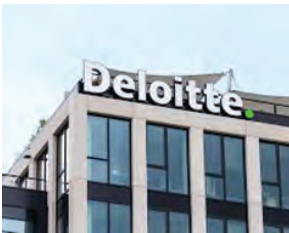
The previous edition was held in Ahmedabad.

(PTI)

Deloitte Group to be transaction advisor for JLN stadium redevelopment project

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
■ New Delhi

London-based accounting firm Deloitte Group will be the Transaction Advisor to "guide the redevelopment process" of the national Capital's iconic Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium, which the government intends to convert into a multi-purpose Sports City.



picked after a tendering process in which two other companies made it past the technical evaluation phase.

Deloitte was found to be the best in the final round of evaluation and was awarded the bid. The Deloitte group is empanelled in the Department of Economic Affairs' pre-approved list of consultants.

Its brief for the upcoming

Treesa-Gayatri assure WC medal, say job not finished

AMIT KUMAR DAS  
■ New Delhi

India's Treesa Jolly and Gayatri Gopichand on Friday said being "calm and patient" was the key to their medal run at the World Championships, but were quick to add that the job is "not finished yet" as they eye a deeper run.

The Indian duo assured themselves of a medal with a come-from-behind 16-21, 21-15, 21-13 win over China's Jia Yi Fan and Zhang Shu Xian in the women's doubles quarterfinal.

India last won a BWF World Championships medal in women's doubles in 2011, when Jwala Gutta and Ashwini Ponnappa claimed bronze in London.

"I think just being calm and patient and just being in the present moment is actually what we need to do to score points against them. That kind of mindset was there. I think that really worked," Gayatri told reporters.

Treesa admitted the signif-

icance of the victory only truly sank in when they reached the final stages of the deciding game.

"I think when we got the last 21 points. Because with those kinds of players, it's like when you actually win, that time only will we actually process that," she said.

"I think right now, just processing this one, we are going to the semi-finals and being on the podium. But it's not finished yet. This is not the ending. We came here with a goal.

"Actually, this is our third World Championship. And it's happening in India and on home soil. I think the crowd was so amazing. I think that really helped us."

The Indians will next face top seeds China's Liu Sheng Shu and Tan Ning, but Gayatri said they were refusing to get carried away by the occasion or the identity of their opponents.

"We don't want to think too much. We don't want to think about the outcome too much. We just want to get on



court first. And then I think we are playing well. And I think we just want to keep doing that. And see what happens," she said.

Treesa also drew confidence from the praise they received from Olympic champion Jia Yifan, who won the Paris Games gold alongside Chen Qingchen.

"When I started playing, when she won the Olympic gold medal, it's like she is a good player and beating her it's like kind of a confidence boost for both of us," Treesa said.

"And at this level, when you play, you cannot really

praise anyone. It's like everyone is competitive, and we need to be at that level; we should do that."

Gayatri revealed that even with a sizeable lead in the decider, the pair kept reminding each other not to relax.

"I think we were constantly telling each other it's not over yet, it's not over yet. Because we had a huge lead in the third set, but we just kept telling each other it wasn't over yet," she said.

The medal also represents the culmination of several years of ups and downs for the pair, who have pushed each other through difficult phases.

In the past, Treesa and Gayatri made it to the All England Open semi-finals in 2022 and 2023. They also won a Commonwealth Games bronze in 2022 and broke into the top 10 at the start of last year.

However, early this year, Treesa suffered an ankle injury while training ahead of the Asia Badminton Championships and Uber Cup.

"I think there are so many ups and downs over these many years that we all went through. I think now we are in great shape and we just want to continue that," Treesa said.

"I think obviously, before the Asian Championship, I got injured three days before. I think that was kind of, obviously, it's been sad and emotional and kind of missing those major tournaments, representing India and all those moments I missed," she said.

After a gruelling rehabilitation, Treesa and Gayatri returned at the Indonesia Open and then played at the

US Open before winning the Philippine International Challenge early this month.

"I think those times, I think Gopi sir, Gaya, my parents, my friends, everyone was there behind me, who supported me to just recover as soon as possible and just be fit.

"I think that time she was also training. She's also waiting for me. I'm telling her. I will come soon."

Treesa said past disappointments, including the India Open, had taught her the value of staying patient in crucial moments.

"I think in a few tournaments, I think I have messed up with so much greediness to get the scoring, the points, that obviously I still remember when we played the India Open," she said.

"It was kind of a little bit crucial situations happened, and it was such a great match we played. But in those situations, if I could have been a little bit calmer and more patient, we could have just scored points and won that match.

(PTI)

Rising stars like India's Atiqa Mir redefining future of motorsport: FIA

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
■ Paris

World motorsport body FIA has given a strong endorsement for Indian racer Atiqa Mir's special talent, saying rising stars like the 11-year-old are redefining the future of the sport.



Karting Championship Nations Cup and has now started competing in international FIA Karting competitions on her journey to professional racing. Well done Atiqa and we look forward to following your continued success," the FIA added.

In May, Atiqa had completed a historic sweep of Round 2 of the Champions of the Future Academy in Greece. Earlier this month, she became the youngest Indian to record two top-10 finishes in a FIA European Championship round in Sweden.

Last month, Atiqa had attracted plenty of attention by outqualifying Mercedes junior Niccolò Perico for pole position in Round 3 of the Champions of the Future Academy series in Italy.

The FIA too took notice of that standout performance.

"At the recent Champions of the Future Academy Program event in Italy, 11-year-old Atiqa Mir from India delivered a standout performance, securing pole position and setting an event record against a highly competitive international field.

Azhar wins maiden title at Kolar Open

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
■ Kolar (Karnataka)

Hyderabad golfer Mohammed Azhar produced a consistent performance to card a one-under 71 and clinch his maiden professional title at the ₹1 crore Kolar Open on Friday.



The 27-year-old Azhar (70-68-70-71) finished at nine-under 279 to secure a two-shot victory and collect the winner's cheque of ₹15 lakh. He also climbed seven places, from 17th to 10th, in the 2026 DP World PGTI Order of Merit, taking his season's earnings to ₹35,14,675.

Chandigarh's Angad Cheema (73-68-67-73), a four-time winner on the tour, and Delhi's Shaurya Bhattacharya (68-67-71-75), a three-time winner, shared second place at seven-under 281.

Cheema recorded his second runner-up finish of the season, having also finished tied second at the Boulders Classic in April.

Bhattacharya began the final round with a two-shot lead and remained in control until the closing stretch. However, consecu-

tive double bogeys on the 17th and 18th proved costly, leaving him two shots behind Azhar.

It was another close finish for Bhattacharya, who also finished runner-up in the inaugural edition last year, two shots behind Kshitij Naveed Kaul.

Azhar, who joined the professional tour in 2020, began the final round two shots behind Bhattacharya. He stayed patient through testing spells of wind and rain and created enough opportunities to move ahead as the tournament reached its decisive stage.

"Today was very good, and I'm extremely happy with the way I played," said Azhar. "The conditions were difficult with the wind and

rain, but I stayed patient and focused on finding greens in regulation."

Azhar reached the par-five second in two shots and made a comfortable two-putt birdie. He then struck his approach close for a tap-in birdie on the fourth.

One of the biggest moments of his round arrived on the 12th, where he holed a putt from around 30 to 35 feet for birdie.

"I created several birdie opportunities and managed to convert enough of them," he said.

"The long putt on the 12th was one of the highlights. On the back nine, I tried to play solidly and make pars whenever a birdie opportunity was not available."

Atomy India partners with PCI for para-athlete wellness

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

Atomy Enterprise India Private Limited has signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the Paralympic Committee of India (PCI) to become the official nutrition and wellness partner for Paralympic sports across the nation.

Under the agreement, both organisations will focus on building health, nutrition and wellness awareness among para-athletes through workshops, seminars, community engagement activities and digital campaigns. Atomy India will extend nutritional product support, resources and event assistance, while the PCI will involve athletes, coaches and sports experts.



Highlighting the scope of the alliance, Devendra Jhajharia, President of the Paralympic Committee of India, noted that the Paralympic movement relies heavily on athlete discipline and resilience. "Their journey demands not only sporting excellence but also sustained attention to health, wellness, nutrition and overall

well-being, which are important foundations for enhancing performance," Jhajharia said, adding that the tie-up creates avenues to strengthen the ecosystem supporting Indian para-athletes.

Dr SI (Abraham Lee), Managing Director and CEO of Atomy India, shared that personal recovery from a recent ligament injury deep-

ened his admiration for the courage and daily struggles of Paralympic competitors.

Atomy's flagship wellness product, HemoHIM, carries certification under the Informed Choice anti-doping programme. Internationally, Atomy and Kolmar BNH recently executed a three-year sponsorship deal supporting the South Korean national badminton team.

The MoU signing took place during the Atomy India Success Academy event, where over 80 members attaining new Mastership ranks were felicitated. Notably, Star Master Tarachand Suaskar — a former MGNREGA daily-wage labourer earning ₹100 per day — was lauded for earning ₹10-15 lakh monthly through the network.

Mandaviya to chair BRICS Youth, Sports Ministers meeting in Visakhapatnam

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
■ New Delhi

Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya will chair a two-day meeting of BRICS Sports and Youth Ministers beginning on Saturday in Visakhapatnam where a joint declaration focussing on sports manufacturing and indigenous disciplines will be issued on the final day.



South Africa and the United Arab Emirates, followed by the adoption of the Joint Declaration, stated a government press release.

The meetings will be chaired by Mandaviya, with Minister of State for Sports and Youth Affairs, Raksha Khadse, participating in the proceedings.

Senior officials of the

Sports Ministry, including Secretary Hari Ranjan Rao, will also be associated with the engagements.

The BRICS Youth Ministers' Meeting on Saturday will focus on strengthening cooperation in youth development and empowerment, with discussions covering education, skills, entrepreneurship, and sustainable development.

The meeting is expected to culminate in the adoption of the BRICS Youth Ministerial Joint Declaration and the BRICS Youth Cooperation Framework.

At the BRICS Sports Ministers' Meeting on Sunday, member countries would reaffirm their shared commitment to strengthening cooperation in sports.

Messi inspires Argentina hockey skipper Rey at sixth WC

MONA PARTHSARATHI  
■ Amstelveen

Lionel Messi's influence on Argentine sport extends well beyond football and the country's men's hockey captain Matias Rey is drawing inspiration from the iconic Number 10 as he leads his country at a sixth World Cup.

The Talismanic Messi led Argentina to three FIFA World Cup finals in four editions, with the Albiceleste finishing runners-up to Spain in the summit clash last month.

Like Messi, Rey is appearing in his sixth World Cup and the veteran defender sees his role extending beyond his own performance.

"I am playing my sixth World Cup, like Lionel Messi, and I am in a position to share my experience with

the young players and all the things I have learnt," Rey told PTI.

Rey, who was part of Argentina's gold medal-winning team at the 2016 Rio Olympics, said the country's football success under Messi has reinforced a simple sporting philosophy: never give up.

"Argentina is a football country and they played the World Cup final this year. We learn from them not to give up until the end and keep fighting," Rey said.

The 41-year-old's experience will be put to the test when Argentina take on India on Monday, with the skipper expecting a stiff challenge from Harmanpreet Singh and his men.

"India is a really strong team. They have many good players and a good coach, so



it will be a tough fight. We are here to compete. Now we have to face two wonderful teams. We know it will not be easy, but we are ready," he said.

Goalkeeper Tomas Santiago, who has 57 international appearances and featured in Argentina's last two

World Cup campaigns, said the team would have to be fully focused against India.

"India is a very strong team and we need to be 120 per cent focused to beat them," he said.

Santiago singled out Harmanpreet as a major threat, saying Argentina

would rely on video analysis to prepare for the penalty-corner specialist.

"Every team has a strong drag flicker and Harmanpreet is also one of them. We will analyse the videos and try our best to neutralise his PCs," he said.

Argentina's hockey players, meanwhile, are hoping to emulate the consistency of their country's all-conquering football side.

"We like to be as successful as our football team. They won the last World Cup and reached the final again," Santiago said.

Messi's influence was also visible in the stands during Argentina's pool match against New Zealand at the Wageren Stadium on Thursday, with several supporters sporting his iconic Number 10 jersey.

(PTI)

# England thrashes Pakistan by an innings and 103 runs in first test

ASSOCIATED PRESS  
■ Leeds (England)

England wrapped up an innings win over Pakistan inside three days in the first test on Friday, delivering a strong start to the post-Bazball era under returning captain Joe Root.

Dismissed for 409 around 40 minutes into day three, England took a 238-run advantage into the second innings and skittled Pakistan for 135 in 37.3 overs before tea.

England won by an innings and 103 runs and has a 1-0 lead in the three-match series. The second test starts on Thursday at Lord's.

England's battery of four seamers pestered consistently at a fuller length that's required at Headingley, and Pakistan couldn't endure it.

Jofra Archer removed the openers with the new ball, Ollie Robinson got three more wickets, Josh Tongue was introduced after lunch and took three wickets averaging 143 kph (89 mph), and



Gus Atkinson bowled superbly for the late reward of Pakistan top scorer Mohammad Rizwan.

Robinson and Tongue each took eight wickets in the match. They took five each in the first innings and literally split the match ball in half. Robinson was named the player of the match for his 8-80 compared to Tongue's 8-89. Robinson is heading back

to Lord's, where he took 7-77 against New Zealand in June.

England is in a new era following the retirement of captain Ben Stokes and the firing of Brendon McCullum as test coach after the 2-1 series loss to New Zealand in June.

Pakistan arrived with a semblance of confidence after drawing the series in the West Indies this month and

playing a warm-up match last week. But Pakistan looked rusty, and the bowling and fielding were less than ordinary. The question, after finishing England's first innings in the morning, was whether the visitors could force play into a fourth day.

England, 366-8 overnight, added 43 runs. Archer pulled the only six of the match. Khurram Shahzad took both wickets and showed the pitch was still offering plenty for the bowlers.

Pakistan started 0-1 for the second time in the match.

Imam-ul-Haq bent backwards to an Archer bouncer, and the ball brushed a glove. Azan Awaiz, who fell to the first ball of the series, then nicked to Root at leg slip, and Archer had dismissed both openers.

The pressure was on veterans Shan Masood and Abdullah Shafique to endure, but Robinson broke their partnership in the 14th over. Robinson busted through Shafique's determined defence with a nick to second slip.

# Gill polishes game against left-arm spinners at nets; Kuldeep and Rahul give it a miss

G UNNIKRISHNAN  
■ Colombo

Mindful of his underwhelming returns against left-arm spin, India skipper Shubman Gill on Friday spent considerable time fine-tuning his game against that variation at the team's training session ahead of the upcoming second Test against Sri Lanka.

In the first Test at Galle, Gill fell to left-arm spinner Prabath Jayasuriya twice while making 16 and 8. India, nonetheless, won the game by 165 runs. The second Test begins here on August 23.

In general, Gill's travails against the orthodox left-armers has its genesis in his inadequate covering of the line, and it was evident at Galle while he struggled to negate Jayasuriya.

Gill has been dismissed 11 times by left-arm spinners in Test cricket across 42 games.

At the Sinhalese Sports Club nets, Gill worked on his game against left-arm spinners, facing up to Manav Suthar, Ravindra Jadeja and a couple of local bowlers for a considerable time.



India's spin bowling coach Sairaj Bahutule gave an insight into Gill's net session on the day, and said the right-hander was trying to adapt to Colombo conditions.

"The way he plays, there is a flow of runs always. So, he is somebody who is just assessing the pitch condition, pace of the pitch and seeing what type of shots he can play, what are the defences he can

manoeuvre. He is just adapting to the conditions.

"There is nothing too much into it in terms of planning how he is going to approach. He just follows his natural way of playing each innings," said Bahutule.

But it has to be said that Gill has a better record against off-spinners and leg-spinners with a combined average of 61, and holds a

career average of 48 against tweekers of all types.

Kuldeep Yadav attended the nets, but he neither bowled nor batted. However, off-spinner Saransh Jain bowled a few overs to Rishabh Pant and Shubman Gill, and even squared up the former on a couple of occasions.

But it would be naive, at least at this stage, to take it as a sign of Jain replacing Kuldeep in the eleven for the second Test. "Both KL and Kuldeep are resting. We finished five days of the match; we travelled from Galle. So that's the reason," said Bahutule.

Kuldeep struggled to make an impact in the Galle Test, conceding 103 runs in 25 runs for a solitary wicket, which too was made possible by Gill's athleticism at covers.

Opener and vice-captain KL Rahul was absent from nets, while middle-order batter Dhruv Jurel joined in a bit late to polish his skills. Both Rahul and Jurel had made well-timed fifties in the first Test, contributing to India's victory. (PTI)

# Do-or-die match for us, need full 60 minute masterclass against the Dutch: Harmanpreet

MONA PARTHSARATHI  
■ Amstelveen

Facing a "do-or-die" contest against Paris Olympic champion Netherlands, Indian hockey skipper Harmanpreet Singh has warned his squad that a quarter-by-quarter effort won't cut it, and only a full 60-minute masterclass will keep their campaign alive in the FIH World Cup.

India will have to start from scratch in the second round. England and pool A topper Netherlands will have a three-point cushion as they had beaten India and Argentina in the first round respectively. That makes both the second-round matches and the Dutch and Argentina games virtual knockouts for India.

"Playing well in patches won't work. We have to play good hockey till the whistle is blown. We have to maintain the same body language and attitude, that is the most important thing," Harmanpreet told media ahead of the big match.

"We have video-analysed our mistakes in the last three matches, and the focus is on not repeating them. Defense has to be impeccable as we know that we can create opportunities in the opponents' circle and earn PC. But mistakes in the backline are not acceptable. We must not concede goals on silly mistakes," he said.

India had defeated Netherlands 3-2 in the last match of FIH Pro League 2025-26 season in June and the captain feels that his team can do it again provided they stick to the game plan and play smartly.

"In that match we controlled the ball possession and did not let them win the ball in our half. If we could play with a similar strategy and energy, there is no reason why we can't repeat that.

"We will focus on rotation, speed and co ordination as a team. We have senior



players in every line to guide the youngsters and they should take the responsibility," he said.

The tournament's top scorer with five goals to his name, the ace drag flicker will be on the Dutch team's radar, but he feels that India has more weapons to surprise them.

"There is no pressure; rather, there is clarity that we have to win it. There is no other way. It's a do-or-die match for us. Individually also I am not feeling any pressure. I will do what I have been doing for years now. If they are focusing of me, we have other weapons too to surprise them," he said. Harmanpreet also feels that being the underdogs will work in the Indian team's favour.

"We have beaten higher-ranked teams before. But it's good that we will enter the field as underdogs. Defeating big teams in front of their crowd boosts confidence. We have a great opportunity and we can do it," he said.

India coach Craig Fulton believed his side has a "great opportunity" to upset the hosts but said they will have to be at their best.

"They are Olympic gold medalists and are not in the

top three teams for nothing. They have good set-pieces and PCD. We have made some good improvements against them, but we have to be on our game to put pressure on them," Fulton said.

India's historic win over Australia at the Paris Olympics gives them belief, but Fulton said the past result means little now.

"We beat Australia in Paris for the first time in 50 years. But that is the stat and we have to do it now in the next 24 hours. We have got a great opportunity and come as underdogs, so all the pressure is on them," he said.

Fulton also stressed the need for India to press intelligently and capitalise on their chances.

"We have got to press well, be smart and efficient when we win the ball. When we get our chance, we have got to be composed and make that count," he said. On the expected home support for the Dutch, Fulton said India are used to playing in front of passionate crowds. "It's like the support for us in Rourkela or Bhubaneswar. The crowd is like the 12th man supporting them from the stands. The only way is to score goals and put pressure on the opponent," he said. (PTI)

# Speed not enough, needs skill: Sohail Khan on Pakistani pacers

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
■ Karachi

Pakistan fast bowler Sohail Khan, who once took five wickets against India in a World Cup match, has blamed the current crop of pacers for playing a major role in the country's downslide in Test cricket, saying they have not learnt how to polish their skills.

Pakistan appeared to be staring at another defeat in the first Test against England at Leeds after the pace bowlers failed to make an impact on a pitch assisting lateral movement.

Sohail said that Pakistan, which has a legacy of producing world class fast bowlers, was now in trouble because of the inability of the bowlers to work on their skill levels.

"Speed is not everything to be a successful fast bowler in Test cricket. You need to



know the art of using the crease, angles, reverse swing, late swing from a good length to constantly take wickets," he said.

Sohail took five wickets for 55 runs in the 2015 World Cup match against India in Adelaide and was also impressive on tours to England with two five wicket hauls. He retired from international cricket in 2023 but

continued to play domestic and franchise-based white-ball format.

"There is so much talk about speed but fast bowlers need to know how to produce results with their skills. Jasprit Bumrah is a classic example. The way he uses his wrist and angles makes him a devastating fast bowler in any format," Sohail, who played 27 inter-

national matches including nine Tests, said.

He said nowadays in Pakistan cricket there is a lot of talk about how fast a bowler is but no one is holding specialized one-to-one sessions with the young pacers to tutor them on how to improve their skills and tactics.

Sohail said with the advent of T20 cricket, which guaranteed a lot of money to young players, the trend was mostly to buck against Test and First class cricket.

"The thing is, unless you don't play enough first class cricket with the red ball, you can never become world class and have the ability to adjust and exploit different pitches and conditions. The more you play the more fit a fast bowler remains," said the 42-year-old.

He said pace bowlers needed to be encouraged and one example of this

was Indian cricket. "We have a couple of good prospects but they don't know how to be a complete fast bowler. Shaheen Shah Afridi is an example. He is struggling because of his wrist positions and he falls away in his follow through and no one has rectified his problem as yet." He also lamented that internal politics and personnel egos had also badly hit the progress of Pakistan cricket.

"There are too many likes and dislikes in our cricket. Too much ego. I have spoken to Aqib Javed, Misbah ul Haq, Asad Shafiq and offered my services as fast bowling coach but they have not bothered to get back despite reminders," he disclosed. Sohail said he has done a level 2 coaching course but was more inclined to develop coaching skills to make young pacers complete bowlers.

# India series dates could shift; BPL unlikely this year: BCB chief

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
■ Dhaka

Bangladesh Cricket Board President Tamim Iqbal has said that the dates of a much-awaited home series against India could "move around" as the BCB reworks its calendar, which may not feature its flagship T20 showpiece, the Bangladesh Premier League, this year due to heavy financial losses.

Speaking to reporters, Tamim said the BCB will conduct a Game Development tournament at the Sher-e-Bangla National Cricket Stadium from August 28 to September 9, featuring players from Under-17, Under-19 and Under-23 categories.

"There are discussions regarding the India series; the dates may move around," said Tamim.

"And this tournament is taking place in Mirpur, but if necessary, it can also move to the Bashundhara ground

(Dhaka). Once the India series is fixed, we will schedule it accordingly," he was quoted as saying by 'Cricbuzz'.

India have already scheduled a three-match T20 International series against Afghanistan in New Delhi from September 13 to 17. This has all but ruled out an India-Bangladesh series in the September window. The series was postponed last year due to unrest in Bangladesh.

Speaking about the BPL, which has been mired in several controversies including corruption by players and franchises, Tamim said the Board needs to improve its financial health. He said the BPL has caused losses adding up to 40 crore Bangladeshi Taka (₹31 crore) in the past two seasons.

"I don't think BPL will be held this year...I don't want to organise the BPL this way...for the last two years,



BCB has incurred losses of around 40 Crore Taka," Tamim said.

"Until and unless we fix the issues, it is not absolutely important for us to host this event every year...Do we have the intention to do it? Hundred per cent. Do I want to rush it? Absolutely not," he added.

Tamim said it could take up to two years to fix the

current situation. "A tournament from which the BCB is supposed to make a profit is instead making losses. So until this is corrected, holding it every year is not important to me. If it takes six, 12 or 24 months to do it properly, I will take that time.

"We have started communication with the franchises. The issues involving

those who defaulted have to be settled. The issues of missed payments and bank guarantees are being looked at step by step. We will organise the BPL only after taking the BCB to a profit-making position," he said.

Tamim said he hopes to have the franchises ready to go by April-May next year.

"If someone defaults, I want to have three to four months in hand to look for an alternative franchise. I want to ensure that the BCB or Bangladesh cricket does not fall into any trouble.

"I could put five teams together tomorrow if I wanted to, but do you want that? I am willing to face criticism for this. We are working on a formula and have completed around 60-70 per cent of the work regarding the domestic calendar. When we announce it, you will see a lot of new things," he added.

# Sreeshankar to lead Indian challenge in maiden WA Continental Tour

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
■ Bhubaneswar

Long jumpers Murali Sreeshankar and Ancy Sojan, sprinters Animesh Kujur and Gurindervir Singh will be among some of the Indian stars who will vie for top honours in the World Athletics Continental Tour silver-level meet on Saturday.

The Indian athletes can use the one-day meet as a tune-up for the upcoming Asian Games in Japan as they will rub shoulders with athletes from other countries, including the likes of 2024

Paris Olympics bronze-winning quarter-miler Muzala Samukonga of Zambia.

Samukonga boasts a season best of 44.02 seconds and a personal best of 43.74 seconds. He will be joined by Nigeria's World No. 10 shot putter Chukwuebuka Enekwechi, a Commonwealth Games champion and Paris Olympics finalist.

There will be 18 events split equally between men and women. Male athletes will compete in 100m, 400m, 800m, 110m hurdles, high jump, long jump, shot put and javelin throw.



Female athletes will compete in 100m, 400m, 1500m, 100m hurdles, high jump, long jump, javelin throw, and discus throw.

Top performers will earn crucial world ranking points as well as cash prizes. The winners will pocket \$1,600, \$1,200 for second-place finishers and \$900 for third-place finishers.

India has fielded their top athletes in almost all 18 events. In all, the one-day meet will see around 200 participants, including 88 Indians.

Athletes from 26 nations, including around 140 partic-

ipants from 12 Asian countries, are taking part in the event.

The meet is India's first-ever World Athletics Continental Tour silver event after successfully staging a bronze-level competition here last year. As many as 195 athletes from 17 countries took part in 2025. Following its success, World Athletics upgraded the Bhubaneswar event to silver level this year. The men's long jump will see all the top Indian athletes, including Sreeshankar, Shahnavaz Khan, Lokesh Sathanathan and P David.

# SL draft in Arachchige and Kamil for second Test



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
■ Colombo

Sri Lanka on Friday drafted in off-spin all-rounder Sahan

Arachchige and batter Kamil Mishara into the squad for the must-win second and final Test against India, starting here from August 23.